2ND Russian-Pakistani International Conference

THE EVOLVING RUSSIA-PAKISTAN RELATIONSHIP IN A CHANGING GLOBAL ORDER

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Institute of International Relations, History and Oriental Studies
Kazan Federal University, Russia &
Department of International Relations, Federal Urdu University of Arts, Science and Technology, Islamabad, Pakistan

2ND Russian-Pakistani International Conference

THE EVOLVING RUSSIA-PAKISTAN RELATIONSHIP IN A CHANGING GLOBAL ORDER

Abstract Booklet

Academic Editors

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Partner Institutes

CAPES | CONSORTIUM FOR ASIA PACIFIC & EURASIAN STUDIES

NATIONAL UNIVERSITY OF SCIENCES & TECHNOLOGY
PAKISTAN

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Kazan Federal University (KFU)

Kazan Federal University (KFU) is one of the oldest and most prestigious institutions of higher education in Russia, renowned for its rich academic heritage, scientific achievements, and global outlook. Established in 1804, the university has played a central role in the development of education, research, and intellectual thought in the Russian Federation and beyond. Located in the historic city of Kazan, KFU serves as a major educational and cultural hub, attracting students and scholars from across the world.

Over the centuries, Kazan Federal University has built a distinguished reputation for academic excellence and innovation. It has been associated with many prominent scholars, including the famous mathematician Nikolai Lobachevsky, who served as rector and made groundbreaking contributions to non-Euclidean geometry. The university's legacy reflects a strong tradition of scientific inquiry and intellectual rigor, which continues to shape its modern academic environment.

KFU offers a wide range of undergraduate, graduate, and doctoral programs across diverse disciplines, including natural sciences, engineering, medicine, social sciences, humanities, and information technology. The university comprises numerous institutes and faculties, each equipped with modern facilities, research centers, and laboratories that support cutting-edge research and innovation. Its academic structure is designed to foster interdisciplinary learning and equip students with the skills required to address contemporary global challenges.

In recent years, Kazan Federal University has undergone significant modernization as part of Russia's efforts to enhance the global competitiveness of its higher education system. It is a participant in national academic excellence initiatives, which aim to strengthen research output, international collaboration, and educational quality. The university maintains partnerships with leading institutions worldwide, facilitating student exchange programs, joint research projects, and international conferences.

Research is a cornerstone of KFU's mission, with particular strengths in fields such as physics, chemistry, medicine, geology, and information technology. The university actively contributes to scientific advancements and innovation, addressing issues ranging from energy and environmental sustainability to public health and digital transformation. Its commitment to research excellence is supported by state-of-the-art infrastructure and collaboration with industry and academic partners.

Beyond academics, KFU provides a vibrant campus life that encourages cultural exchange, personal development, and community engagement. Students benefit from a diverse and inclusive environment, enriched by the presence of international students from various countries. The university also promotes extracurricular activities, including sports, arts, and student organizations, which contribute to the holistic development of its students.

In conclusion, Kazan Federal University stands as a symbol of academic tradition blended with modern innovation. With its strong emphasis on research, internationalization, and quality education, KFU continues to play a vital role in shaping the future of higher education in Russia and contributing to the global academic community.



Federal Urdu University of Arts, Science and Technology (FUUAST)

Federal Urdu University of Arts, Science and Technology (FUUAST) is one of Pakistan's prominent public-sector universities, established with the distinctive mission of promoting higher education through the medium of Urdu. Founded in 2002, the university represents a significant milestone in Pakistan's educational and cultural development, as it seeks to strengthen the role of the national language in academic, scientific, and professional domains. With campuses in Islamabad and Karachi, FUUAST serves a diverse student population from across the country, providing access to quality education in a wide range of disciplines.

The origins of the university can be traced back to the Federal Government Urdu College, which was established in 1949 by Baba-e-Urdu, Maulvi Abdul Haq, a leading figure in the promotion of the Urdu language. This institution played a pioneering role in advocating for Urdu as a medium of instruction in higher education. Over time, it evolved into a full-fledged university, reflecting the growing demand for accessible education that integrates national identity with academic excellence.

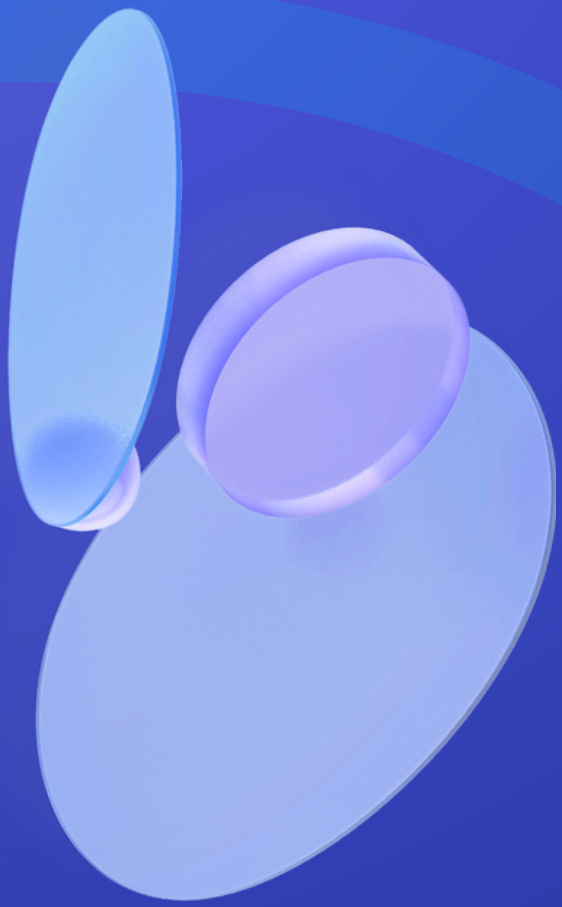
FUUAST offers undergraduate, graduate, and postgraduate programs in fields such as natural sciences, social sciences, humanities, business administration, computer science, and education. The university is structured into various faculties and departments, each committed to fostering critical thinking, research skills, and intellectual growth. By combining traditional knowledge with modern academic approaches, FUUAST aims to prepare students to meet the challenges of a rapidly changing global environment.

A distinctive feature of the university is its emphasis on Urdu as a language of instruction, particularly in disciplines where English has traditionally dominated. This approach not only facilitates learning for students from diverse linguistic backgrounds but also contributes to the development of academic literature in Urdu. At the same time, the university ensures that students are equipped with proficiency in English and other necessary skills to compete internationally.

Research and innovation are integral components of FUUAST's academic framework. The university encourages faculty and students to engage in scholarly research that addresses national and global issues. Various seminars, conferences, and workshops are organized regularly to promote academic discourse and collaboration. The institution also seeks to build partnerships with other universities and research organizations, both within Pakistan and abroad.

In addition to academic excellence, FUUAST places strong emphasis on character building, social responsibility, and civic engagement. Through extracurricular activities, student societies, and community outreach programs, the university nurtures well-rounded individuals who can contribute positively to society. Its inclusive environment promotes diversity, tolerance, and mutual respect among students from different cultural and socioeconomic backgrounds.

In conclusion, the Federal Urdu University of Arts, Science and Technology stands as a symbol of Pakistan's commitment to accessible and culturally grounded higher education. By integrating the Urdu language into modern academic frameworks while maintaining high educational standards, the university plays a vital role in shaping the intellectual and professional future of the nation.



Messages



Lenar Safin
Rector
Kazan Federal University

Dear Colleagues,

I am pleased to welcome you to the proceedings of the 2nd Russian-Pakistani International Conference, which presents a cross-section of the most current scientific research prepared by leading experts from Russia and Pakistan for discussion within the forum framework. The 2nd Russian-Pakistani International Conference, held with the support of Kazan Federal University and the Federal Urdu University of Arts, Sciences and Technology, as part of the XVII International Economic Forum "Russia – Islamic World: KazanForum" continues the dialogue initiated a year ago in Karachi. This volume testifies to the transition of our cooperation into a phase of deep substantive analysis and the development of concrete solutions. The materials presented here demonstrate a high level of interdisciplinary approach. The authors examine the transformation of Russian-Pakistani ties through the prism of three strategic vectors that define the modern global agenda:

- Geopolitical stability and security;
- Economic integration;
- The humanitarian dimension as the foundation of trust.

Kazan Federal University, with its unique 222-year-old school of Oriental Studies, serves as a platform uniting these areas. We are confident that the research presented in this volume will provide a solid theoretical basis for the plenary discussions and working sessions of the conference. I express my deep gratitude to the authors for their thorough elaboration of the topics, to the reviewers for their high professionalism in selecting the materials, and to the Organizing Committee for preparing the publication for print.

I hope that this volume will prove to be a useful tool for all participants in the scientific dialogue and serve as an impetus for new joint projects between our countries.

I wish you fruitful work and successful implementation of your ideas!



Prof. Dr. Zabta Khan Shinwari

Vice Chancellor
Federal Urdu University of Arts, Science and Technology (FUUAST), Pakistan

It gives me immense pleasure to extend my warm greetings to all distinguished scholars, researchers, diplomats, policymakers, and participants attending the *2nd Russian–Pakistani International Conference, titled **The Evolving Russia–Pakistan Relationship in a Changing Global Order**, being held in Kazan, Russian Federation, as part of the prestigious Russia–Islamic World: Kazan Forum 2026.

In an era marked by profound geopolitical transformation and the emergence of new regional and global realities, academic dialogue and intellectual cooperation have become increasingly important for fostering mutual understanding and sustainable partnerships among nations. The growing relationship between Pakistan and the Russian Federation reflects not only evolving strategic interests but also a shared commitment to regional peace, connectivity, education, and cultural engagement.

This conference represents an important academic platform that brings together scholars and experts from diverse backgrounds to exchange ideas, share research, and explore new avenues of cooperation between Pakistan and Russia. Such initiatives play a vital role in strengthening people-to-people connections and promoting constructive engagement through knowledge, research, and diplomacy.

I am pleased to note that this conference builds upon the success of the 1st Russian–Pakistani International Conference held in Karachi in February 2025, which laid the foundation for sustained institutional and scholarly collaboration between our two countries. The second edition in Kazan reflects the growing momentum of this partnership and the expanding interest of academic institutions in promoting Eurasian dialogue and cooperation.

I would like to express my sincere appreciation to Kazan Federal University, our partner institutions, organizing committees, and all contributors for their dedicated efforts in making this conference possible. I am confident that the deliberations and scholarly exchanges during this forum will contribute meaningfully to strengthening Pakistan–Russia relations and advancing academic cooperation in the years ahead.

I wish the conference great success and extend my best wishes to all participants for productive discussions and a memorable experience in Kazan.



H.E. Mr. Albert P. Khorev

Ambassador of the Russian Federation to the Islamic Republic of Pakistan

I send my cordial greeting to the participants of the 2nd Russian-Pakistani Conference, which has already become a traditional event and these days it is hosted in the city of Kazan – the Cultural Capital of the Islamic World.

Amid ongoing fundamental transformation of the system of international relations, which leaves no alternative but to strengthen ties between natural neighbours in the Eurasian region, Russia and Pakistan have reached a qualitatively new level of relations, marked by substantially increased multifaceted bilateral dialogue.

In view of this, I urge the participants of the Conference to make a feasible contribution to the development of new approaches and initiatives, aimed at further deepening of fruitful cooperation between our friendly nations.

Long live Russian-Pakistani friendship!



Faisal Niaz Tirmizi

Ambassador of the Islamic Republic of Pakistan to the Russian Federation

Amid geopolitical flux that is marked by changing regional and global realities, economic transformations and evolving security dynamics, Pakistan and Russia are strengthening bilateral relations based on mutual trust and respect and converging regional and global interests.

Celebrating the 78th anniversary of establishment of our bilateral relations on 1st May 2026, both countries fostered this goodwill over two decades that has given both sides confidence to work through impediments. The scope of our bilateral relationships has widened for cooperation in diverse areas such as trade, industry, energy, defense, people-to-people contacts, education and science and technology.

Pakistan views Russia as an important partner in promoting regional stability, multipolarity, an inclusive international cooperation. The theme “The evolving Russia-Pakistan Relationship in a changing global order” aptly reflects the growing importance of our partnership and our shared desire to translate political goodwill into tangible cooperation for the mutual benefit of our peoples and the broader Eurasian region.

Dr. Faisal Javaid

Conference Organizer
& Focal Person



It is a great honor and privilege for me to welcome all distinguished scholars, diplomats, policymakers, researchers, and participants to the 2nd Russian–Pakistani International Conference, titled **The Evolving Russia–Pakistan Relationship in a Changing Global Order,** being held in Kazan, Russian Federation, as part of the prestigious Russia–Islamic World: Kazan Forum 2026.

This conference holds special significance as Pakistan and the Russian Federation celebrate 78 years of diplomatic relations. Over the decades, the relationship between our two countries has evolved remarkably—from limited interaction during the Cold War era to an increasingly constructive partnership based on mutual respect, regional cooperation, connectivity, and shared strategic interests. Today, Pakistan–Russia relations are entering a new phase shaped by dialogue, pragmatism, and expanding people-to-people engagement.

In the contemporary international environment, academic diplomacy has become an essential pillar for strengthening bilateral and regional cooperation. Universities, scholars, and research institutions now play a crucial role in fostering informed dialogue and generating new ideas for peace, stability, and sustainable development. This conference aims to provide an intellectual platform where scholars and practitioners from Pakistan, Russia, and other countries can engage in meaningful discussions on geopolitics, Eurasian connectivity, economic cooperation, regional security, education, culture, and the emerging multipolar world order.

The successful organization of the 1st Russian–Pakistani International Conference in Karachi in February 2025 demonstrated the growing academic interest in strengthening Pakistan–Russia relations. Building upon that momentum, the second edition in Kazan has received an overwhelming response from scholars and institutions, reflecting the increasing importance of academic engagement in promoting long-term bilateral understanding. As the organizer and focal person of this initiative, I firmly believe that such academic forums are not merely conferences; they are bridges of understanding that connect societies, institutions, and future generations. In a world witnessing rapid geopolitical transformation, intellectual and cultural engagement can play a vital role in promoting cooperation, mutual trust, and regional harmony.

I would like to express my sincere gratitude to *Kazan Federal University, Federal Urdu University of Arts, Science and Technology (FUUAST)*, our partner institutions, ambassadors, patrons, organizing committees, and all participants for their valuable support and cooperation in making this conference possible.

I am confident that the deliberations and collaborations emerging from this conference will contribute meaningfully to strengthening Pakistan–Russia relations and advancing a shared vision of knowledge, partnership, and mutual prosperity.

I wish all participants a productive conference and a memorable stay in Kazan.



Dr. Hassan Jalil Shah

Principal,
Jinnah School of Public Policy and Leadership (JSPPL), NUST
Islamabad.

It gives me great pleasure to convey my greetings and best wishes to the distinguished scholars, practitioners, policymakers, and delegates participating in the 2nd Russian–Pakistani International Conference, titled “The Evolving Russia–Pakistan Relationship in a Changing Global Order,” being held in Kazan as part of the XVII International Economic Forum “Russia–Islamic World: KazanForum” 2026.

Such scholarly initiatives play an important role in strengthening institutional partnerships, encouraging intellectual exchange, and promoting constructive engagement between nations. I commend the organizers, partner institutions, and all contributors whose dedication and efforts have made this important conference possible. I am confident that the discussions and engagements during the forum will contribute meaningfully to the advancement of Pakistan–Russia relations and broader Eurasian cooperation. I extend my best wishes to all participants for a productive conference and a memorable experience in Kazan.

Special Dignitaries
from Paksitan



Mr. Rana Mubashir Iqbal

Federal Minister
for Public Affairs Unit

Mr. Talha Burki

Special Assistant to the Prime Minister
(SAPM) on Political Affairs,
(Minister of State)



Purpose and Foundation



The contemporary international system is experiencing a profound transformation characterized by the emergence of multipolarity, evolving geopolitical alignments, and the growing importance of regional cooperation. In this dynamic global environment, relations between Russia and Pakistan have entered a promising phase marked by mutual trust, pragmatic engagement, and expanding areas of cooperation. Both countries are increasingly viewing each other as constructive partners in promoting regional stability, economic development, and inclusive connectivity across Eurasia and South Asia. While historical circumstances limited close interaction during the Cold War, Russia and Pakistan have, in recent years, successfully moved beyond legacy constraints to develop a relationship based on shared interests and complementary strengths. Cooperation has expanded in key areas such as defense dialogue, energy collaboration, trade, education, regional connectivity, and coordination on regional security challenges.

Pakistan's strategic geographic position as a gateway between South Asia, Central Asia, and the 3 Middle East, combined with Russia's Eurasian outreach and economic capabilities, creates significant potential for mutually beneficial engagement. The 2nd Russian–Pakistani International Conference is designed to further strengthen this positive trajectory by providing an inclusive academic and policy-oriented platform for dialogue, analysis, and collaboration. The conference aims to bring together scholars, policymakers, practitioners, businessmen and students from both countries and beyond to examine the evolving Russia–Pakistan relationship within the context of a changing global order.

Purpose and Foundation



Through interdisciplinary discussion, the conference seeks to highlight opportunities for cooperation, share best practices, and explore innovative approaches to long-term partnership. This conference builds upon the strong foundation laid by the 1st Pakistani–Russian International Conference, held in Karachi in February 2025, which marked a milestone in bilateral academic engagement. The inaugural conference brought together 115 presenters from Pakistan and Russia, representing more than 60 universities and think tanks, and featured active participation by diplomats, policymakers, and senior scholars. As the first large-scale academic forum of its kind, the Karachi conference successfully fostered meaningful dialogue, generated high-quality research output, and established enduring academic and institutional linkages between the two countries. By hosting the second edition in Kazan, this conference aims to deepen academic cooperation, expand research networks, and further 4 institutionalize scholarly exchange between Russia and Pakistan.

It seeks to promote a balanced, forward-looking understanding of bilateral relations, contribute to regional and global peace, and support the development of practical frameworks for cooperation in trade, energy, education, connectivity, and people-to-people engagement. Ultimately, the conference aspires to serve as a catalyst for sustained collaboration and a shared vision of prosperity, stability, and partnership between Russia and Pakistan.



Objectives

01

To analyze the global changes shaping the evolving relationship between Russia and Pakistan.

02

To examine the historical heritage foundations and contemporary dynamics of political and diplomatic relations between Russia and Pakistan.

03

To identify promising and emerging areas for deeper bilateral cooperation between Russia and Pakistan.

04

To explore future trajectories of trade, transportation, and connectivity between Russia and Pakistan.

05

To highlight Pakistan's role as a pivotal logistical and economic hub linking Russia and Central Asia with South Asia.

06

To strengthen people-to-people engagement through education, cultural diplomacy, academic exchange, and media cooperation.



Themes and Sub-Themes

We invite abstracts of research papers from scholars around the world on the theme: **The Evolving Russia–Pakistan Relationship in a Changing Global Order** Papers employing theoretical frameworks, conceptual analyses, and case studies are welcome for presentation under the following Themes and Sub-Themes:

01

Russia and Pakistan in modern International Relations in a Polycentric World (International security and cooperation, geopolitics and diplomacy, traditional and non-traditional security domains)

02

Economic Integration of Russia and Pakistan within the Eurasian Framework (Key areas of economic engagement, sectoral cooperation, trade and investment patterns, financial security issues, regional and multilateral frameworks including the Shanghai Cooperation Organization (SCO), the Eurasian Economic Union (EAEU), BRICS, and the Organization of Islamic Cooperation (OIC), as well as statistical trends and future prospects)

03

Russia and Pakistan in modern International Relations in a Polycentric World (International security and cooperation, geopolitics and diplomacy, traditional and non-traditional security domains)

Program at a Glance





Day 1

Plenary session & Youth Session

Greetings, short presentations, interactive youth discussions, and networking activities, with both in-person and online participation

Day 2

Working/ Thematic sessions

Thematic sessions, expert panel discussions, focusing on in-depth analysis and policy-oriented dialogue, both in-person and online.





Organizing Committee’s Comments

Organizing Committee's Comments

"This conference symbolizes a new chapter in Russia–Pakistan academic and strategic engagement."

Dr. Timirkhan Alishev





"The participation of diverse stakeholders enriches the dialogue and strengthens the outcomes of this initiative."

Dr. Faisal Javaid

"We believe this gathering will generate innovative ideas and practical solutions for regional and global challenges."

Dr. Rustem Chanyshev





"I extend my sincere gratitude to all participants for contributing to the success of this important academic endeavor."

Dr. Muhammad Arif Khan

"I am confident that this platform will open new avenues for research partnerships and collaborative projects."

Dr. Amir Ahmed Farooqui



Organizing Committee's Comments

"We hope the discussions here will contribute to shaping a more inclusive and multipolar global order."

Saima Azhar





"It is encouraging to witness the growing academic and policy-oriented engagement between our two countries."

Prof. Dr. Svetlana Takhtarova

"This conference builds upon the success of the inaugural event and aims to further institutionalize scholarly exchange."

Dr. Gul-i Ay-esha





"The conference serves as an important platform for fostering mutual understanding and long-term cooperation between Russia and Pakistan."

Dr. Sundus Khizar

"This conference reflects our shared commitment to strengthening Russia–Pakistan relations through academic dialogue and collaboration."

Dr. Olga Vershinina





Abstracts and Biographical Note

RUSSIA AND PAKISTAN IN THE SCO AS A FACTOR IN THE TRANSFORMATION OF THE SECURITY ARCHITECTURE IN A POLYCENTRIC WORLD

Abstract

The development of a polycentric world order is changing the usual approaches to international security, increasing the weight of regional alliances. In this context, Russia's and Pakistan's cooperation within the Shanghai Cooperation Organization takes on a special significance, as bilateral relations are gradually establishing a stable institutional foundation for security. This process aligns with the common challenges faced by the region. Additionally, it highlights the shift from fragmented negotiations to joint action. Pakistan's accession to the SCO in 2017 has significantly revitalized ties between Moscow and Islamabad. During the Cold War, the countries were on opposite sides of the geopolitical confrontation. Today, their rapprochement is based on their shared interests in maintaining stability in Central and South Asia. Within the SCO, both countries actively participate in the Regional Anti-Terrorist Structure, coordinate measures against terrorism, extremism, and separatism, exchange intelligence, and engage in joint efforts.

Biograpical Notes

Sofia Akubzhanova is a 22-year-old undergraduate student enrolled in the Department of Management at the Technological University named after Cosmonaut A.A. Leonov, a branch of the Moscow State University of Geodesy and Cartography. She is currently in her fourth year, specializing in Customs Affairs, where she has developed a solid understanding of international trade, customs regulations, and administrative practices.
In addition to her academic pursuits, Sofia is actively involved in sports, demonstrating discipline, resilience, and teamwork. She is also an avid reader, which supports her intellectual growth and broadens her perspective. Furthermore, she is passionate about learning foreign languages, reflecting her interest in global communication. Sofia is highly motivated, committed to continuous self-improvement, and aspires to build a successful professional career.



Akubzhanova Sofia Sergeevna
Department of Management, Technological University, Russia

Kapustyan Daria is a 21-year-old undergraduate student currently enrolled in the Department of Management at the Technological University named after the twice Hero of the Soviet Union Cosmonaut A.A. Leonov, a branch of the Moscow State University of Geodesy and Cartography. She is in her fourth year of study, specializing in Customs Affairs, where she has developed a strong academic foundation in international trade, customs regulations, and administrative procedures. Alongside her academic commitments, Daria actively participates in sports, demonstrating discipline, perseverance, and teamwork. She is also an enthusiastic reader, continuously expanding her knowledge and intellectual horizons. Additionally, she has a strong passion for learning foreign languages, reflecting her interest in global communication and multicultural engagement. Daria is highly motivated, dedicated to personal growth, and aspires to build a successful professional career in an international environment.



Kapustyan Daria Olegovna
Department of Management, Technological University, Russia

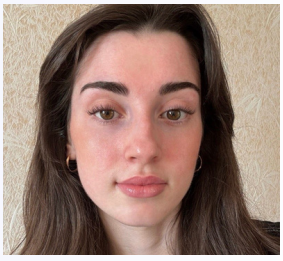
Humanitarian Logistics and Cultural Diplomacy: New Dimensions of Cooperation between Russia and Pakistan

Abstract

In the context of a transforming polycentric system of international relations, the humanitarian dimension of cooperation is acquiring a qualitatively new significance, evolving from a subsidiary aspect of foreign policy into an independent factor in the sustainability of interstate relations. Russia and Pakistan, by expanding bilateral dialogue and harnessing the potential of multilateral platforms, including the Shanghai Cooperation Organization and BRICS, are gradually forming a space of interaction in which humanitarian logistics—understood as the organizational and infrastructural support for educational, cultural, and academic exchanges—becomes an instrument of cultural diplomacy and long-term trust. The main idea is that the effective logistical organization of humanitarian flows, including student and faculty mobility, joint scientific forums, cultural festivals, and youth programs, requires not only transport connectivity, but also coordinated visa, customs, and administrative procedures that minimize barriers to cross-border interaction. By facilitating the movement of educational equipment, exhibition displays, and scientific materials, synchronizing regulatory regimes, and implementing digital project support services, the parties, acting systematically and consistently, can transform humanitarian initiatives into a sustainable channel for public diplomacy. It seems advisable to institutionalize joint educational platforms, expand Russian and Urdu language programs, and develop the training of specialists in international logistics capable of providing infrastructure support for humanitarian projects. Thus, humanitarian logistics, when integrated into a cultural diplomacy strategy, can become a link between economic and political cooperation, forming a solid foundation for intersocietal contacts and, by strengthening mutual understanding, facilitating the formation of a sustainable Russian-Pakistani partnership in the long term.

Biograpical Note

A dedicated student in the Department of Management at the Technological University named after twice Hero of the Soviet Union, pilot-cosmonaut A.A. Leonov, which operates as a branch of the Federal State Budgetary Educational Institution of Higher Education “Moscow State University of Geodesy and Cartography,” she is pursuing her academic interests with a strong commitment to excellence. Her studies focus on developing managerial skills, organizational understanding, and analytical thinking necessary for modern business environments. Alongside her academic pursuits, she demonstrates a keen interest in professional growth, interdisciplinary learning, and global perspectives in management. Motivated and goal-oriented, she actively seeks opportunities to enhance her knowledge and practical experience, preparing herself for a successful career in management and related fields.



Nino Kereselidze,
Moscow State University

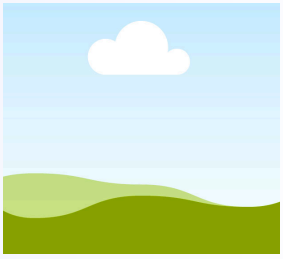
Russia and Pakistan within the BRICS

Abstract

This report examines the prospects of Pakistan's accession to BRICS+ and the chronology of the grouping's expansion, outlines Islamabad's official position, and considers the support extended by Russia and China as well as India's opposition. Attention is given to Pakistan's domestic political debate and the country's strategic significance as a transit hub at the intersection of South Asia, Central Asia and the Middle East.

Biograpical Note

Third-year student at the Financial University under the Government of the Russian Federation (Economics); Intern at the Research Center for Economic and Legal Research and Expertise.



Garmash Sofia,
Financial University under the Government of the Russian Federation

When Connectivity Fails to Deliver Trade: Digital Market Participation and Logistics Constraints in Russia–Pakistan Economic Integration

Abstract

compatibility of the infrastructure and regulatory uncertainty as a result of the sanctions on the utilization of routes through the structured survey of the participants of the logistics business of about 80-100 cross-border actors (along with targeted interviews with the experts). It examines whether logistics reliability itself serves as a mediating factor between trade decision and connectedness. Based on the trade facilitation and logistics performance models, the findings suggest that firms rationally minimize shipment frequency or avoid routes entirely when shipment delivery times cannot be predicted, border processes are unreliable, and the rules are ambiguous, regardless of the presence of the routes. Drawing scale-based evidence at the firm level, it refocuses the attention on infrastructure expansion and the performance and coordination of corridors, and it outlines the policy priorities in the cooperation of customs and trade facilitation, as well as the governance of corridors needed to promote sustainable Russia-Pakistan economic integration.

Biograpical Notes

Sarmad is a Master's student in Business Development at HSE University, Nizhny Novgorod. As an E-commerce and Digital Marketing Strategist, he develops revenue-focused online systems for global clients, specializing in user-centric storefronts, GA4/GTM tracking, and data-driven SEO/CRO programs. His diverse background bridges applied computer science and management. He previously contributed to high-performance computing research involving GPU-accelerated MRI processing and has experience teaching both computer science and business. This technical foundation allows him to seamlessly translate complex systems into commercial outcomes. His research interests include practical machine learning in digital commerce, graph-based fraud detection, recommender systems, and digital transformation in emerging markets. Through his international academic engagement, he aims to develop impact-oriented solutions that link technological innovation with sustainable socio-economic development.



Malik Muhammad Sarmad,
HSE University,
Nizhny Novgorod

An analysis of the current state of the crypto industry and the potential for cooperation between Russia and Pakistan

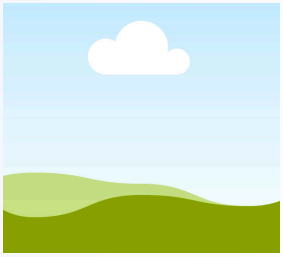
Abstract

Cryptocurrencies, thanks to their ideological and technological foundation, are developing in a decentralized manner, bringing together individuals in an ecosystem seeking effective solutions to their problems using new technologies. This gives rise to new financial instruments, data storage platforms, and distributed networks for tracking logistics and the authenticity of goods. Scaling processes requires a legal framework capable of covering all types of activities present in the country. The problem arises when government agencies limit themselves to planning legislation only within the country, as digital technologies operate internationally. It is necessary to synchronize the legal framework between countries seeking to collaborate in various economic sectors that utilize cryptocurrencies in their activities. This article examines: The current legal reality in Russia and Pakistan, including which authorities are responsible for regulating and managing the markets where cryptocurrencies are used. It is necessary to review draft laws and current legislation, and where the definitions and general rules for working with cryptocurrencies converge and diverge.

The state of the cryptocurrency market in each country, which projects are being created to address current societal problems, and opportunities for collaboration between these projects. An analysis of the strengths and weaknesses of each country is needed to identify the most effective collaborations between projects. An opportunity for cooperation within legal, academic, and corporate frameworks to strengthen ties between countries and promote domestic solutions in the crypto sphere. The goal of this work is to describe the common reality in each country and propose the best paths for further development to avoid lagging behind international trends and to bring national projects and governing bodies closer together, increasing their effectiveness both locally and internationally. Reports and articles may be submitted in either Russian or English; this will be subject to the conference organizers' approval.

Biograpical Note

Daniel Rivero Padilla, a third-year PhD student in economic theory at Ufa University of Science and Technology (UFUIT). Cryptocurrency analyst at SHARD.



Rivero Padilla Daniel,
Ufa University of Science and Technology (UFUIT)

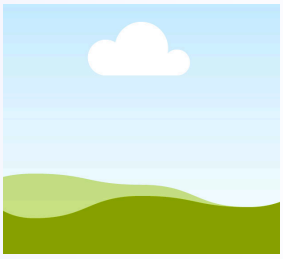
Institutional Foundations and Strategic Directions of Economic Integration between Russia and Pakistan within Eurasian Cooperation: Models of Trade and Investment Cooperation

Abstract

This article examines the institutional foundations and strategic trajectories of economic integration between the Russian Federation and the Islamic Republic of Pakistan within the broader context of Eurasian cooperation. Despite a historically modest economic relationship, recent geopolitical shifts and mutual strategic interests have catalyzed a renewed impetus for bilateral engagement. This paper analyzes the evolving models of trade and investment cooperation, moving beyond ad-hoc interactions toward a more structured partnership. It investigates the core drivers of integration, including energy complementarity, infrastructure development, and shared aspirations for a multipolar world order. Concurrently, it identifies critical institutional deficits, such as the absence of a Bilateral Investment Treaty (BIT) and the disruptive impact of Western sanctions, which impede progress. By examining flagship projects like the Pakistan Stream gas pipeline and railway modernization initiatives, the article assesses the efficacy of existing institutional mechanisms, including the Intergovernmental Commission (IGC). The findings suggest that while a strong political foundation exists, translating this into substantial economic integration requires the creation of resilient financial architectures, harmonized legal frameworks, and the successful implementation of pilot projects to build trust and demonstrate viability.

Biograpical Note

Student at Moscow Polytechnic University, Faculty of International Business and Foreign Economic



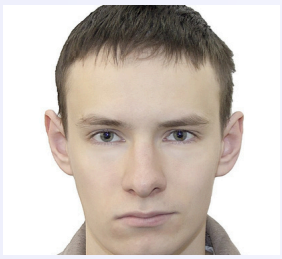
Margarita Aleksandrovna Matuz,
Moscow Polytechnic University, Faculty of International Business and Foreign Economic

Cooperation between Russia and Pakistan in IT sector

Abstract

The report examines the current state of Russian-Pakistani relations in IT, as well as the prospects for developing ties in this sector. The importance of the IT sector is determined by the characteristic features of the modern information age. In light of new threats and methods of public administration, IT plays a decisive role for states, especially in the context of the emergence of new ways of conducting public administration. Russia is actively working to ensure digital sovereignty, and the national project "Data Economy and Digital Transformation of the State" is underway. In the context of the Special Military Operation (SVO), Russia has faced unprecedented hacker attacks, which has required a revision of cybersecurity mechanisms. Currently, Russia possesses unique experience in ensuring information security. AI is being actively developed, and Russia is the initiator of the creation of the International Alliance in the field of AI — a platform for international dialogue in a rapidly developing but also risk-laden area. Pakistan is an important regional player in the IT sector. There are a number of innovative initiatives: Pakistan e-Rozgaar, the National Incubation Center, the Pakistan Software Export Board, and others. The export of IT services, which reached US $2.4 billion in 2022, plays an important role in the country's socio-economic development. The IT sector is a promising area for Russian-Pakistani relations. On October 15, the first meeting of the Russian-Pakistani Joint Working Group on Information and Communication Cooperation took place, which demonstrates the relevance of this direction. Information and communication technologies are also in the focus of the Business Association for Cooperation with Pakistan (BACP). The issue of cooperation in IT was also discussed during the 10th meeting of the Russian-Pakistani Intergovernmental Commission. Given the shortage of skilled labour in the Russian economy, Pakistan could become an important IT outsourcing hub for Russian companies. An educational track could also be an important area of cooperation. Dialogue should be the basis of cooperation, and mutual participation in various forums can help achieve that. One stage of experience exchange could be the use of digital platforms for state-society interaction: Russia has a number of services (Gosuslugi, the Max messenger) that allow the state to stay in contact with citizens. In Pakistan, an important service is Pakistan e-Rozgaar, which deals with employment issues. Thus, both Moscow and Islamabad have unique experience that they can share with each other.

Biograpical Note



Timofey Pavlovich Shirokov,
MGIMO University

The author is a student at the Faculty of International Relations at MGIMO, enrolled in the “Diplomacy and Foreign Policy (India)” program, where he studies Urdu, Hindi, and Chinese. He is a two-time winner of the analytical paper competition at the “IR Week” student research festival, with work focusing on Indo-Pakistani and Afghan-Pakistani relations. He has completed an internship at MGIMO’s Institute of International Studies and has actively participated in Model United Nations programs as a top delegate and expert. His academic achievements include awards in multiple school Olympiads and recognition as a finalist in the “I Am a Professional” student Olympiad. He has participated in various academic conferences, including “Dubyansky Readings” and “Ex Oriente Lux,” and is a member of the Indo-Iranian Club and the Historical Club “Kassiodor.” His interests include diplomacy, regional studies, and digital culture in Eurasian contexts.

Academic mobility as Micro-Foundation of Science Diplomacy: The Scientific image of Russia among Pakistani Students in Russia

Abstract

This study insights about the micro-foundations of science diplomacy,investigates to what extent the academic mobility affects the perceptions of Pakistani students about Russia's scientific image. Previous research conducted on the international students studying in Russia has more focused on Russia's general image,about demography and socio-cultural stereotypes,showing very little attention about experiences in Russia's Scientific and tech institutions build trust, Scientific reputation and projections for future collaboration.Based on soft power theory and contemporary science diplomacy frameworks, study provides the context of educational mobility as a bridge to science diplomacy, where students are more socially exposed into scientific societies within the parent host institutions. The primary focus groups consist of Pakistani students enrolled in STEM programs (Bachelor's/Master's/PhD in the fields of Engineering,Management, Natural Sciences and Technology, etc). A cross-sectional design uses structured surveys and semi-structured interviews. Perceptions are operationalized through cognitive,affective and behavioral matrix: cognitive dimensions include Scientific ability of Russia, research environment. Affective dimensions include institutional trust.Behavioral dimensions include future cooperation in academia and knowledge sharing. Exposure variables include time span of stay, Level of study , Program specialization, research activities, language proficiency, and interaction with Russian peers. Data from a homogenous sample across two universities including Higher School of Economics (HSE) and RUDN University allow for comparative analysis of institutional environmental impacts. By linking measurable changes in impression to concrete academic exchange experiences, this study provides empirical evidence on how academic mobility serves as a practical pathway of science diplomacy between Russia and Pakistan relations. The study underscores the need for a more deliberate implementation of science diplomacy approaches within an integrated framework, positioning academic mobility as a cornerstone of "broader science diplomacy." It also highlights the variability of the "scientific" dimension in Pakistani students' perceptions of Russia and points to the importance of developing strategies to strengthen this image by creating attractive mechanisms that encourage continued engagement with Russia's scientific ecosystem. This issue could serve as a focus for further research.

Biograpical Note

Muhammad Abdullah Tariq is a first-year Master's student at the Higher School of Economics (HSE), Moscow, pursuing a degree in Science, Technology, and Innovation Management and Policy on a fully funded scholarship. He completed his Bachelor's degree in 2025 from the National Defence University (NDU), Islamabad, in the Department of Government and Public Policy. His academic interests lie at the intersection of governance, innovation, and technology-driven development, with a particular focus on how public institutions adapt to emerging technological transformations. He has contributed to policy discourse through a published policy paper at the National School of Public Policy, Lahore, where his work engaged with issues of public policy and institutional development. Through his academic and research pursuits, he aims to explore how innovation policy can strengthen governance frameworks and support sustainable development in rapidly evolving global and national contexts.



Muhammad Abdullah Tariq,
Higher School of Economics (HSE), Moscow

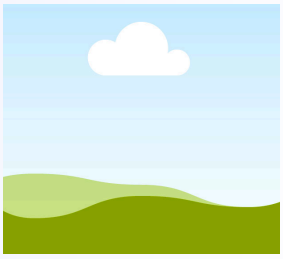
Leadership Styles and Their Differential Impact on School Climate: Evidence from Baluchistan, Pakistan

Abstract

School climate is the overall environment of the school, which consists of the physical, social, and psychological dimensions. It is the essential element of learning. It can be made positive by the continuous efforts of students, teachers, and principals, but the principals' role in this regard is considered very crucial because they direct and control the activities within the school. The objectives of this study were to identify the leadership styles of the principals and their effect on school climate. It was a quantitative study. The Multifactor Leadership Questionnaire MLQ and Delaware School Climate Survey (DSCS-student version) were used in this regard. A multistage sampling technique was employed, and the data were collected and analyzed. A simple linear regression was applied to determine the effect of three different leadership styles on various dimensions of school climate. Among the three leadership styles, the transformational leadership demonstrated the highest mean score (M = 83.98), followed by transactional leadership (M = 36.50), whereas laissez-faire leadership showed the lowest mean score (M = 6.51). These results suggest that, overall, participants' perceived school leaders as demonstrating more transformational behaviors compared to the other leadership styles. Furthermore, the data revealed that only the transformational leadership style has a strong, positive, significant effect on various dimensions such as students-student relations, teacher-student relations, clarity of expectations, and school safety. A moderate to strong positive effect was observed on student school engagement and fairness of rules but a negative effect was found on bullying school-wide, indicating that this leadership style decreases bullying in the school. The transactional leadership style showed mixed outcomes while the laissez faire demonstrated a negative effect on these dimensions. This study has implications for the principals and policymakers to adopt transformational leadership styles in schools.

Biograpical Note

Seema Azeem is a third-year PhD candidate at the Institute of Education, Higher School of Economics, Moscow, Russia, and serves as a Lecturer in Baluchistan, Pakistan. Her research centers on school climate, with particular attention to the psychological and social dimensions of schooling as experienced by principals, teachers, and students. She examines how different leadership styles shape institutional culture, student well-being, and behavioral outcomes within diverse and often under-resourced contexts. Through her work, Seema seeks to generate evidence-based insights that inform leadership practices and contribute to more inclusive and supportive school environments. She is especially interested in understanding how leadership can foster safety, relationships between different stakeholders of the school and academic resilience. Her engagement in international conferences reflects her commitment to scholarly dialogue, comparative perspectives, and collaborative research aimed at strengthening educational leadership and school climate globally.



Seema Azeem,
Institute of Education, Higher School of Economics, Moscow, Russia

The Role of Balochistan in Strengthening Russia–Pakistan Relations in a Changing Global Order

Abstract

This article argues how the province of Balochistan might influence and possibly strengthen Russia-Pakistan relations in the context of the changing global order, being multipolar, geoeconomically competitive and rebalancing regional alliances. This paper frames Balochistan as a sub-state strategic space whose geographical position, sea-access, and the infrastructure of corridors, makes it a possible nexus between the Eurasian orientation of Russia and the connectivity goals of Pakistan. The study uses a geoeconomic statecraft model combined with Regional Security Complex Theory (RSCT) to discuss the ways in which infrastructure development, energy transit corridors and port expansion in Balochistan are connected to regional security interdependence patterns. It analyzes the future of Russian involvement in energy pipelines, modernization of ports and linkage of North and South transportation between Russia and Central Asia to the Arabian Sea via Pakistan. At the same time, it evaluates the nature of securitization, governance limitations and insurgency, vulnerabilities in Balochistan that predetermines the viability and sustainability of such collaboration. The paper claims that Balochistan is a strategically important, but structurally weak point in the broader Eurasian security system. Although geopolitical factors, such as the long-term strategic alliance between Russia and India, sanctions regimes and the general rivalry between the great powers, do not provide an avenue to the formal alliance, the project based geoeconomic cooperation in Balochistan provides a viable route to gradual rapprochement. This paper concludes that the potential of the province to enable long-lasting Russia-Pakistan relations is conditional on how internal stabilization interacts with calculated desecuritization as well as alignment of strategies of Eurasia connectivity in a progressively elastic multipolar order.

Biograpical Note

Hidayat Ullah holds an M.A. in International Relations from the University of Karachi and is currently pursuing a Master's degree in Comparative Politics of Eurasia at the Higher School of Economics, Saint Petersburg, Russia. He has served as Visiting Faculty at the Department of International Relations, University of Karachi, where he taught courses such as International Relations, Global Issues, and Comparative Politics. His teaching experience reflects a strong commitment to academic engagement and student development. His research interests lie in international politics, Eurasian regional dynamics, and comparative political systems, with a particular focus on evolving geopolitical trends and cross-regional interactions. Through both teaching and research, he aims to contribute to a deeper understanding of global political processes and regional transformations. His academic work bridges theoretical perspectives with contemporary political developments, positioning him as an emerging scholar in the field of comparative politics and international relations.



Hidayat Ullah,
Higher School of Economics, Saint Petersburg, Russia

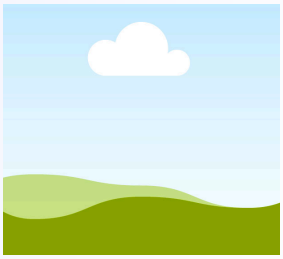
Cross-Border SME Cooperation between Pakistan and Russia: A Conceptual and Comparative Analysis

Abstract

The contribution of Small and Medium Enterprises (SMEs) in national economy is evident, as this sector consists of approximately 3.2 million enterprises in Pakistan, accounting for approximately 40% of the total GDP. Meanwhile, 6 million SMEs in Russia contribute around 22.3% to the GDP. This study elaborates on the strengths, weaknesses, opportunities, challenges, and operational framework of SME cross-border partnerships between Russia and Pakistan, including insufficient institutional support, financial constraints, limited R&D, and regional conflicts. Pakistan-Russia economic relations are expanding through frameworks such as the Shanghai Cooperation Organization and ISTC, which largely focus on trade flows, energy, and corridors. However, limited studies have been conducted on the operational role of SMEs as a key future driver of economic integration. Today, economic collaboration is export-oriented; however, the SME-to-SME sector needs attention. Additionally, this collaboration lacks policy support, government-backed institutional mechanisms, and operational frameworks, including joint chambers of commerce at the regional level and knowledge incubators. The method adapted in this study is qualitative and uses a conceptual framework centered on government-backed support and centralized coordination channels at the regional level. Additionally, a comparative analysis in the context of Pak-China collaboration is discussed as a reference case to drive the framework for Pakistan-Russia economic integration. In the future, the implementation of a policy-integrated framework and network-oriented collaborations can strengthen SME-oriented partnerships between both countries and foster an entrepreneurial culture that plays a significant role in regional economic integration.

Biograpical Note

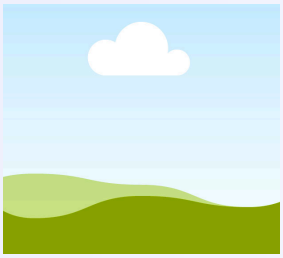
Tatheer Fatima Isphani is a dynamic and driven professional currently pursuing a Master's degree in Business Development at the Higher School of Economics (HSE). With a strong academic foundation and a passion for strategic growth, she actively contributes to student leadership and community engagement initiatives. Tatheer serves as an IFC Ambassador and holds the position of Assistant Head within the CISA at HSE, where she plays a key role in fostering collaboration and organizational development. Professionally, she has gained valuable experience as a Social Media Analyst for the PACS region at VMLY&R, working on globally recognized brands such as Coca-Cola and Coke Studio. Her expertise lies in digital strategy, audience engagement, and data-driven content optimization. Combining analytical insight with creative thinking, Tatheer is committed to driving impactful business solutions and meaningful brand narratives in an increasingly digital world.



Tatheer Fatima Isphani,
Business Development at the Higher School of Economics (HSE)

Biograpical Note

Danial Nawaz is a Master's candidate in Business Development at the Higher School of Economics (HSE), where he is actively engaged in student leadership through his role in community engagement within the Student Council. With a strong professional foundation, Danial brings over five years of experience in the real estate industry, having worked with leading firms such as Graana and Zameen. His expertise lies in sales, client success, and business development, where he has consistently demonstrated the ability to build lasting client relationships and drive growth initiatives. Danial combines practical industry experience with academic insight to approach business challenges with a strategic and results-oriented mindset. Passionate about community building and professional development, he continues to expand his skill set while contributing meaningfully to both academic and professional environments.



Danial Nawaz,
Business Development at the Higher School of Economics (HSE)

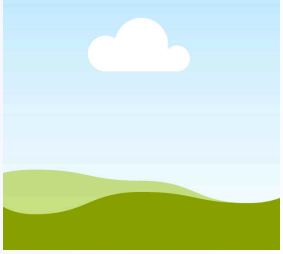
Humanitarian Diplomacy and Soft Power in Russia–Pakistan Relations After 2022: Educational and Cultural Linkages in a Multipolar World

Abstract

This paper studies how Russia and Pakistan are strengthening their relations through education, language, and cultural cooperation after 2022. Instead of focusing only on geopolitics, this research looks at humanitarian diplomacy and soft power. I am a Pakistani student currently studying in Moscow at the Higher School of Economics, and my personal experience helps me understand how academic exchange and cultural contact shape mutual perceptions. The study focuses on four main areas: academic exchange programs, Russian language education in Pakistan, youth and student diplomacy, and cultural activities organized by embassies and cultural centers. The paper uses publicly available data such as official scholarship announcements, university partnership agreements, embassy press releases, and media coverage from both countries. It also reviews cooperation between universities, student mobility trends, and participation in cultural forums. The research applies the concept of soft power to examine how education and culture create long-term influence and trust between Russia and Pakistan. Instead of looking at power in military or economic terms, the study focuses on attraction, shared values, and mutual understanding. Educational exchange with scholarships, language programs and youth forums help shape how young people see each other's countries. Over time, these experiences can build professional networks and emotional connections that support bilateral relations. The paper also uses basic discourse analysis to study how ideas such as "multipolar world," "sovereignty," "strategic partnership," and "civilizational dialogue" appear in official speeches and embassy publications. By examining the language used by policymakers and institutions, the research explores how both countries present their cooperation to domestic and international audiences. The paper argues that after 2022, humanitarian cooperation has become more visible and strategically important in Russia–Pakistan relations. Educational exchange and language programs are not only academic tools but also instruments for building stable and positive relations in a changing global order. By focusing on people-to-people ties, this research highlights an area of cooperation that is practical, growing, and still not widely studied.

Biograpical Note

Farheen Siddique is currently a Master's student and researcher in Intercultural Communication and Foreign Languages at the Higher School of Economics (HSE), Moscow, Russian Federation. Their academic work focuses on intercultural communication, the intersection of language and culture in international relations, and the role of linguistic and cultural factors in shaping people-to-people connections. Their research specifically examines intercultural dialogue, cultural perceptions, and communication challenges in Russia–Pakistan relations, with an emphasis on humanitarian cooperation, education, and academic exchange. Adopting an interdisciplinary approach, the author draws on communication studies, language studies, and international relations to analyze contemporary global interactions.



Farheen Siddique,
Higher School of Economics (HSE), Moscow, Russian Federation

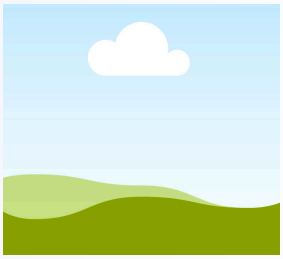
Pharmaceutical Geo-economics in a Multipolar World: Pakistan–Russia Cooperation and Emerging Healthcare Corridors Across Eurasia

Abstract

The paper will discuss how pharmaceutical collaboration between Pakistan and Russia is being re-organized in the environment of multipolarity, financial fragmentation via sanctions, and securitization of medical supply chains, and that such pressures are likely to be contributing to the emergence of Eurasian health care corridors gradually that is integrating manufacturing, regulation, logistics, and market access in Russia, Central Asia, and South Asia. Current literature is inclined to consider pharmaceutical industrial policy, export upgrading and regional connectedness as independent realms, therefore, it fails to explain the firm-level processes by which the corridor-like terms are formed as commercial strategy is transformed by regulatory harmonization, localization incentives and geopolitical risk. This gap is addressed in the study by posing the question of how the pharmaceutical relation between Pakistan and Russia is operationalized in practice, what drives the firms to enter into partnerships and market access in the changing Eurasian regulatory frameworks, why Central Asian jurisdictions are now viewed as interim production or distribution sites and how the participants cope with compliance, transaction frictions and continuity of supplies amidst the competing geo-economic regimes. The article uses a qualitative research design (semi-structured expert interview) of pharmaceutical manufacturers, export managers, regulatory affairs specialists, distributors, joint-venture executives, and investment or industrial-zone stakeholders in Pakistan, Russia/EAEU-facing markets, and the selected Central Asian economies with the supplementary use of documentary research of regulatory and industrial policy frameworks. The analysis of interview and documentary data is conducted by using iterative thematic coding to detect repeat decision logics and mechanisms of building corridors. The article proposes that the formation of corridors is the result not of a bilateral initiative but rather of the coordination of incentives between states: Russian localization and procurement systems, the Pakistani diversified regulated-market strategies and Central Asian platform strategies are mechanism to give rise to new models of partnership, new practices of regulatory navigation, and new paths of logistics access, which combine in a cumulative way to create an emerging architecture of corridors in healthcare.

Biograpical Note

Syed Danyal Hussain is currently pursuing a Master's degree in Science, Technology, and Innovation Management and Policy at the Higher School of Economics (HSE), Moscow. His academic interests center on innovation policy, the application of artificial intelligence in educational settings, and the geoeconomic dimensions of the pharmaceutical industry in Eurasia. Professionally, he works in clinical research regulatory affairs in accordance with the requirements of the Drug Regulatory Authority of Pakistan (DRAP), focusing on regulatory compliance, clinical study documentation, and market access procedures. His work reflects a strong engagement with the regulatory frameworks shaping healthcare systems. His research explores the intersection of regulation, geopolitics, and industrial strategy in emerging healthcare ecosystems. At this conference, he presents findings on the geoeconomics of pharmaceuticals, the development of healthcare spaces in Eurasia, and the evolving dynamics of Pakistan–Russia cooperation in a multipolar economy and shifting global supply chains.



Syed Danyal Hussain,
Higher School of Economics (HSE), Moscow

Ethical Literary Criticism of Discourses Across Civilizations: A Comparative Analysis of Leo Tolstoy and Ashfaq Ahmed's Selected Works

Abstract

This study explores ethical discourses in Russian and Pakistani literature as a bridge for cross-cultural dialogue, employing Nie Zhenzhao's Ethical Literary Criticism (2023) as it's theoretical framework. Ethical Literary Criticism posits literature as records of human moral experiences, structured by ethical knots (moral dilemmas), ethical lines (narrative progressions of ethical choices), and ethical selection (choosing moral reason over animal instincts). By applying this lens, the paper compares Leo Tolstoy's short story "How Much Land Does a Man Need?" (1886) and selected texts from Ashfaq Ahmed's drama "Mann Chalay Ka Sauda" (1970s), highlighting shared themes of material greed for spiritual and moral fulfillment. In Tolstoy's narrative, the protagonist's insatiable desire for land forms the central ethical knot, a conflict between human ambition (animal factor) and moral restraint. His ethical line unfolds through escalating acquisitions, culminating in his fatal overreach during a land-walking challenge, where he dies exhausted, needing only six feet for burial. This illustrates ethical selection that protagonist's preference to greed over morality leads to self-destruction, echoing Tolstoy's Christian humanism on contentment and non-possession. On the other hand, Ahmed's text delves into existential sorrow as humanity's "basic tragedy," questioning life's purpose beyond wealth, honor, and luxury. The ethical knot emerges in the awakening from material satisfaction to metaphysical inquiry; why one exists, suffers, and dies, and whether justice awaits. The ethical line traces a phenomenological journey toward spiritual consciousness, urging ethical selection by rejecting superficial pursuits for deeper self-realization, rooted in Sufi-influenced Pakistani culture. By using qualitative approach for this comparative analysis, the study reveals dialogic parallels: both works reconstruct ethical order by warning against animal instincts (greed, complacency) in favor of moral humans pursuing transcendence. This research strengthens Russia-Pakistan humanitarian ties by highlighting literature's capacity to bridge shared values and offer vital lessons for ethical progress in a polycentric world.

Biograpical Note

Haadia Haseeb is a 22-year-old multilingual scholar and a Master's candidate in Foreign Languages and Intercultural Communication at the National Research University–Higher School of Economics (Moscow, Russia), where she studies on a full academic scholarship. She holds a Bachelor's degree (Honours) in English Literature from the University of Management and Technology (Sialkot, Pakistan), graduating with multiple Merit Awards in recognition of her academic excellence. An active and dedicated researcher, Haadia's academic interests span world literatures, linguistics, philosophy, semiotics, and cultural studies. She has presented her research at numerous international conferences across Pakistan, the State of Azad Jammu and Kashmir, Malaysia, China, and Russia, reflecting her strong engagement with global academic discourse. With a passion for interdisciplinary inquiry and cross-cultural understanding, Haadia continues to contribute thoughtfully to the evolving landscape of humanities research.



Haadia Haseeb,
National Research University–Higher School of Economics (Moscow, Russia)

Drivers of Russia-Pakistan Rapprochement: Testing Theories of International Cooperation

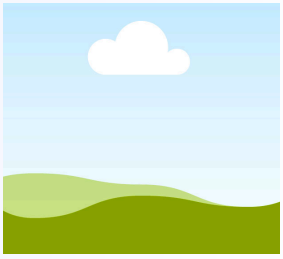
Abstract

Pakistan has adapted its foreign policy in accordance with new geopolitical dynamics and a desire to reduce its dependency on the US. This has motivated Pakistan to seek economic partnerships in the Eurasian region, particularly through efforts to strengthen ties with Russia via bilateral relations and regional frameworks such as the Eurasian Economic Union (EAEU) and the Shanghai Cooperation Organization (SCO). This study aims to investigate the drivers of the Russia-Pakistan rapprochement. It addresses two fundamental questions: first, which theories of international relations explain the course of Russia-Pakistan relations? Second, what are the potential outcomes for the region from the strengthening of Russia-Pakistan ties? This study employs a qualitative approach to assess the motives behind the Russia-Pakistan reorientation through the lens of enduring theories of international relations. It uses realism to explore fundamental factors such as Pakistan's diversification away from the US and Russia's efforts to neutralize Western sanctions. It applies liberalism to examine Pakistan's gradual foreign policy shift and its increased engagement in regional economic and political partnerships such as the EAEU and the SCO. Furthermore, it draws on constructivism to understand the mutual narratives of both countries on multipolarity and the strengthening of Global South camaraderie.

This research is based on primary sources including official documents from the governments of Russia and Pakistan, reports released by the Eurasian Economic Commission, statements issued by the Shanghai Cooperation Organization, and bilateral trade data between Russia and Pakistan. This study also take leverage from secondary sources such as academic articles and reports by Russian and Pakistani scholars and their respective institutions. Prefatory findings reveal that all three theories elaborate different motives for the rapprochement of Russia and Pakistan. Realism stresses geopolitical pressures, liberalism draws on institutional engagement, while constructivism highlights the role of the ideational world. The significance of this study is that it helps us understand the complex nature of Russia-Pakistan realignment, which has been accelerated by multiple realities of the contemporary period.

Biograpical Note

Maryam Anwar holds a Bachelor's degree in International Relations from the Federal Urdu University of Arts, Science and Technology (FUUAST), Karachi. She is currently pursuing a Master's degree in Eurasian Integration at Tomsk State University, Russia, where she focuses on regional dynamics and evolving geopolitical trends.Her academic interests include geopolitics, Russia–Pakistan relations, and regional integration processes across Eurasia. She is particularly interested in connectivity frameworks such as the China–Pakistan Economic Corridor (CPEC) and multilateral platforms like the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation (SCO), examining their role in shaping regional cooperation and economic interdependence.Her research reflects a broader engagement with the emerging partnership between Russia and Pakistan within a multipolar global order. Through her academic work, she aims to contribute to a deeper understanding of regional connectivity, strategic cooperation, and the shifting balance of power in Eurasia.



Maryam Anwar,
Federal Urdu University of Arts, Science and Technology

People, Culture, and Economy: Reimagining Pakistan–Russia Relations Through Societal Linkages

Abstract

This study presents a rational reinterpretation of Pakistan-Russia relationship through the lens of people centered culture and socio-economic linkages evading the discussion of cliched state-centric geopolitics. This paper discusses the foundation for sustainable and resilient bilateral cooperation lies in societal connectivity which no one has explored deeply. This study carries out chronological analysis through the comparison of the Pre-Soviet and Post-Soviet interactions and evaluates the evolvement of cultural narratives from the early Silk Route exchanges to contemporary engagements via education, migration and trade. This comparison uncovered the reality of their relationship overshadowed by intricate geopolitical realities. This study is grounded in the theory of constructivism and advocates the complex interdependence theory. This study further demonstrates Russia's Pivot to Asia in the contemporary epoch and multi-layered engagement through cultural diplomacy between both nations. This study is set to examine the two central questions comprehensively: First, how have the Pre-Soviet to Post-Soviet eras shaped contemporary people-to-people, cultural, and economic interactions between Pakistan and Russia? Second, Do Cultural diplomacy, educational exchanges, diaspora network and creatives serve as real catalyst for consolidating Pakistan-Russia economic and diplomatic collaboration? What are the unidentified gaps between both countries responsible for gradual or short-lived collaboration? This study employs a mix-method approach, it combines both qualitative and quantitative for socio-economic indicators and trade diversification. Overall, this study introduces a rational framework to understand Pakistan-Russia relationship in multifaceted aspects.

Biograpical Note

Nuzhat Tariq holds a Bachelor's degree in International Relations from the Federal Urdu University of Arts, Science and Technology (FUUAST), Karachi. She has actively presented her academic work at several prominent national and international conferences, demonstrating strong engagement with scholarly discourse. Her research interests include populism in South Asia, Eurasian integration, and regional connectivity, with a particular focus on the evolving geopolitical role of the Global South. She is currently pursuing a Master's degree in Eurasian Integration at Tomsk State University, Russian Federation, where her graduate research examines interregional cooperation between Eurasia and South Asia. In addition to her academic pursuits, she is the Founding Editor of Politic Vista, the first student-led e-magazine at her institution, reflecting her commitment to academic dialogue, research dissemination, and student-led intellectual initiatives in the field of international relations



Nuzhat Tariq,
Tomsk State University, Russian Federation

Soviet-Era Development Cooperation in Pakistan and Its Relevance in the Emerging Multipolar Order

Abstract

While the Cold War is often remembered for the rivalry between US and USSR, it also featured lesser-known episodes of developmental cooperation between the Soviet Union and American allies. This paper examines the history of Soviet development assistance to Pakistan, focusing on flagship projects such as the Pakistan Steel Mills, the Guddu and Muzaffargarh thermal power stations, and Soviet-assisted oil and gas exploration. Against the backdrop of a shifting global order from Cold War bipolarity to unipolarity and now to an emerging multipolar system this paper asks: What relevance do these historical projects hold for the contemporary Pakistan-Russia relationship? Employing a geo-economic theoretical framework, the paper argues that these Soviet-era projects serve three critical functions today. First, they provide a foundational infrastructural memory and technical legacy that lowers the transaction costs of renewed cooperation. Second, they act as a diplomatic reservoir of goodwill, allowing current leaders to frame new deals, such as the Pakistan Stream Gas Pipeline as a revival of a pragmatic, rather than ideological, partnership. Finally, they offer a strategic counter-narrative to the exclusively Western-centric history of Pakistan's industrialization, legitimizing diversification toward Moscow in a multipolar context. The paper concludes that while historical mistrust from the Soviet-Afghan War era remains a constraint, the physical and symbolic capital of Soviet-era cooperation is a unique and underutilized asset in the current geopolitical realignment.

Biograpical Note

Sanjay Kumar is a Master's student in International Relations at the National Research Tomsk State University, Russia. He holds a Bachelor's degree in International Relations from the Federal Urdu University, Karachi. His academic work focuses on Russia, Central Asia, and Pakistan, reflecting a strong engagement with regional geopolitics and international dynamics. He has presented research papers and posters at several international forums, including the First Pakistani–Russian International Conference and the First Eurasian Congress of Linguists in Moscow. His notable work explores themes such as Russia's "Pivot to Asia," the legacy of Peter the Great, and the linguistic landscape of Pakistan. Beyond research, he has significant experience in academic organizing for major international conferences and has served as Head of Assistant Editors for Politico Vista magazine. His professional interests include policy development, cross-cultural engagement, and evolving geopolitical relations across Eurasia and South Asia.



Sanjay Kumar,
National Research Tomsk State University, Russia

Counterterrorism and Regional Stability: Russia-Pakistan Coordination within the SCO Architecture

Abstract

This paper explores how Russia and Pakistan use the institutional framework of the Shanghai Cooperation Organization (SCO) to advance common counterterrorism objectives and promote regional stability in Eurasia. Situated at the crossroads of Central and South Asia, the two states face overlapping security challenges, including international terrorism, extremism, drug trafficking, and the spillover effects of instability in Afghanistan. The central research question guiding this study is: To what extent has SCO membership enabled meaningful Russia-Pakistan security coordination, and what are the limits of this cooperation.? The paper adopts a qualitative, case study approach. It examines key SCO documents, joint declarations, and summit messages, with a particular focus on the activities of the Regional Anti-Terrorism Structure (RATS). It also analyzes joint military exercises, intelligence-sharing practices, and capacity-building initiatives involving Moscow and Islamabad under the Shanghai Cooperation Organization. The paper argues that the SCO has provided Moscow and Islamabad with a useful multilateral platform for institutionalizing dialogue, building confidence, and conducting joint counterterrorism engagements that would be politically more sensitive in a purely bilateral format. At the same time, their coordination is limited by broader geopolitical rivalries, divergent security priorities, and a long-standing deficit in mutual trust. The analysis shows that, although SCO-based mechanisms have not transformed the security landscape, they have contributed significantly to regional stability by fostering habits of cooperation and creating channels for crisis communication. The paper concludes with an outline of policy recommendations for strengthening Russia-Pakistan cooperation within the Shanghai Cooperation Organization, including closer engagement with RATS, more frequent and specialized joint exercises, and better coordination on security measures related to Afghanistan.

Biograpical Note

Saif Ur Rehman is a Master's student in International Relations at the National Research Tomsk State University. He has actively participated in several national and international academic conferences, including the First and Second Pakistani–Polish International Conferences and the First Russian International Conference. His recent research paper, titled "Trade Substitution in a Fragmented World: EU's China Derisking vs. Russia's Pivot to Asia – Where Does Pakistan Fit?", examines evolving Eurasian economic dynamics and global trade realignments. Alongside his academic work, he has contributed as a dedicated volunteer in various scholarly and academic initiatives, demonstrating a strong commitment to research and professional development. His research interests include Eurasian integration, Russia–Pakistan relations, regional security frameworks such as the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation (SCO), and counter-terrorism cooperation. Through his work, he aims to contribute to a deeper understanding of regional connectivity and emerging geopolitical trends.



Saif Ur Rehman
National Research Tomsk State University

The Evolution of Diplomatic Engagement between Moscow and Islamabad: Strategic Convergence in a Multipolar Eurasia

Abstract

This study examines the gradual transformation of diplomatic relations between Russia and Pakistan from Cold War estrangement to pragmatic engagement in the twenty-first century. For decades, Moscow and Islamabad remained on opposing sides of the global ideological divide, limiting meaningful political cooperation. However, shifting regional realities and changes in the international system have encouraged both states to reassess and gradually redefine their bilateral relationship. The study explores the key drivers behind this evolution, including emerging security concerns in South and Central Asia, the pursuit of strategic diversification, and expanding dialogue in defense, energy, and regional connectivity. It also considers the role of multilateral platforms, particularly the Shanghai Cooperation Organization, in facilitating structured and sustained diplomatic engagement. Rather than interpreting this development as a formal alliance or ideological shift, the study argues that growing Moscow–Islamabad interaction reflects a pragmatic, interest-based adjustment shaped by the realities of an increasingly multipolar world. By situating bilateral diplomacy within broader Eurasian geopolitical changes, the research highlights how both countries are adapting their foreign policy priorities in response to evolving power balances and regional challenges. The study concludes that the evolving Russia–Pakistan relationship reflects a broader structural adjustment in South–Central Asian politics, where pragmatic and interest-driven partnerships are increasingly shaping regional diplomacy in a multipolar era, with potential long-term implications for regional stability.

Biograpical Note

Abdul Malik is a Master's student in International Relations (European Union Studies) at the National Research Tomsk State University. He has actively participated in several national and international academic conferences, including the First and Second Pakistani–Polish International Conferences, as well as the First and Second Russian International Conferences. His recent research paper, titled "Trade Substitution in a Fragmented World: EU's China Derisking vs. Russia's Pivot to Asia – Where Does Pakistan Fit?", reflects his engagement with contemporary global economic and geopolitical shifts. In addition to his academic work, he has contributed as a volunteer in various academic and research initiatives, demonstrating a strong commitment to professional development and scholarly collaboration. His research interests lie in European and Eurasian integration, with a focus on regional cooperation, economic transitions, and the evolving dynamics of global trade and geopolitics.



Abdul Malik,
National Research Tomsk State University

Navigating Rivalries: Assessing Pakistan's "Balancing Act" Between its Traditional Partners (US-China) and its Deepening Ties with Russia

Abstract

Pakistan's foreign policy has historically been shaped by complex power asymmetries, regional security imperatives, and shifting global alignments. In an increasingly polycentric international system, Pakistan is recalibrating its strategic posture by balancing its traditional partnerships with the United States and China while simultaneously deepening its engagement with Russia. This study examines Pakistan's evolving "balancing act" through the lens of strategic hedging and multi-vector diplomacy, assessing how Islamabad navigates competing geopolitical pressures without alienating long-standing allies. The paper argues that Pakistan's engagement with Russia reflects both pragmatic economic motivations and emerging security convergences, particularly in energy cooperation, defense dialogue, and regional counterterrorism frameworks. The analysis situates these developments within broader Eurasian integration processes, including Pakistan's growing participation in multilateral platforms such as the Shanghai Cooperation Organization, engagement with the Eurasian Economic Union, interactions with BRICS frameworks, and cooperation through the Organization of Islamic Cooperation. These institutions provide Islamabad with diplomatic space to diversify economic partnerships, enhance regional connectivity, and reduce excessive dependence on any single global power. Using a qualitative analytical approach supported by policy documents, trade statistics, and diplomatic engagement patterns, the study explores how Pakistan strategically balances its security reliance, economic interests, and geopolitical positioning. Particular attention is paid to the impact of shifting great power competition, sanctions regimes, and regional security dynamics in South and Central Asia. The research contributes to understanding how middle powers maneuver within a transforming global order by highlighting Pakistan's adaptive foreign policy strategies. It further evaluates the sustainability of Pakistan's multi-alignment approach and its implications for Russia–Pakistan relations in shaping emerging Eurasian geopolitical and economic architectures.

Biograpical Note

Abdul Samad is a Pakistani national and a Master's student of International Relations at Tomsk State University, Russian Federation. Despite being in his first academic semester, he has demonstrated strong academic performance, research engagement, and leadership in student diplomacy. He is the Founder of the Pakistan Club and an active moderator of the Urdu Club, contributing to intercultural dialogue, cultural representation, and student engagement within the international student community.He has authored and co-authored multiple research papers on international relations, geopolitics, and Pakistan–Russia relations, including an international book chapter. His research interests include international security, non-traditional security threats, regional geopolitics, and evolving global power dynamics.He has also participated in collaborative research initiatives across Pakistan and Russia and was a winner at the Study in Russia regional stage in the Culture and Language category. In 2025, he received the International Student of the Year Award.



Abdul Samad,
Tomsk State University, Russian Federation

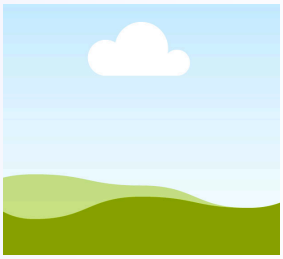
Why firms still do not trade: digital market participation and geo-economic barriers in Russia-Pakistan cross-border commerce

Abstract

Recent international relations between Russia and Pakistan have raised potential hopes of increasing bilateral trade, but at the firm level, the involvement is minimal. Current studies blame this lapse primarily upon infrastructure, sanctions surroundings, or macroeconomic aspects, which ignore the escalating responsibility of decision-making by firms in digital marketplaces. Lots of Pakistani small-medium sized enterprises (SMEs) have the technical access to online services and still do not make transactions with Russia. This research focuses on understanding why digitally capable firms abstain from engaging in Russia–Pakistan cross-border e-commerce. It explores whether perceived transaction unreliability and weak institutional trust rather than logistics constraints alone discourage market entry. The study is based on a structured questionnaire among Pakistani exporting SMEs and e-commerce sellers, who actually or possibly engage in the Eurasian markets. A small group of interviews with the experts is also used to supplement the survey. It assesses the effects of payment settlement frictions, regulatory transparency, platform governance provisions and perceived geopolitical risk on firms choices to begin or to increase their cross-border activity, and determines whether institutional trust conditions the effects of these relationships. Basing the paper on a transaction-uncertainty approach to firm behaviour, The findings indicate that non-participation is driven more by perceived transaction risk than by insufficient demand. As reliability in payment, enforcement of contracts or rules seems to be uncertain, Firms rationally avoid cross-border transactions despite digital availability. The paper reasons why the diplomatic cooperation cannot necessarily result in the creation of trade and provides policy areas, including, but not limited to, payment interoperability, governance of digital platform, and trust-building mechanisms, to ensure sustainable bilateral digital commerce.

Biograpical Note

Vardah Iqbal is a researcher specializing in cross-border e-commerce, digital trust, and sustainability-oriented market strategies in emerging economies. Her work explores why increased digital connectivity and market access do not necessarily translate into proportional trade participation, with a focus on institutional reliability, digital payment systems, and firm-level engagement in cross-border commerce. Her research portfolio includes studies on China–Pakistan e-commerce dynamics, technology and digital payment adoption using extended Technology Acceptance Models, and AI-driven consumer behavior in digital marketplaces. She employs mixed-method approaches, including Structural Equation Modelling (SEM), survey-based empirical analysis, and AI-assisted tools to generate policy-relevant insights. With experience in e-commerce consulting, digital marketing strategy, and academic teaching, she integrates practical expertise with rigorous research. Her broader agenda emphasizes strengthening digital trade cooperation, institutional trust, and sustainability-driven economic integration in emerging and multipolar trade environments.



Varda Iqbal,
National Research University Higher School of Economics (HSE), Russia

Historical experience of interaction between Russia and Pakistan in ensuring regional security in the context of armed conflicts in Afghanistan (1979–2025)

Abstract

The relevance of this study lies in the fact that the Taliban's rise to power in Afghanistan has led to significant changes in regional security in the Middle East and Central Asia. Afghanistan's neighbors are now facing threats of terrorism, instability, and border conflicts. In the new geopolitical environment, there is a need for international cooperation between Russia, Pakistan, Iran, China, and the countries of Central Asia aimed at reducing tensions in the region and creating conditions for ensuring international security. The main scientific problem is that the relationship between Russia and Pakistan, the assessment of each state's contribution to maintaining regional security, and the analysis of the potential for expanding bilateral cooperation in the new geopolitical environment remain insufficiently researched and addressed. This article examines the historical development of bilateral relations between Russia/the USSR and Pakistan in the area of ensuring regional security and countering the threats of terrorism, instability, and drug trafficking emanating from Afghanistan. It examines the two countries' contributions to resolving the crisis and stabilizing the situation in the region, the historical and political background of relations between the USSR and Pakistan (1979-1991), the influence of the situation in Afghanistan on the formation of Soviet-Pakistani relations, the progress of the Geneva negotiations (1982-1988) to resolve the conflict, and the role of the USSR and Pakistan in signing the Geneva Accords on Afghanistan. This article analyzes bilateral interactions during the Afghan Civil War (1992-2001). It examines the positions of Russia and Pakistan on the international stage and their participation in resolving the conflict in Afghanistan (2001-2021). It also examines relations between Russia and Pakistan during the preparation for and withdrawal of American troops from Afghanistan (2020-2025), the improvement of operational response mechanisms to terrorist threats in the new geopolitical environment, and the creation of new cooperation formats, including participation in integration initiatives within the SCO. The methodological basis is formed by the concept of the “security dilemma”, the theory of regional security complexes and the constructivist approach, as well as the chronological (reconstruction of historical events, identification of the main trends in relations between Russia and Pakistan) and comparative methods (analysis of the behavior patterns and strategies of Russia and Pakistan, similarities and differences in their approaches to ensuring regional security).

Biograpical Note



Vasily Stepanovich Khristoforov,
Russian State University

Vasily Stepanovich Khristoforov, Corresponding Member of the Russian Academy of Sciences, Doctor of Law, Professor, Director of the Institute of International Relations and Political Science at the Russian State University for the Humanities, Senior Researcher at the N.A. Dobrolyubov Nizhny Novgorod State Linguistic University. Research interests: leading specialist in the field of political and military history of Russia in the 20th-21st centuries; history of the countries of the Middle East and Central Asia; oriental studies, international relations, international security, history of domestic intelligence and counterintelligence. The author of more than 300 scientific papers published in leading scientific journals in Russia and abroad (Austria, Hungary, Germany, Italy, Kazakhstan, China, Poland, Finland), including 12 monographs (Khristoforov V.S. Military campaigns of the USSR and the USA in Afghanistan: a comparative analysis. Moscow, 2025; Ibid. Soviet special services open the East. Moscow, 2019; Ibid. Afghanistan: the military-political presence of the USSR 1979-1989. Moscow, 2016 and others), as well as scientific articles published in journals included in the White List, the HAC list, the Web of Science and Scopus databases.

The SCO and Pakistan in a Changing Global Order

Abstract

The Shanghai Cooperation Organization is one of the few regional associations in which Pakistan is running: in an atmosphere of mutual respect; opens new markets in Central Asian region; is expanding mechanisms for combating terrorist elements; the SCO is the platform for developing mechanisms for interaction with Afghanistan and India, etc. Since becoming full member of SCO in 2017, Pakistan has constructively participated in all its events as well as extended all out cooperation towards achieving SCO's agenda:

- *- strengthening political, economic and trade relations;*
- *- developing of trade relations,*
- *- Innovation and increased export volumes & etc.*

Pakistan due to some reasons is facing multiple difficulties such as: a technology gap, scaling economic growth, the ability to connect with new industrial supply chains. That is why Pakistan is interested in expanding cooperation with the trusted partners in SCO in: hydrocarbon raw materials, energy, agriculture products, modern technology, etc.

"Pakistan attached high importance to its relations with the Russian Federation; the strengthening relations between two countries was one of Pakistan's foreign policy priorities, and viewed Russia as a stabilizing factor in the international arena". Islamabad has submitted a bid to Russia for a the new Steel Mills in Karachi construction project. The Central Asian project is one of Pakistan's most important. For example Kazakhstan and Uzbekistan agreed with Pakistan the bilateral trade turnover up to USD 1 - 2 billion accordingly. Academic institutions are vital spaces for complex dialogue, which analyzing political cycles through open and responsible ideas exchange. Moreover, active engagement in dialogue is essential to ensure that in a competitive world the future is determined by countries themselves.

Biograpical Note

A Senior Research Fellow at the Center for Middle East Studies, Institute of Oriental Studies, he holds a PhD in History. He is the author of over 500 scholarly and analytical articles focusing on the domestic and foreign policy of the Islamic Republic of Pakistan. His research spans key political, historical, and strategic developments, offering in-depth insights into Pakistan's internal dynamics and its role in regional and global affairs.



Natalia Alekseevna Zamaraeva,
Institute of Oriental Studies

The influence of the American factor on the development of Russian-Pakistani relations in the 21st century

Abstract

Relations between Russia and Pakistan have undergone a complex journey from the antagonism of the Cold War to a modern pragmatic partnership. Signs of gradual rapprochement began to emerge in the early 21st century, when Pakistan, a historical US and NATO ally, began seeking to diversify its international ties, allowing Russia to expand its influence in South Asia. The changing global geopolitical architecture, particularly the emergence of a multipolar world and the shift of the global economic center of gravity to Asia, created fertile ground for Russian-Pakistani rapprochement. In the 21st century, Pakistan strives to chart an independent course on the global political stage, and to this end, it is making significant efforts to strengthen national economic and political stability. At the same time, like many countries in the Global South, it faces significant pressure on its political position in the face of great power competition. The rapprochement between Russia and Pakistan poses a complex challenge for US foreign policy in the 21st century. The US factor remains critical for the development of intensive cooperation between Pakistan and Russia. US sanctions against Russian companies have frozen major projects, in particular the Pakistan Stream gas pipeline, the agreement for which was signed in 2015. If US sanctions against Russia are lifted, Pakistan will gain strategic space to strengthen economic relations with Russia, particularly in securing long-term energy deals at competitive prices, which will significantly benefit the Pakistani economy. Despite American opposition, over the past two decades, political relations between Pakistan and Russia have improved, and mechanisms for the gradual expansion of trade and economic cooperation have emerged. Pakistan is a potentially major market for Russian goods and services, particularly in the energy and engineering sectors. Pakistan's accession to the Shanghai Cooperation Organization (SCO) in 2017, of which Russia is a key member, was a significant milestone, providing a platform for multilateral cooperation and further impetus for bilateral ties.

Biograpical Note

A Candidate of Historical Sciences and Associate Professor at the Chair of International Relations, World Politics and Diplomacy, she is affiliated with the Institute of International Relations, History and Oriental Studies at Kazan Federal University. Her academic work focuses on international relations, global political dynamics, and diplomatic studies, with particular emphasis on historical perspectives in world politics. She has contributed to teaching and research in areas such as foreign policy analysis, regional studies, and international cooperation. With a strong commitment to academic excellence, she actively engages in scholarly activities, including research publications, conferences, and collaborative projects. Her work reflects a deep understanding of global affairs and a dedication to advancing knowledge in the field of international relations.



Penkovtsev Roman Vladimirovich (Grishin Ya.Ya.),
Kazan Federal University

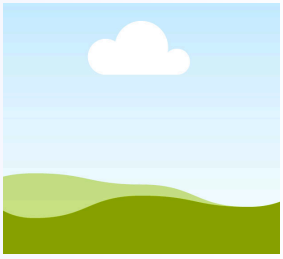
The BRICS Factor in Russian-Pakistani Relations of the New International Order

Abstract

The report presents the main parameters of relations between Russia and Pakistan in the post-Soviet period. After World War II, official diplomatic relations between the countries were established, but they were cool. The main reason was the close cooperation between the Islamic Republic of Pakistan and the United States, the USSR's main geopolitical adversary. During the war in Afghanistan, Pakistan, with the help of Western countries, provided the main support to the mujahideen fighting the country's official government and the Soviet military contingent. In the post-Soviet period, relations between Russia and Pakistan have become pragmatic. Cooperation in the economic sphere has become more active: energy, agriculture, automobile and rail technology, pharmaceuticals, and biotechnology. Russia and Pakistan cooperate politically within the SCO. Regional security policy, including food security for Pakistan, is a key area of cooperation. In recent years, Russia has become a leader among countries considered part of the Global South, and cooperation between Russia and Pakistan is only strengthening. The expansion and gradual institutionalization of BRICS in 2024-2025 has led to the accession of a number of countries to the organization. BRICS now has 10 members and nine partner states. Pakistan sought partner state status. However, this attempt was blocked by India, Pakistan's main regional rival and even engaged in a recurring armed conflict with the country. Modern Pakistan pursues a multi-vector policy. In terms of economics and arms procurement, the country is oriented toward China, while maintaining relations with the United States. It appears that Russia benefits from engaging with Pakistan within BRICS (close cooperation with India is no substitute for this). In recent years, China and India have seen a rapprochement on many issues, paving the way for Pakistan to join BRICS. At the same time, Pakistan remains an active regional player. In 2025, an alliance between the country, Turkey, and Saudi Arabia began to take shape. While not formally directed against Russian interests, increased Western influence on this alliance could potentially lead to active opposition to the BRICS countries.

Biograpical Note

Doctor of Political Science, Professor, Head of the Department of International Relations, World Politics and Diplomacy at Kazan (Volga Region) Federal University.



Bolshakov Andrey Georgievich (Spirchagova E.N.),
Kazan (Volga Region) Federal University

Renegotiating strategic partnership: Pakistan-Russia Relations, Challenges and Opportunities

Abstract

The transformation of the global order has given rise to new patterns of cooperation among regional powers, particularly across the Eurasian geopolitical space. In recent years, as Russia and Pakistan have progressively moved toward closer security engagement and the renegotiation of their relationship, despite historical tensions rooted in Cold War competition. This study examines how Russia–Pakistan security cooperation can be understood within the broader transition toward a polycentric international system. The study argues that the emerging Eurasian order has created both significant opportunities and notable challenges for Moscow and Islamabad as they reassess earlier alignments and pursue pragmatic partnerships grounded in shared security concerns. On the one hand, expanding cooperation in counterterrorism, regional stability in Afghanistan, military exchanges, and multilateral engagement through platforms such as the Shanghai Cooperation Organization offer avenues to institutionalize trust, diversify strategic options, and strengthen their roles in Eurasian security architecture. Shared perceptions of threats related to extremism, political instability, and non-traditional security challenges further provide a functional basis for collaboration. At the same time, the renegotiation of ties is constrained by structural and geopolitical complexities, including historical mistrust, asymmetries in strategic priorities, competing regional alignments, and external pressures from other major powers. Divergent policy approaches toward key regional actors and evolving security dynamics in Afghanistan may also test the durability of their engagement. Using strategic equilibrium theory, the study analyzes how Russia–Pakistan security cooperation reflects broader transformations in Eurasian politics while navigating the interplay of opportunity and constraint inherent in a shifting global order.

Biograpical Note

Dr. Amir Ahmed Farooqui is a lecturer at the Department of International Relations at FUUAST (Federal Urdu University of Arts, Science, and Technology). He joined the department in 2022. Previously he was serving as a visiting faculty member at the University of Karachi for ten years. Dr. Farooqui has a strong background in academia and has also held various administrative positions at Federal Urdu University too. Dr. Farooqui has contributed to the field of international relations through his research and presented his work not only in Pakistan but represented the country internationally. He has published research articles not only in Pakistani journals but scopus indexed globally recognized journals, indicating the quality and relevance of his work. His research primarily focuses on the dynamics of political violence, electoral violence, and political theories of international relations. Dr. Farooqui holds a Ph.D. degree in international relations from the University of Karachi, which further showcases his expertise in the field. With his academic background and research interests, he brings valuable insights and knowledge to the Department of International Relations at FUUAST.



Dr. Amir Ahmed Farooqui,
Federal Urdu University of Arts, Sciences and Technology, Pakistan

Narratives of Multipolarity: The Shanghai Cooperation Organization and the Rise of Alternative Knowledge and Academic Diplomacy

Abstract

The transition toward a multipolar international system is not only redistributing material power but also reshaping the global production of knowledge. Dominant Western-centric epistemic frameworks that have historically shaped international relations theory, development discourse, and security paradigms are increasingly being questioned by emerging Eurasian actors. This paper examines the Shanghai Cooperation Organization (SCO) as a platform for epistemic contestation and alternative narrative construction in the evolving polycentric order. Drawing upon constructivist and critical International Relations theory, the study conceptualizes the SCO not merely as a security or economic bloc, but as an institutional space where member states including Russia and Pakistan, participate in redefining norms surrounding sovereignty, non-interference, regional security, and civilizational pluralism. The paper explores how SCO forums, research centers, academic exchanges, and youth initiatives contribute to what may be termed "academic diplomacy," enabling the circulation of non-Western perspectives on governance, development, and multipolarity. Particular attention is given to Russia-Pakistan intellectual cooperation within SCO-affiliated platforms, assessing whether these engagements represent genuine epistemic innovation or strategic narrative alignment. The analysis also evaluates the limits of such knowledge diplomacy, including institutional capacity constraints and asymmetries among member states. By situating the SCO within broader debates on knowledge rivalries and global norm diffusion, this study argues that Eurasian multilateralism is increasingly operating at both material and ideational levels. In doing so, it contributes to understanding how emerging powers attempt to institutionalize alternative worldviews and shape the normative foundations of a post-unipolar order.

Biograpical Note

Dr. Ayesha Khan is an Assistant Professor at GPP Department, National University of Modern Languages. She holds a PhD in Global Studies from Shanghai University, where her research examined regional integration dynamics within the Economic Cooperation Organization (ECO) region, with particular focus on connectivity initiatives such as the Belt and Road Initiative (BRI) and CAREC corridors. Her research interests include Eurasian geopolitics, regionalism and alternative multilateralism, great power competition in Central and South Asia, and the political economy of connectivity projects. She has published and presented her work on emerging power configurations, security transformations, and development cooperation in the broader Eurasian space. Dr. Khan actively engages in academic dialogue on multipolarity, knowledge politics, and regional institutional frameworks, and contributes to policy-oriented debates on Pakistan's strategic positioning in an evolving global order.



Dr. Ayesha Khan
National University of Modern Languages

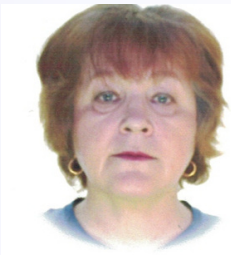
Intensification of Russian-Pakistani Relations in the context of regional consolidation.

Abstract

The historical and geopolitical analysis of the Russian-Pakistani relations reveals that, although Pakistan has traditionally not occupied a significant place in the foreign policy of the Russian Federation, this fact in the current scenario of the global transformation and transition to a Polycentric world does not negate the importance of strengthening relations between Moscow and Islamabad due to their shared regional interests. Actually, both two countries are actively engaged in the creation of the strong dialogue architecture at all levels, including the highest one. In this context, it is worth mentioning the official visit of the Pakistan Prime-Minister Shehbaz Sharif to Moscow on June, 2026, which is expected to be a breakthrough in the bilateral relations. Moreover, during the ceremony of presenting credentials by the new Ambassador of the Islamic Republic of Pakistan H.E. Mr. Faisal Niaz Tirmizi to the President of Russia on January 15, 2026 Vladimir Putin underlined with satisfaction the "truly mutually beneficial" relations between Russia and Pakistan with their close cooperation not only on bilateral, but also on the multilateral levels, as the SCO full-fledged members, with the great economic, technological and human potential of this largest regional Organization. It seems, that the main areas of Russia-Pakistan relations in the vector of the regional integration, according to the priorities ranking, include cooperation in the following 3 important areas: - transport and energy connectivity; - fight against terrorism; - elimination of drug trafficking. Thus, the regional connectivity has practically become the main driver of their bilateral interaction gradually reaching a new level of mutually beneficial partnership as a reflection of both states involvement in the creation of the joint economic and security structure of the Greater Eurasia. Their progress on this track has been facilitated by the coordinated implementation of the Russian integration project EAEU- BEP with the conjunctive project OBOR/BRI-CPEC, which opens the prospects to the global routes access of BRICS, where Pakistan in November 2023 officially applied for the membership.

Biograpical Note

Dr. Irina Serenko, Senior Research Scholar, Pakistan Section at the Center of the Near and Middle East Countries Study, Institute of Oriental Studies, Russian Academy of Sciences (IOS RAS). She started her career in Pakistan /1983-1984/ and worked as an Assistant Professor at the Pyatigorsk State Pedagogical Institute of Foreign Languages /1984-1993/, earning PhD in Education (1993). Since 1993 she has been continuing her research on Pakistan socio-political and cultural dynamics, as well as Pakistan relations with Russia and regional countries at IOS RAS. She participated in different International Congresses and Conferences, not only in Russia, but across Pakistan, England, China, Iraq, Kyrgyzstan and Turkmenistan. She authored about 200 academic works, including personal and collective monographs both in Russian and in English: “Pakistan: Geopolitical Economics and Politics of Economic and Trade Corridors” (Lahore, 2024); “Pakistan-Russia Relations: A Comprehensive Historical and Strategic Analysis” (Islamabad, 2025); “Pakistan in Foreign Policy of Russia. Geopolitical Imperatives and Dynamics of Bilateral Relations” (M., 2025), etc.



Irina Serenko
Institute of Oriental Studies, Russian Academy of Sciences (IOS RAS)

Designing new horizons of the strategic partnership between Russia and Pakistan on the threshold of the new global order emergence

Abstract

The relations between Russia and Pakistan have been developing along the key geopolitical tectonic shifts of the world affairs with the sound of turbulence and uncertainty for the last decades. Every year the international agenda expanded with the new threats, risks, and uncertainties that diminished diplomatic efforts, political and economic governance. The axes of the geostrategic interests of Russia and Pakistan have been interlaced at the point of bypassing the mined areas of world affairs and maneuver between the West and the emerging Eurasian domain. As soon as the system of power distribution has taken a harsh form of the revived realpolitik and amplified aggression among «warring states», Russia and Pakistan are challenged by a lack of their strategic vision synchronization these days. The existing vacuum of the strategic insight and conjugation, P2P & B2B ties, media domain, technological entanglement demonstrates a long-standing absence of the well-tuned conceptual and structural pillars in the architecture of the Russia-Pakistan ties. In spite of expansion of the strategic, military and diplomatic zones of partnership, such as Pakistan-Saudi Arabia defense alliance, with Turkey's intention to join it, Pakistan-China axe of collaboration, Pakistan-Central Asian States (emerging partnerships, especially with Uzbekistan, aimed at regional connectivity and trade, along with the efforts of stabilizing Afghanistan), Pakistan-USA aspiration to find a better equilibrium of interests, Pakistan's capacity of strategic diversification to balance gains against emerging geostrategic, geoeconomic and technological dependencies in a highly contested regional and global order is limited and in need of advanced strategic reassessment. The membership of Pakistan in the newly established «Board of Peace» (BoP) introduced by US President Donald Trump at the World Economic Forum in Davos on the 22nd of January 2026 may apply an additional burden on the geopolitical dilemma that Pakistan has had difficulties to resolve for a long period of time. For counter-balancing a growing complexity of the geopolitical reality Pakistan should seek a closer strategic partnership with Russia by activating the non-traditional forms of collaboration and unconventional approaches in designing new horizons of alignment.

Biograpical Note

Dr. Roxolana Zigón, originally from Russia, has spent over two decades studying and working internationally across the United States and Europe. Her interdisciplinary expertise spans geopolitics, international relations, diplomacy, strategic and military analysis, advanced technologies, arts, philosophy, neurolinguistics, and neuropedagogy. She is the creator of innovative concepts such as "Quantum Geopolitics," "Geoomniapolitics," "Enlightened Activism," and "Polymathic Education." Dr. Zigón is the founder and president of ARFAIM "New Enlightenment," the Diplomatic School "Polymath," and the initiative "Women in Diplomacy of the Global South." She has served as a strategic adviser to high-level political leaders, contributing to global policy and transformation initiatives. Currently, she leads key research and youth diplomacy centers in Russia and is an active media commentator, speaker, and author



Dr. Roxolana Zigon,
Director of the Scientific Center of the International & Strategic Research
Moscow

Soft Balancing in a Polycentric Order: The Strategic Convergence of Pakistan and Russia

Abstract

The transition from a unipolar to a polycentric international order has reshaped patterns of strategic alignment across Eurasia. Despite being on opposing sides during the Cold War, Pakistan and Russia have found strategic convergence in the current multipolar environment, driven by systemic forces. Although there is considerable literature on Pakistan-Russia relations, these relations remain under-theorized within systemic analyses of global power transition. This paper argues that structural shifts toward polycentricity create incentives for Pakistan to pursue soft balancing strategies that facilitate selective strategic convergence with Russia. By drawing on frameworks such as structural realism and soft balancing, the paper demonstrates strategic convergence stemming from shared interests in regional stability, energy security, and the dynamics following Afghanistan's withdrawal. Key areas of cooperation will be explored, including defense collaboration, counterterrorism efforts, energy connectivity initiatives, and coordination within multilateral organizations such as the Shanghai Cooperation Organization (SCO). The paper will employ qualitative analysis of policy documents, defense agreements, and academic sources to provide an in-depth examination of the convergence of national interests. In conclusion, while structural constraints, such as Russia's ties with India, Pakistan's relationship with the United States, and economic limitations, may restrict the depth of strategic alignment, the relationship between Pakistan and Russia demonstrates an adaptive foreign policy. As multipolarity deepens, this relationship could serve as a stabilizing force in Eurasian strategic connectivity.

Biograpical Note

Syed Ehsan Ali is a Lecturer in International Relations at the Federal Urdu University of Arts, Sciences & Technology (FUUAST), Islamabad. He holds an MPhil in American Studies and a BS (Hons) in Political Science from Quaid-i-Azam University, Islamabad. His research focuses on great power competition, South Asian politics, and Eurasian geopolitics. He has published in various national and international journals on topics including US-China rivalry, the regional implications of the QUAD, and Indo-Pacific security dynamics. Previously, he served as a Young Parliamentary Associate at the Senate of Pakistan under an EU-funded program, where he contributed to policy research and parliamentary initiatives. His current research examines Pakistan-Russia relations within an emerging polycentric international order, with particular emphasis on soft balancing and regional security frameworks, contributing to contemporary debates on global and regional strategic transformations.



Syed Ehsan Ali,
Federal Urdu University of Arts, Sciences and Technology, Pakistan

Climate Security and Eurasian Connectivity: Reimagining Russia–Pakistan Strategic Cooperation in the Emerging Global Climate Order

Abstract

The accelerating impacts of climate change have transformed environmental concerns into critical components of global security, regional diplomacy, and economic cooperation. Within the evolving global climate order, climate security has emerged as a central framework for redefining strategic partnerships and regional connectivity. This study examines the role of Russia–Pakistan strategic cooperation in advancing Eurasian connectivity through climate governance, sustainable energy transition, and institutional collaboration. It explores how both countries can use bilateral and multilateral platforms to address climate-induced vulnerabilities while strengthening regional stability and economic integration. Existing scholarship on Russia–Pakistan relations has primarily focused on defense cooperation, energy trade, and geopolitical realignments, while limited attention has been given to climate security as a strategic dimension of bilateral engagement. This research addresses this gap by integrating climate security with regional connectivity discourse and examining the potential of Russia–Pakistan cooperation in shaping sustainable Eurasian governance structures. The study adopts a qualitative and analytical research methodology grounded in climate security theory, regional integration frameworks, and international political economy perspectives. The research relies on secondary data sources, including policy documents, institutional reports, regional cooperation agreements, and scholarly literature. Comparative policy analysis is utilized to evaluate existing climate and energy cooperation strategies between Russia and Pakistan, while case-based examination of Eurasian multilateral platforms such as the Shanghai Cooperation Organization (SCO) provides empirical support. The paper argues that integrating climate security into Russia–Pakistan strategic cooperation can reshape traditional geopolitical alignments by promoting green connectivity and strengthening institutional climate governance. It concludes by proposing policy-oriented pathways to institutionalize climate cooperation, enhance regional resilience, and support Sustainable Development Goals through a long-term Eurasian partnership.

Biograpical Note

Saima Azhar is a faculty member at the Federal Urdu University of Arts, Sciences & Technology (FUUAST), where she has been teaching and conducting research in Pakistan Studies and International Relations since 2015. She is currently pursuing her PhD, with a research focus on climate security and environmental governance. Her academic work examines the intersection of climate change, security, and regional cooperation, with particular emphasis on emerging challenges in environmental sustainability and policy responses. She has published numerous research papers in national and international journals and has presented her work at various international conferences. In addition to her academic responsibilities, she is actively engaged in policy research and analysis, contributing to discussions on climate diplomacy, environmental sustainability, and regional security frameworks. Her current research explores climate security within the broader context of evolving global and regional governance structures.



Saima Azhar,
Federal Urdu University of Arts, Sciences and Technology, Pakistan

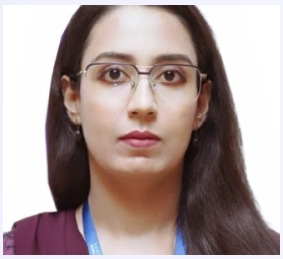
Nuclear Governance and Strategic Bargaining under Nuclear Apartheid: Pakistan-Russia Dynamics

Abstract

In the absence of any treaty and until an agreement on a global arms control framework is reached between the US, Russia and China, the nuclear armed great powers are resorting to nuclear governance mechanisms aimed at managing the existing nuclear chaos featuring the following three determinants in a causal chain manner: First. 'the hegemonic nuclear order wherein the US let the last arms control treaty with Russia expire in order to come-up with a future framework on the US' terms in order to achieve US' nuclear hegemony among allies and competitors. Second, more concerning trait and even corollary of this nuclear hegemony is nuclear apartheid wherein, the competing nuclear armed great powers and their peripheral nuclear armed aligned states are competing to preserve the status quo in their respective regions by preventing any further nuclear armament. The US-Iran-Israel episode highlighted US disregard of the NPT in favour of Israel. Also, the US has also been approving of benefits to nuclear armed states in disregards of the NPT; for instance the NSG waiver given to India as a non-NPT state. Third, it is nuclear anarchy as a derivative of the nuclear apartheid. For instance, the US strikes on the Iranian nuclear sites were abetted by Israel; however, for the arms control regime, the event demonstrated blurring of the lines between NPT compliant and non-compliant states in favour of the US' nuclear hegemony. If NPT states are vulnerable to the emerging nuclear anarchy as a derivative of the nuclear apartheid and to this extent against the NPT protections, it compels the rest of the NPT states with nuclear ambitions and particularly non-NPT nuclear armed states to come up with regional strategic realignments for nuclear governance. At the moment, the Western initiatives include the one between the US and Israel; then the Europe wherein France aims to take the lead; and its alternate in the global south appears to be between Russia, China, Pakistan and North Korea. Subsequently after the New Start, Chinese have recently announced their 'Global Governance Initiative;' while Russia has the 'Eurasian Security Architecture' which also includes SCO countries including Pakistan. Pakistan as a peripheral nuclear armed state, fits-in any nuclear governance framework that the Eastern great powers aim at for the Global South and the most suitable platform for this may be SCO since it pools Russia, China, Pakistan and India together. Also, Pakistan is perceived as a potential partner for any future extended Middle Eastern security complex, visibly with the Saudis and Turkey; and thus may enable the nuclear governance for Asia, managing the nuclear chaos and instability among Eastern states by preventing nuclear armament and managing the threat of Western-led nuclear apartheid; thus assisting Russia in ensuring the existing arms control and non-proliferation regime alive. However, this cooperation comes with bargains. Russia may also initiate nuclear cooperation with Pakistan along the lines of the cooperation between the US and India as confidence building measure. This paper will explore the prospects of a potential strategic bargaining between Pakistan and Russia within framework of nuclear governance for the Global South.

Biograpical Note

Komal Khan is serving as a Research Officer at the Strategic Vision Institute (SVI), Islamabad. She was an InteRussia Fellow in International Relations (Spring 2025 cohort), reflecting her engagement with international academic and policy networks. Her research focuses on nuclear strategy, arms control, great power politics, and military modernization in the Indian Ocean region. She has contributed to scholarly and policy discussions on strategic stability and evolving security dynamics. Previously, she has served as a Visiting Faculty member at Bahria University, Islamabad, and the University of Peshawar, and has also worked as a researcher at the Institute of Strategic Studies Islamabad (ISSI). Her combined academic and policy experience positions her at the intersection of research, teaching, and strategic analysis, with a strong focus on contemporary global security challenges.



Komal Khan ,
Strategic Vision Institute (SVI)

Strengthening Soft Power Ties: Policy Pathways for Deepening Pakistan–Russia People-to-People Engagement

Abstract

As Pakistan and Russia navigate a shifting multipolar order, the sustainability of their bilateral relationship depends not only on strategic and economic cooperation but also on structured soft power engagement. While political dialogue and defense collaboration have advanced in recent years, long-term stability requires deeper societal familiarity and public trust. This paper proposes a policy-driven framework to institutionalize Pakistan–Russia people-to-people connectivity. The study identifies three priority areas for action. First, academic diplomacy should be formalized through mobility programs, dual-degree initiatives, joint research centers, and technology-transfer partnerships in emerging sectors such as artificial intelligence, climate science, and digital innovation. Second, cultural diplomacy should be strengthened through annual cultural forums, digital heritage platforms, diaspora engagement, and structured interfaith dialogue. Third, coordinated media and public diplomacy mechanisms —including journalist exchanges, joint documentary production, and digital campaigns—should be developed to counter misperceptions and shape balanced narratives. To ensure implementation, the paper recommends establishing a Pakistan–Russia Soft Power Forum supported by public–private partnerships and measurable performance indicators. Institutionalizing soft power cooperation will enable both countries to transform growing strategic alignment into durable societal partnership.

Biograpical Note

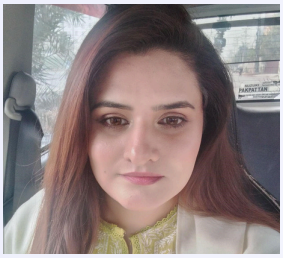
r. Faisal Javaid is Head of the Department of International Relations and Mass Communication and Deputy Director at the Office of Research Innovation and Commercialization (ORIC) at the Federal Urdu University of Arts, Science & Technology (FUUAST), Islamabad, where he has been teaching since 2009. His research focuses on the foreign relations of Central Asia, with particular emphasis on regional connectivity between Pakistan, Central Asia, and the Russian Federation. He is the author of Bridging Horizons: Unraveling the Enigma of Connectivity between Pakistan and Central Asia (IPS, 2024) and editor of New World Order: In Statu Nascendi (FNCA, Poland, 2024), in addition to contributing to several scholarly volumes. He serves as Senior Vice President (Honorary) of the Consortium for Asia Pacific and Eurasian Studies (CAPES). A postdoctoral fellow of the Harriman Institute, Columbia University, Dr. Javaid has published over thirty-three research papers, presented widely at international forums, and served as a Visiting Professor in Poland. He is an active member of ISA, IPSA, MPSA, and APT.



Dr. Faisal Javaid
Federal Urdu University of Arts, Science & Technology (FUUAST)

Biograpical Note

Dr. Sundas Khizar is faculty at university of Okara and Research fellow CAPES, specializes in regional politics, strategic partnerships, and the Russia Pakistan, Eurasia nexus. A seasoned scholar and media analyst, she offers insightful perspectives on international affairs and geopolitical trends. Her work focuses on how emerging global dynamics shape Pakistan's foreign policy and regional stability.



Dr. Sundas Khizar,
University of Okara

Comparative analysis of the paradiplomatic capabilities of the regions of Pakistan and the Russian Federation

Abstract

Paradiplomacy is the process of engaging subnational entities in international relations. It is becoming an increasingly prominent phenomenon in world politics today, amid globalization and the strengthening of regional identities. This study compares the paradiplomatic capacities of regions in two large federations—Russia and Pakistan—between which profound structural asymmetries are revealed. The Russian constitutional model recognizes the international activities of regions as a matter of joint jurisdiction between the center and the constituent entities. Special federal legislation grants regions the right to enter into agreements with territorial units of foreign states, establish foreign missions, and interact with international organizations—subject to approval by the Ministry of Foreign Affairs. Pakistan's constitutional tradition, by contrast, unconditionally assigns foreign affairs to the exclusive prerogative of the central government. A significant constitutional reform in 2010 expanded provincial powers in social affairs and resource management, but deliberately ignored the issue of foreign policy competence. There is no specific law regulating provincial international relations in Pakistan. At the institutional level, the contrast is no less striking. Russian regions have developed a fully-fledged paradiplomatic infrastructure—from specialized departments within regional governments to a network of permanent missions abroad and participation in cross-border associations. Tatarstan, a pioneer in this area, maintains a presence in nine countries and is purposefully building ties with the Turkic-speaking and Muslim worlds. Pakistan's provinces lack such infrastructure, and their few international contacts remain informal and ad hoc. The identified asymmetry is determined by a number of interrelated factors: The fundamental differences in constitutional models of federalism, the dominance of the army in shaping Pakistan's foreign policy, and the specific geopolitical environment—a protracted confrontation with India and internal separatist challenges—turn any decentralization of foreign relations into a matter of national security.Russian practice demonstrates that paradiplomacy can serve as an effective mechanism for regional development and strengthening interethnic harmony, provided there is a well-balanced balance between regional autonomy and the central government's coordinating role. The Pakistani experience, in turn, clearly demonstrates that even extensive internal decentralization does not always extend to foreign relations if the political system is dominated by security institutions and faces persistent external threats.

Biograpical Note

Candidate of Political Sciences, Associate Professor in the Department of International Relations, World Politics and Diplomacy at the Institute of International Relations, History and Oriental Studies, Kazan Federal University.



Evgeniya Valerievna Khramova (Ch.A. Misbakhova/Z.V. Silaeva)
Kazan Federal University

Bridging Continents: Strategic Connectivity and Economic Integration between Central Asia, Russia, and Pakistan

Abstract

This research examines the growing connectivity between Central Asia, Russia, and Pakistan, focusing on its strategic relevance for fostering deeper regional economic integration across Eurasia. It explores how historical trade routes, revived under contemporary geopolitical and economic imperatives, are being reimagined through initiatives such as the China-Pakistan Economic Corridor, the International North-South Transport Corridor, and regional transport and energy infrastructure projects. It identifies persistent challenges hindering connectivity, including fragile political environments, infrastructural bottlenecks, external strategic rivalries, and prevailing security threats. Moreover, through the analytical lenses of Regionalism and Geoeconomics, the research examines how economic and political motivations are converging to reshape regional alignments.

Biograpical Note

Prof Dr Adam Saud is a co-editor of the book “China’s Globalisation and the New World Order” published by Springer in 2025. I have over 20 years of academic experience at undergraduate, postgraduate and PhD levels. Besides teaching and research supervision, I remained the Head of Department, Humanities and Social Sciences, Coordinator Quality Assurance, and Head of IR Program at Bahria University. I am HEC approved supervisor and the member of HEC National Curriculum Review Committee on International Relations. I am a member of the Board of Governors for Area Study Center, Quaid-i-Azam University, Islamabad. I’m the core member of the Working Group on Countering Violent Extremism under the Ministry of Information and Broadcasting. I’m a member of the advisory board of five research journals and reviewer of several international and national journals. I’m also core member and Secretary of Pakistan Society for International Studies.



Prof. Dr. Adam Saud,
Bahria University

Strategic Realignment in Eurasia: Russia–Pakistan Relations amid Global Power Transition

Abstract

The international system is undergoing a pronounced transition toward a fragmented and multipolar order. The protracted Russia–Ukraine conflict, intensifying great-power rivalry, sanctions-driven restructuring of global markets, and renewed instability in the Middle East have reshaped Eurasian strategic dynamics. In this context, Pakistan's elevated diplomatic footprint in 2025—marked by its effective crisis diplomacy during the short conflict with India, its redefinition as a security partner in the Gulf, and the revival of strategic ties with the United States—reflects an assertive and diversified foreign policy approach. This evolution creates new strategic opportunities for engagement with Russia.

This paper argues that Russia–Pakistan relations are entering a phase of structured strategic realignment driven by converging geopolitical and economic imperatives. Over the past decade, both states have institutionalised defence cooperation through joint military exercises, deepened coordination within the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation, initiated energy collaboration such as the Pakistan Stream Gas Pipeline project, and sustained high-level political dialogue. Moscow's gradual diversification of its South Asia policy beyond a historically India-centric framework, combined with Islamabad's pursuit of multi-vector diplomacy amid shifting regional responsibilities, has created substantive room for cooperation.

However, this realignment is bounded by structural constraints: limited trade volumes, sanctions-related financial barriers, implementation delays in flagship projects, and broader balancing strategies with other major powers. The paper contends that the durability of Russia–Pakistan ties will depend on translating geopolitical convergence into institutionalised economic mechanisms, energy connectivity, defence-technical collaboration, and coordinated engagement within Eurasian multilateral platforms. This analysis offers a grounded assessment of the future trajectory of Russia–Pakistan relations in a period of global power transition.

Biograpical Note

Dr. Ishtiaq Ahmad is Professor Emeritus at the School of Politics and International Relations, Quaid-e-Azam University, Islamabad. A distinguished scholar of regional security, economic integration, and Pakistan's politics and foreign policy, he previously served as Vice Chancellor of the University of Sargodha, where he led wide-ranging governance and academic reforms, transforming the institution into a globally ranked public university. He was Pakistan Chair and Quaid-e-Azam Fellow at St Antony's College, University of Oxford, contributing to advanced research on South Asia and regional politics. Dr. Ahmad has published extensively in leading journals, edited volumes, and books with publishers such as Routledge. He has also spoken at major international forums across Europe, Asia and the Middle East. His work bridges scholarship and policy, with experience in higher-education reform, strategic planning, and development communication at the national and international level.



Prof. Dr. Ishtiaq Ahmad,
Quaid-e-Azam University

Regionalization of Eurasia: From Global Value Chains to Regional Prosperity in Russia, Pakistan, and Central Asia

Abstract

Dominant analytical frameworks of Eurasian economic integration tend to conceptualize specific subregions of Eurasia primarily as transit spaces within global value chains rather than as potential loci of internal value creation. This bias has shaped infrastructure, trade, and investment strategies that prioritize external connectivity over endogenous development, particularly in regions located between major global economic centers. Under conditions of accelerating global economic fragmentation, such approaches increasingly constrain regional resilience and long-term growth. This article advances a subregional political economy perspective, arguing that Eurasia should be understood not as a homogeneous economic space but as a system of emerging, potentially self-sufficient subregional economies. Within this framework, Eurasia comprises several major subregional centers, including China, ASEAN, an emerging Eurasian economic core encompassing Russia, Pakistan, Central Asia and the countries of the Persian Gulf, followed by Europe and India. The paper contends that macro-regional integration across Eurasia is structurally dependent on the prior consolidation of internally coherent subregional economies rather than on transit-oriented connectivity alone. Focusing on economic integration between Russia and Pakistan, the study argues that bilateral integration constitutes a necessary structuring mechanism for consolidating a wider subregional economy encompassing Central Asia and the Persian Gulf. It demonstrates that Russia–Pakistan integration functions as a system-forming anchor by linking industrial capacity, market demand, energy supply, and financial coordination. Without a consolidated subregional core, Eurasian integration risks remaining fragmented, corridor-based, and structurally dependent on external centers of demand and finance in the post-global economic order. In this context, the consolidation of an emerging Eurasian core linking Russia, Central Asia, the Persian Gulf, and Pakistan constitutes a necessary condition for the transition from transit-oriented connectivity to a coherent regional economic system.

Biograpical Note

Nazir Zaman Magsi is a Lecturer in the Department of Management at Moscow Polytechnic University. His professional and research interests focus on strategic management, the development and application of information technologies, and process automation in educational and organizational systems. His academic work also explores the transformation of vocational education and training models, with an emphasis on adapting to technological and economic changes. In addition, he conducts research on regional economic processes and Eurasian economic integration, particularly in the context of foreign economic activity. An interdisciplinary scholar, he has also engaged with emerging directions in seismological research, reflecting a broad and diverse research profile. Through his work, he aims to contribute to the advancement of management practices, technological integration, and regional economic development in a rapidly evolving global environment.



Nazir Zaman Magsi,
Moscow Polytechnic University

Pakistan, China and Russia: Regional Economy & Future Prospects

Abstract

The recent shifts in the global economic order have significant impact on regional co-operations and trade partnerships. The Eurasia is not an exception to it particularly Pakistan, China and Russia. These three nations are progressively aligning their economic interests with the growth in the regional economic initiatives. This research is focused on the possible future potential of economic partnerships among Pakistan, China, and Russia within the regional economy surrounding South & Central Asia. Using secondary data and qualitative research approach for policy analysis and comparative regional evaluation, this research evaluate significant initiatives for instance the China–Pakistan Economic Corridor (CPEC) and Russia's Eurasian economic strategy. The outcomes of the research indicate that, energy partnership, and institutional collaborations and better infrastructure network could significantly improve regional economic integration. However the long term benefits are linked to the better management of financial sustainability, governance challenges, security issues, and geopolitical pressures. This research suggests that for achieving the full potential of the Trilateral Regional Economic Collaboration constant political commitment, economic expansion & diversification, and multidimensional trade cooperation are crucial.

Biograpical Note

Dr. Ghazala Yasmeen is a prominent Pakistani academic, economist, and higher education leader known for her contributions to research, teaching, and women's empowerment. She is a Professor of Economics with extensive academic experience and has published numerous research papers in areas such as entrepreneurship, women empowerment, and development economics. She served as the founding Vice Chancellor of Women University Mardan, where she played a transformative role in building the institution from its early stages into a leading women's university in Khyber Pakhtunkhwa. Under her leadership, the university expanded significantly in programs, campuses, and academic quality, earning top rankings among women's universities in the province. Later, she was appointed as Vice Chancellor of Women University Swabi, continuing her mission of strengthening higher education and promoting innovation, research, and digital transformation in universities. Dr. Yasmeen is also recognized internationally, being a Fellow of the Royal Society of Arts (UK), and has received awards such as the Star Women Award and Quaid-e-Azam Award. She is regarded as an influential mentor and leader.



Prof. Dr. Ghazala Yasmeen,
Women University Swabi

Models of Russian-Pakistani economic interaction

Abstract

The 9th meeting of the Intergovernmental Commission, held at the end of 2024, outlined the main contours of Russian-Pakistani economic and humanitarian cooperation: energy (oil supplies, investments in fuel and energy complex facilities), logistics (use of the North-South International Transport Corridor routes), pharmaceuticals (localization of insulin production in Pakistan), and educational cooperation (memorandums of understanding between Russian and Pakistani universities). On the one hand, identifying precisely these areas of cooperation that involve work on long-term projects could have a positive impact on Russian-Pakistani economic ties, both quantitatively and qualitatively. In quantitative terms, Moscow's trade ties remain modest and, moreover, subject to volatility. For example, in 2023, trade between the two countries exceeded $1 billion for the first time, but this growth was followed by a decline. As a result, Russia isn't even among Pakistan's top twenty trading partners, and its share in both export and import statistics is less than one percent. These figures are explained by the qualitative characteristics of the product mix: the development of trade ties hasn't been accompanied by an increase in the share of capital-intensive goods, making trade turnover susceptible to market price volatility. The parties' plans for cooperation in manufacturing, logistics, and transportation offer hope for a rectification of this situation.On the other hand, these plans are currently largely reflected only in intergovernmental agreements; few contracts for specific projects have been signed. However, one should not expect quick results through public investment by one of the parties – rushing to launch projects could lead to irrational use of funds and eventual failure, which would cast doubt on any prospects for developing relations between Moscow and Islamabad. Encouraging private initiatives aimed at developing the counterparty's market appears more appropriate – this promises lower short-term risks and more sustainable economic ties in the long term. Therefore, the report proposes to compare two patterns of bilateral economic relations between Russia and Pakistan (focused on public and private initiatives), and to examine examples of private Russian and Pakistani initiatives that promote economic ties without high-risk investments by national governments.

Biograpical Note

PhD in Political Science, Research Fellow at the Indian Ocean Region Center at the IMEMO RAS. He completed internships at the Institute of Strategic Studies Islamabad, the National Defense University of Pakistan, and the India Foundation, an Indian think tank. His research interests include Pakistan's strategic culture, Indo-Pakistani relations, and Russian-Pakistani relations. He has published over 15 articles in peer-reviewed journals and over five chapters in joint monographs.



Makarevich Gleb Grigorievich
IMEMO RAS

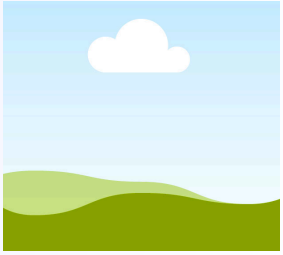
The Impact of Globalization on Innovative Interaction between the Economic Systems of Russia and Pakistan

Abstract

A characteristic of the development of the modern global economy is the gradual and relatively stable division of countries into core capitalist economies and peripheral economies. While industrial production processes gradually shifted, in terms of location and growth of economic efficiency, to countries with cheap labor and economic resources, core capitalist countries have made the development of innovation, the development and sale of new technological solutions and production methods on the global market, the foundation of their economic systems. The globalization processes occurring in the global economy in recent decades have only intensified this trend.Nevertheless, a number of new centers of innovation, scientific, and financial development worldwide demonstrate that peripheral countries are aware of the current situation and are taking steps to change it. The development and formation of new innovation centers requires government action within the framework of national economic and innovation policies. However, existing and growing trends toward regionalization in the global economic system demonstrate that the combined efforts of countries to create conditions for the development of new technological solutions (within groups of countries) are proving most effective.In accordance with the above, it is important to consider that innovative interaction requires both collaboration between innovative and manufacturing organizations and cooperation between countries through the establishment of links between scientific and educational systems. Accordingly, cooperation in scientific and educational spheres becomes the foundation for future innovative interaction.Innovative interaction between the economic systems of the Russian Federation and Pakistan can only be based on the establishment of information (communication) links between scientific, educational, financial, and manufacturing structures. Each level of this systemic interaction is important, both within regional economic systems and at the level of national economies as a whole. Selecting priority areas of interaction, taking into account the scientific and financial capabilities of the two countries, requires analyzing and forecasting various options.

Biograpical Note

Vladimir Valentinovich Malaev, PhD in Economics, Associate Professor, Department of International Economic Relations, Institute of International Relations, History, and Oriental Studies.



Vladimir Valentinovich Malayev
Institute of International Relations, History, and Oriental Studies.

Pakistan: A New Attempt to Reform the Country's Financial Sector

Abstract

This article analyzes Pakistan's efforts to bring its national financial system into compliance with Sharia law. It examines the theory and history of this issue, the current situation, and prospects for cooperation between Pakistan and Russia in light of the Russian Federation's federal law on a pilot project for partner financing.

Biograpical Note

Doctor of Economics, Chief Researcher at the Ufa Federal Research Center of the Russian Academy of Sciences. Since 2025, she has been a professor at the Ufa University of Science and Technology.



Almira Zagirovna Nagimova
Ufa University of Science and Technology.

Impact of Arctic Transformation on Pakistan-Russia Trade Relations

Abstract

Building on the existing literature on the impact of climate-induced Arctic accessibility on global geopolitics and trade routes, this study investigates the specific implications of these transformations for Pakistan-Russia bilateral trade relations. As Arctic ice melting opens new maritime corridors—particularly the Northern Sea Route—and reconfigures global shipping patterns, non-Arctic states face both opportunities and challenges in adapting their trade strategies. This research focuses on how Pakistan might leverage emerging Arctic pathways to strengthen economic ties with Russia while navigating the complex geopolitical landscape shaped by NATO-Russia tensions and great power competition. The study examines three interconnected dimensions. First, it analyzes the economic feasibility and strategic implications of Pakistan utilizing Arctic routes for bilateral trade with Russia, particularly in sectors such as energy imports, grain, and industrial goods. Second, it investigates how climate-driven changes in global maritime connectivity affect Pakistan's position in regional and global trade networks, considering both direct shipping opportunities and indirect effects on conventional routes. Third, it evaluates the geopolitical constraints and opportunities that shape Pakistan-Russia trade cooperation in the context of evolving Arctic security dynamics, sanctions regimes, and shifting alliances. Using qualitative analysis of secondary sources, including trade statistics, policy documents, and academic literature, this research applies a realist framework to critically examine how Pakistan's strategic calculus—shaped by energy security needs, economic diversification goals, and regional geopolitical alignments—intersects with Russia's Arctic strategy and its broader efforts to develop alternative trade partnerships in response to Western sanctions.

Preliminary findings suggest that while Arctic routes present theoretical opportunities for reducing transit times and costs between Pakistan and Russian ports, practical barriers, including infrastructure limitations, insurance costs, regulatory uncertainties, and geopolitical risks, significantly constrain immediate commercial viability. The study identifies niche opportunities in specific sectors and seasonal windows, while recognizing that Pakistan-Russia trade dynamics remain primarily shaped by geopolitical considerations rather than purely economic optimization. The research contributes to broader debates on how climate-induced transformations in distant regions create ripple effects across global trade networks and bilateral relationships, demonstrating that Arctic change is not merely a regional phenomenon but a catalyst for reconfiguring international economic and strategic partnerships.

Biograpical Notes



Dr. Fizza Batool,
SZABIST University

Dr. Fizza Batool is an Assistant Professor at SZABIST University, Karachi, specializing in comparative politics with a particular focus on populism, democratization, and South Asian political dynamics. Her research explores the evolving nature of political institutions, leadership patterns, and democratic transitions in the region. She has contributed to academic discourse through her engagement with global research communities and policy-oriented institutions. In recognition of her scholarly work, she was awarded prestigious research fellowships at the Central European University Democracy Institute in Budapest in 2024 and the Stimson Center in Washington, D.C. in 2020. These experiences have enriched her comparative perspective and strengthened her analytical approach to contemporary political challenges. Dr. Batool is committed to advancing critical research and fostering academic excellence through teaching, mentorship, and collaborative inquiry in the field of political science.



Emad Hussain,
SZABIST University

Emad Hussain is an undergraduate student at SZABIST University, Karachi, pursuing a degree in International Relations. His academic interests center on geopolitics, with a particular focus on the evolving strategic and economic dynamics of the Arctic region. He is especially interested in how emerging trade routes, resource competition, and great power rivalries are reshaping the Arctic's role in global politics. Emad's work explores the intersection of climate change and international trade, examining how melting ice is opening new maritime corridors and influencing global supply chains. As a developing scholar, he is committed to understanding complex geopolitical transformations and contributing to informed policy discussions. Through his academic pursuits, Emad aims to deepen his expertise in international affairs and build a foundation for future research and professional engagement in global policy and strategic studies.

Humanitarian Cooperation and Disaster Risk Reduction: Russia–Pakistan Partnership in a Polycentric Global Order

Abstract

The international system is undergoing a profound transformation characterized by a shift towards a polycentric global order. New alignments and shared interests are creating avenues for cooperation between emerging partners. Within this evolving landscape, Pakistan and Russia are expanding their bilateral engagement and exploring possibilities of humanitarian collaboration, especially within the domain of disaster risk reduction (DRR). This paper examines the prospects for institutionalized Russia–Pakistan cooperation in disaster preparedness, emergency coordination, and resilience-building as a foundational element of their bilateral relations. In the past, Pakistan has experienced multiple geological and climatic catastrophes owing to erratic monsoon cycles, rapid glacial melts, flash floods, and severe heatwaves. These recurring disasters have affected the lives of millions of people, leading to displacement, infrastructure destruction, and long-term socioeconomic vulnerability. Russia possesses extensive experience in early warning systems, emergency rescue operations, civil defense coordination, and international humanitarian assistance through its Ministry of the Russian Federation for Civil Defence, Emergencies, and Elimination of Consequences of Natural Disasters (EMERCOM). Institutional collaboration between Pakistan's National Disaster Management Authority (NDMA) and EMERCOM presents a valuable opportunity to strengthen Pakistan's disaster preparedness and emergency response mechanisms. Preliminary engagements were initiated between the two sides in 2025; however, a sustained and institutional mechanism could bolster Pakistan's disaster resilience. The study employs a qualitative approach focusing on comparative institutional assessment and policy analysis to explore opportunities for collaboration in disaster risk reduction between Pakistan and Russia within the framework of the SCO. The study argues that humanitarian cooperation in the Pakistan-Russia relationship focused on building disaster resilience promotes trust-building and has the potential to strengthen the bilateral relationship beyond traditional security paradigms.

Keywords: Russia–Pakistan Relations; Humanitarian Cooperation; Disaster Risk Reduction; EMERCOM; NDMA; Polycentric World Order.

Biograpical Note

Dr. Sobia Hanif is an Assistant Professor at the Department of International Relations at Fatima Jinnah Women University, Rawalpindi, Pakistan. She specializes in the Politics of the Asia Pacific Region and has previously served as visiting faculty at National Defence University and National University of Modern Languages Islamabad. She has also been associated with the University of Texas at Austin, USA as a visiting faculty member.



Dr. Sobia Hanif
Fatima Jinnah
Women University

Public Diplomacy – A Must for Relational Future Between Pakistan and Russia

Abstract

Pakistan and Russia have had sinusoidal relations over the history, punctuated by close collaborations and fierce enmity. Post 9/11, consistent convergences and closeness is observed between the two countries. The perceptive treatment each meted by the other although has been dimmed yet there is a lot both Pakistan and Russia can achieve together to bring good not only to their own people but also to the region. There are many convergences that can bring the two countries close enough to reap benefits of each other's strength. While efforts on government level are being made to forge these relations via various domains, public diplomacy is what needs to be given priority. When people from different walks of life engage regularly, many new vistas are identified which help governments to chart a plausible course of action. People to people contact help understand culture, traditions and thought process of each side which ultimately reside as constant factors in identifying the joint benefit. People from academia, think tanks, media, arts, culture and educational institutions are the ones needing to interact with their counterparts frequently and consistently to conceive projects that prove to be mutually beneficial. The wisdom, experience and understanding on each side is therefore required to be shared via continued engagements for building coherent strategic narrative, developing mutual respect and shaping positive perceptions with relational outcome. This paper will aim to identify ways and means to achieve this objective through a study of the past, review of present and forecast of future.

Biograpical Note

I am an analyst, researcher, writer, host, moderator, communication strategist and event organiser. I have done masters in DSS from QAU Islamabad and masters in Mass Communication from AIOU Islamabad. I am associated with leading think tanks in Pakistan. These include PICS, MSF, PAYF and IRS where I am appointed as Communication Strategist. I have contributed more than 400 articles in English in international and domestic print media focusing on various aspects of security, geo-politics, international affairs, maritime affairs, regional connectivity and public diplomacy. I have hosted TV shows from the digital platform with renowned scholars, analysts and Subject Matter Experts. I am an alumnus of MARSEW from Pakistan Navy War College, Lahore, NSW from NDU Islamabad, NMW from NDU and NWB organised by Govt of Baluchistan, Pakistan. I have also attended Fellowships with different organisations/ institutes notably IPDS Bangkok, AIR Center Baku, Azerbaijan, FES, RCSS Colombo, Sri Lanka.



Reema Shaukat,
QAU Islamabad

Russia in Pakistani Public Imagination: A Constructivist Foreign Policy Analysis

Abstract

Constructivist theory explicates that collective meanings about foreign states are shaped through social interactions, historical memory, education systems, and political narratives. The underlying research reconnoiters how political discourses on national identity, and geopolitical consciousness among Pakistani youth shape public perception of Russia. This research reasons that public attitudes in Pakistan toward Russia are largely shaped through socially constructed meanings engendered by global political narratives, identity-based interpretations of international politics and ideological interpretations of global power structures. The study argues while employing Constructivist theory that Russia's image in Pakistan is not merely shaped by direct experiences or substantial interactions between the two states but largely constructed through public perceptions of Pakistan's strategic interests. The study proclaims that strategic geopolitical awareness among the Pakistani youth positively stimulates favorable public attitudes toward Russia, particularly in relation to perceptions of global power competition and regional security dynamics. The research also suggests that political communication, ontological security, anti-Americanism, role of leadership and media challenging traditional western stances act as intermediaries between international events and public perception formation. Furthermore, the study explores public support for Russia–Pakistan cooperation and its association with perceptions of Russia as a strategic counterbalance to Western global dominance. Russia is viewed by segments of the Pakistani public as a likely challenger to Western domination, contributing to its socially constructed international image. Methodologically, the research incorporates a quantitative cross-sectional survey design research design, using Likert-scale indicators to measure perception variables among Pakistani youth at public sector universities to measure public perception patterns. Survey questions are structured around key constructivist indicators including media influence, historical narratives, identity-based perception, geopolitical awareness, and foreign policy reasoning.

The study adds to international relations and foreign policy literature by providing empirical insights into socially constructed geopolitical perceptions in South Asian societies and offering policy implications for strengthening Russia–Pakistan diplomatic relations in a changing global political environment.

Biograpical Note

Dr. Falki is a faculty member at the Department of Political Science, LCWU; a women university in Lahore, Pakistan . She altogether has 20 years of teaching and research experience at graduate and post-graduate level. She has presented a multitude of her research papers at international and national conferences while also serving as Discussant and Co-chair in IPSA Conferences..



Dr. Sadia Mahmood Falki,
Women university in Lahore

From Gatekeeping to Permissiveness: Pakistan-Russia Relations and the Structural Limits of Western Alliance Discipline

Abstract

Since the end of the Cold War, Western powers have informally regulated the foreign policy alignments of non-Western states through sanctions, diplomatic pressure, aid conditionality, and threat discourse—a mechanism conceptualized here as alliance policing. This gatekeeping has historically constrained diversified partnerships by imposing material and reputational costs on states engaging actors deemed incompatible with the Western-led order.This paper will argue that the evolution of Pakistan-Russia relations provides empirical evidence of declining Western hegemonic discipline and the erosion of alliance gatekeeping in the post-unipolar global system. It will demonstrate that Pakistan's deepening engagement with Russia neither constitutes ideological realignment nor abandonment of traditional partnerships, but rather a strategic exercise of agency facilitated by the waning efficacy of Western exclusivity enforcement.

Methodologically, the paper will employ process tracing to examine policy shifts from 2001 to 2025 across three domains: high-level diplomatic visits and leadership statements; defense agreements and joint military exercises; and energy cooperation, including pipeline projects and LNG deals. By sequencing these engagements against Western responses, the analysis will identify inflection points where policing mechanisms failed to deter or reverse Pakistan's diversification.The findings will reveal that Pakistan has expanded ties with Russia in energy, defense, and Eurasian connectivity without prohibitive costs, exemplifying post-exclusivity diplomacy. This pattern will illustrate a broader shift: middle powers increasingly pursue issue-specific, interest-driven cooperation beyond binary alignments. Ultimately, Pakistan-Russia relations will signal rational adaptation to a permissive multipolar order, where Western gatekeeping no longer decisively constrains non-Western foreign policy autonomy.

Biograpical Note

Dr. Sidra Khan is an Assistant Professor of International Relations at Bahria University, Karachi. She holds a PhD in International Relations from Quaid-e-Azam University, Islamabad. Her teaching and research focus on U.S. foreign policy, South Asian security, strategic alliances, conflict resolution, and global governance, with a particular emphasis on Global South perspectives. Dr. Khan has published extensively in leading academic and policy-oriented journals on topics such as great power politics, regional security dynamics, the Kashmir issue, and evolving global orders. She has presented her research at numerous national and international conferences and actively engages with policy think tanks, including ISSRA, SVI, and CSCR. Beyond academia, she contributes to public discourse as a television host and guest expert, offering insights on international security and geopolitical developments. Her work bridges academic research, policy analysis, and media engagement.



Dr. Sidra Khan,
Bahria University,
Karachi

Russia-Pakistan Relations and the Shifting Balance of Power in South Asia

Abstract

The evolving trajectory of Russia-Pakistan relations reflects broader transformations in the regional and global distribution of power. Historically constrained by Cold War alignments and Russia's longstanding strategic partnership with India, Moscow-Islamabad ties have undergone cautious yet noticeable recalibration over the past decade. This paper applies Structural Realism to examine how systemic pressures and shifting balance of power dynamics in South Asia have contributed to this emerging engagement. It argues that three interrelated developments have driven Russia's outreach to Pakistan; the consolidation of the USA-India strategic partnership, the geopolitical consequences of the USA withdrawal from Afghanistan and Russia's strategic repositioning amid intensifying confrontation with the West following the Ukraine conflict. Within an evolving multipolar order, Moscow has sought to diversify its regional partnerships while Pakistan has pursued greater strategic autonomy through expanded diplomatic, security and energy cooperation beyond its traditional alignments. The study analyzes emerging areas of interaction, including defense dialogue, joint military exercises, energy collaborationz, particularly crude oil imports since 2023, and coordination within multilateral frameworks such as the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation (SCO). At the same time, structural constraints remain significant, especially Russia's enduring defense and technological relationship with India which limits the depth of strategic convergence with Pakistan. The paper contends that Russia- Pakistan engagement represents not an alliance realignment but a pragmatic balancing adjustment within a fluid regional order characterized by flexible alignments and selective cooperation, thereby contributing to subtle shifts in South Asia's balance of power amid systemic transition

Biograpical Note

Dr. Muhammad Arif Khan holds a PhD in International Relations with a research focus on territorial disputes and their implications for state security and cooperation. His broader research interests include geopolitics, strategic competition, and regional security, with a particular focus on South Asia. Dr. Khan has contributed to several SCOPUS-indexed publications, including book chapters and edited volumes on contemporary issues in international relations. He actively participates in international academic conferences and collaborative research projects, reflecting his engagement with global scholarly networks.



Dr. Muhammad Arif Khan,
PhD in International Relations

Pakistan-Russia Relations in the Era of Multi-Alignment

Abstract

The gradual shift in international system from unipolarity to multipolarity has created a strategic space for the middle powers to pursue flexible foreign policy strategies beyond rigid alliances. Pakistan's strategic positioning has encouraged the adoption of multi-alignment strategy, characterized by concurrent engagement with major powers, particularly China, the United States, and Russia. Despite extensive scholarship on Pakistan's relations with China and USA, Russia's role remains conceptually underdeveloped and institutionally fragmented. This paper argues that Pakistan-Russia relations should be understood as a broader triangular multi-alignment strategy rather than a purely bilateral partnership. drawing multi-alignment theory and neoclassical realism, the study employs qualitative document analysis and policy discourse review to identify academic and policy gaps that constrain deeper bilateral cooperation. The findings indicate that Russia is a stimulus for functional diversification in Pakistan's strategic calculus, most notably in the domains of energy, regional diplomacy, and defense dialogue. However, this engagement remains largely episodic due to institutional fragmentation, sanctions sensitivities, and limited scholarly theorization. The paper concludes that bridging academic and policy gaps is crucial for meaningful integration of Russia in Pakistan's long-term foreign policy framework.

Biograpical Note

Dr. Sidra Ahmed holds a PhD in International Relations, with her research focusing on Muslim identity formation in secular Europe and its implications for social, economic, and political integration. Her academic work is grounded in decolonial perspectives, alternative narratives, and multi-alignment approaches to global politics. She is the President and founding member of the Centre for Alternative Perspectives (CAP), an independent women-led think tank, where she leads a team of emerging scholars and has authored 14 research papers. She has also served on the Higher Education Commission's National Curriculum Review Committee (NCRC) for International Relations and contributed to the development of BS and MPhil IR programs at DHA Suffa University and Bahria University Karachi. Beyond academia, she works as a political analyst, corporate trainer, and consultant, specializing in diplomacy, strategic communication, leadership development, and organizational capacity building



Dr. Sidra Ahmad,
Bahria University

Countering Terrorism - A Shared Interest between Russia and Pakistan

Abstract

As victims to the scourge of terrorism, Pakistan and Russia are both much concerned about its devastating effects. Despite the fact Russia recognised Islamic Emirate of Afghanistan on 3 July 2025, it is well aware of the regime's incapability to uproot terrorists from its homeland. The Russian Foreign Ministry report on the subject dated 23 February 2026 highlighting presence of over 20000 terrorists inside Afghanistan belonging to various organisations is a testament to this fact. Pakistan is severely affected by the terrorists' activities emanating from its neighbour Afghanistan. The failure of Afghan Taliban's regime to respond positively to Pakistan's demands of denying the terrorists its territory brought both countries to loggerheads on 26 February 2026 when they were engaged in an armed conflict. There is a clear and present danger that if Afghanistan is left to become hotbed of terrorism once again, it will spill over to the entire region including Central Asia, South Asia and West Asia. A variety of solutions need to be worked out aimed at arresting the growing situation. Pakistan and Russia with their credible political clout possessing intent, capability and valuable experience are in a potent position to jointly curb the menace. Afghanistan and terrorism brewing inside its territory therefore form natural convergence between both countries. There is a need to forge cooperation and collaboration between them to identify requisite measures and jointly work on them so as to protect the region from this exacerbating plaque. This paper is aimed to discern the possible avenues of collaboration between Pakistan and Russia that can be put to a workable joint strategy against terrorism emanating from Afghanistan.

Biograpical Note

Rear Admiral (Retd.) Syed Faisal Ali Shah, Hilal-e-Imtiaz (Military), retired from the Pakistan Navy after over three decades of distinguished service. Belonging to the Marines branch, he holds the distinction of being the first Marine officer to attain the rank of two-star admiral. He also served as Naval and Air Attaché in Iran. He holds multiple advanced degrees, including an MPhil in Public Policy, MSc in Defence and Strategic Studies, MSc in War Studies, Master of Military Studies from the United States, and an MBA in Human Resource Management. He is a graduate of NDU Islamabad, PN War College Lahore, and the US Marine Corps Command and Staff College, Virginia. His specialized training includes Satellite Imagery Interpretation from SUPARCO and a Counter-Terrorism Fellowship from US CENTCOM. A seasoned expert in policymaking, strategic planning, Middle East and Central Asia affairs, terrorism, and maritime security, he is an Honorary Research Fellow at NIMA and a regular contributor to academic and media platforms.



Syed Faisal Ali Shah,
National Institute Of Maritime Affairs

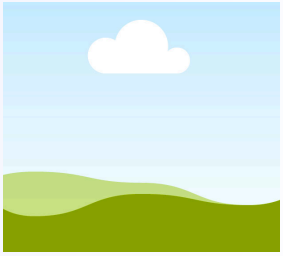
Dynamics of Trade Relations between Russia and Pakistan: Analysis and Prospects.

Abstract

Trade relations between Russia and Pakistan have experienced substantial growth and structural transformation during the period 2020–2025, reflecting the strengthening of bilateral economic cooperation and shifting global trade dynamics. Trade turnover between the two countries more than doubled, driven by intensified political dialogue, the establishment of an intergovernmental commission on trade and economic cooperation, and Russia's strategic diversification of export markets in response to geopolitical developments. Russian exports to Pakistan increased by approximately 2.75 times, rising from $695.7 million in 2020 to $1.91 billion in 2025, with the highest annual growth recorded in 2023. The primary contributors to export growth included agricultural commodities, energy products, and defense-related goods. During the same period, Russian imports from Pakistan expanded more than fourfold, from $93.8 million to $398.1 million, supported mainly by textiles, food products, and emerging pharmaceutical supplies. The structure of bilateral trade also underwent notable changes. Agricultural products became increasingly dominant in Russian exports, while machinery and equipment gained a larger share. On the import side, textiles and clothing remained the leading category, whereas pharmaceuticals emerged as a new and promising sector. Trade relations accelerated significantly after 2022 due to changes in the international economic environment and the expansion of Russian-Pakistani political engagement. The study further identifies several promising areas for future cooperation, including the establishment of a technology hub in Islamabad, collaboration in digital public services, joint pharmaceutical production, educational exchange programs in high-technology fields, and the localization of Russian software production in Pakistan. If effectively implemented, these initiatives could raise bilateral trade turnover to approximately $5–6 billion by 2030, strengthening long-term economic partnership and regional connectivity between the two countries.

Biograpical Note

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Olga Viktorovna Kirillova,
Kazan Federal University

Pakistan-Russia Counter-Terrorism Collaboration for Regional Stability: The Afghan Context

Abstract

Pakistan and Russia are promoting collaboration on counterterrorism to advance regional stability, mainly from the Eurasian Security perspective. In this context, their primary security concern is Afghanistan's protracted instability. Since 2021, when the US forces withdrew from Afghanistan, the two countries have become more engaged with each other diplomatically and strategically to counter active insurgent networks in Afghanistan, such as Tehrik-i-Taliban and ISKP. These networks pose an immense threat to the internal and external interests of Pakistan and Russia. In Pakistan, they are a cause of cross-border terrorism, internal security threats, and refugee stresses. Simultaneously, they can jeopardize Russia's Central Asian interests in general and the Eurasian Security Architecture in particular. The purpose of this study is to examine the strategic convergence between Islamabad and Moscow in counterterrorism cooperation. This study finds that Islamabad and Moscow share concerns about extremism originating in Afghanistan and implement practical measures to prevent it. Within the framework of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation (SCO), the two countries focus on intelligence sharing, conduct joint military exercises, combat drug trafficking, and coordinate efforts to prevent cross-border terrorist threats and attacks. Through this collaboration, both countries can approach the de facto Afghan administration to seek its cooperation in strengthening security mechanisms for regional stability. The study concludes that Pakistan-Russia security cooperation is inevitable for the evolution of the Eurasian Security Architecture and overall regional stability

Biograpical Note

Dr. Ishrat Afshan Abbasi is a Professor in the Department of International Relations at the University of Sindh, Jamshoro, where she has been a faculty member since 2004 and has served as Chair since January 2019. She holds an M.Phil. from the School of Politics and International Relations (SPIR), Quaid-i-Azam University, Islamabad, and a PhD from the University of Erfurt, Germany. Her research focuses on Middle Eastern affairs, particularly peace and conflict, human security, political Islam, and the sociology of Islam. She is also a member of the Board of Governors at the Area Studies Centre for Far East and South East Asia Studies, University of Sindh. Dr. Abbasi has participated in several prestigious international programs, including the International Visitor Leadership Program (USA), Japan–South Asia Youth Invitation Program (Tokyo), Women in Security and Conflict Management (New Delhi), Regional Centre for Strategic Studies (Colombo), and the IAHR World Congress (Erfurt)., Germany.



Dr. Ishrat Afshan Abassi,
niversity of Sindh, Jamshoro

Russia and Pakistan in Modern International Relations in a Polycentric World

Abstract

How are Russia-Pakistan relations being reconfigured in the context of a new polycentric world order, and what do these developments tell us about the changing contours of international security and cooperation? This paper investigates the strategic reorientation of Russia-Pakistan relations in light of changing global power balances, regional turmoil, and the transfer of authority to multiple centers of influence. Going beyond the Cold War rivalries, this research inquiry seeks to determine whether Russia and Pakistan are forging a new partnership based on shared security interests and strategic diplomacy. In terms of methodology, this paper adopts a qualitative research approach that incorporates process tracing, discourse analysis of official pronouncements and joint communiques, and policy document analysis. There is a focus on activities within the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation framework, as well as other joint military exercises and energy security initiatives. The research incorporates both traditional and non-traditional security areas, including counter-terrorism, defense partnership, and regional stability in Afghanistan, as well as energy security, climate change resilience, cyber security, and economic sustainability. The key argument advanced is that Russia–Pakistan engagement reflects adaptive, interest-driven diplomacy characteristic of a polycentric system rather than ideological alignment or alliance formation. Findings suggest that while defense and counterterrorism cooperation have deepened incrementally, the most sustainable avenues of partnership lie in connectivity projects, energy cooperation, and multilateral coordination. However, structural constraints, competing regional alignments, economic limitations, and external geopolitical pressures continue to limit strategic depth. The study concludes that Russia Pakistan relations exemplify how middle and major powers navigate complex interdependencies to maximize strategic autonomy in an increasingly multipolar and contested international order

Biograpical Note

Dr. Lubna Sunawar is a scholar of Peace and Conflict Studies, specializing in international security, radicalization, post-conflict peacebuilding, and the role of emerging technologies in global politics. Her research critically examines the intersection of structural violence, relative deprivation, and extremism, with a regional focus on fragile and conflict-affected states such as Afghanistan, Iraq, Somalia, and Yemen. She has developed innovative theoretical contributions, including the Deprivation Radicalization Escalation Model (DREM), and incorporates AI-driven discourse analysis and geospatial mapping into conflict research. Her work reflects a strong interdisciplinary approach, combining theory with methodological innovation. Dr. Sunawar has presented at international conferences and contributes to discussions on climate-induced migration, human rights, and the ethical use of technology in education and security governance. She is also actively engaged in curriculum development, linking international relations theory with contemporary global challenges



Dr. Lubna Sunawar,
National Defence University

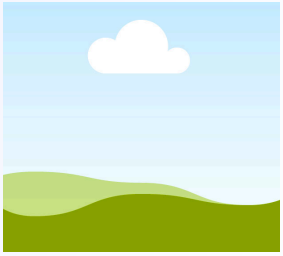
Regional Security Complex Dynamics and the Strategic Convergence between Russia and Pakistan

Abstract

This paper examines the increasing strategic convergence between Russia and Pakistan within the framework of the Regional Security Complex Theory. For much of the Cold War, the two countries were on opposing sides of the global political landscape, with minimal cooperation. However, their connection has improved recently as a result of shifting regional and international dynamics. The study argues that this shift is not the result of ideological alignment but a pragmatic response to evolving security dynamics in South and Central Asia. This convergence can be explained by three important factors: shared concerns about Afghanistan's instability, expanded defence cooperation, and increased energy coordination. After the U.S. withdrawal from Afghanistan, both Moscow and Islamabad have sought to prevent the spread of extremism and maintain regional stability. Simultaneously, combined military training exercises and energy agreements reflect shared strategic and economic interests. Using a qualitative analytical method, the study demonstrates how Russia and Pakistan are adapting their foreign policy to a changing regional security environment characterized by multipolarity and shifting alliances. Although constraints exist, particularly Russia's close partnership with India, the relationship indicates cautious but consistent participation. The study indicates that Russia-Pakistan convergence represents a practical adaptation to regional security pressures rather than the formation of a formal alliance

Biograpical Note

Dr. Omme Asma is a dedicated faculty member in the Department of Political Science at Government College University, Lahore. With a strong academic background and a commitment to excellence in teaching and research, her areas of interest include international relations, political theory, and contemporary global politics. She has contributed to academic scholarship through research publications and active participation in conferences and seminars. The second author, Prof. Dr. Fauzia Ghani, serves as the Chairperson of the Department of Political Science at the same institution. She is a distinguished academic with extensive experience in research, teaching, and academic leadership. Her work focuses on governance, public policy, and international relations, and she has played a significant role in promoting research culture and academic development within the department.



Omme Asma Qaiser,
Government College University, Lahore

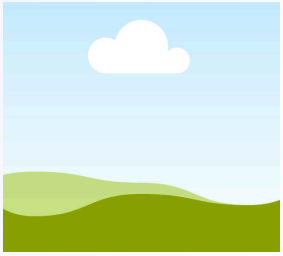
Patriotism in the Media in Russia and Pakistan: How Influencers Turn National Pride into a Trend

Abstract

This paper presents a comparative analysis of the phenomenon of patriotic influence in the media spaces of Russia and Pakistan. The study focuses on the transformation of national pride into a popular trend, actively promoted by influencers to a youth audience. The relevance of this topic stems from the growing role of social media as a platform for civil discourse and a tool of soft power in the digital age. The first part of the paper examines the Russian experience, where state rhetoric is integrated into bloggers' everyday content. An analysis of academic sources reveals that youth movement leaders and popular video bloggers employ influencer techniques (emotional engagement, demonstrations of "simple life") to convey pro-Kremlin narratives. This occurs both through direct funding and educational programs for bloggers in new territories, and through the creation of "viral" content that romanticizes patriotism through the prism of traditional values, volunteerism, or village life. The second part of the paper focuses on the Pakistani context, where patriotic discourse on social media is also a significant phenomenon. It examines the polarization of the field: from mass displays of loyalty by celebrities on Independence Day to the use of patriotic rhetoric to uphold the state narrative and counter anti-state campaigns. At the same time, the flip side of the phenomenon is also highlighted: the social pressure on influencers who avoid sensitive political topics, risking being accused of a lack of patriotism. Particular attention is paid to how patriotism becomes a tool for mobilization in the information war, while criticism of state institutions is automatically labeled by opponents as treason. The conclusion points to a convergent trend in both countries: patriotism is ceasing to be an abstract idea and becoming a commodity and an element of personal branding. Influencers are acting as key intermediaries between state ideology and mass audiences, adapting complex political narratives to entertainment and everyday content formats.

Biograpical Note

Senior Lecturer, Department of Political Science, Financial University under the Government of the Russian Federation



Stepan Borisovich Vasilenko,
Financial University under the Government of the Russian Federation

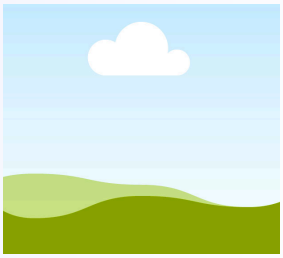
Strategic Convergence in Russia- Pakistan Relations in the Changing Global Order: A Neoclassical Realist and Pragmatic Analysis

Abstract

Amid intensifying great power competition and the gradual transition toward a multipolar international system Russia-Pakistan relations have undergone a noticeable reorientation. Historically characterized by limited engagement recent interactions indicate a selective convergence shaped by evolving geopolitical constraints rather than ideological alignment. This paper examines the emerging trajectory of Russia-Pakistan relations through the combined lens of neoclassical realism and strategic pragmatism. Neoclassical realism provides a framework to assess how systemic pressures such as shifting power configurations, regional instability in South Asia and Afghanistan and the erosion of US centric global influence interact with domestic political and strategic considerations to shape foreign policy choices. Strategic pragmatism further explains the issue based nature of bilateral engagement, emphasizing functional cooperation in areas including security coordination, energy diplomacy and regional connectivity without the formation of formal alliance commitments. The study argues that Russia and Pakistan are driven by overlapping but limited interests resulting in a flexible partnership that prioritizes strategic autonomy and policy adaptability. This pattern reflects a broader trend in contemporary international relations, where states pursue selective cooperation to manage uncertainty while avoiding binding obligations. By situating Russia Pakistan relations within this theoretical framework the paper contributes to a nuanced understanding of middle power diplomacy and non-alliance-based convergence in a changing global order. The findings highlight the significance of pragmatic alignment as an alternative to traditional alliance structures in an increasingly fragmented international system.

Biograpical Note

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Dr. Tatheer Sherazi,
Financial University under the Government of the Russian Federation

Strategic Convergence in Russia- Pakistan Relations in the Changing Global Order: A Neoclassical Realist and Pragmatic Analysis

Abstract

Amid intensifying great power competition and the gradual transition toward a multipolar international system Russia-Pakistan relations have undergone a noticeable reorientation. Historically characterized by limited engagement recent interactions indicate a selective convergence shaped by evolving geopolitical constraints rather than ideological alignment. This paper examines the emerging trajectory of Russia-Pakistan relations through the combined lens of neoclassical realism and strategic pragmatism. Neoclassical realism provides a framework to assess how systemic pressures such as shifting power configurations, regional instability in South Asia and Afghanistan and the erosion of US centric global influence interact with domestic political and strategic considerations to shape foreign policy choices. Strategic pragmatism further explains the issue based nature of bilateral engagement, emphasizing functional cooperation in areas including security coordination, energy diplomacy and regional connectivity without the formation of formal alliance commitments. The study argues that Russia and Pakistan are driven by overlapping but limited interests resulting in a flexible partnership that prioritizes strategic autonomy and policy adaptability. This pattern reflects a broader trend in contemporary international relations, where states pursue selective cooperation to manage uncertainty while avoiding binding obligations. By situating Russia Pakistan relations within this theoretical framework the paper contributes to a nuanced understanding of middle power diplomacy and non-alliance-based convergence in a changing global order. The findings highlight the significance of pragmatic alignment as an alternative to traditional alliance structures in an increasingly fragmented international system.

Biograpical Note

Ms. Khushboo Farid Khan Ghouri is a Lecturer at FAST-NUCES (National University of Computer and Emerging Sciences), Pakistan, and a PhD Fellow at the Department of International Relations, University of Karachi. She has over six years of teaching and research experience in higher education, with academic expertise in strategic studies, Nuclear Studies, emerging technologies, cybersecurity, gender studies, human rights, and global power politics. Her doctoral research examines the impact of emerging technologies on future great power competition, while her MPhil work focused on cyberspace as a domain of power and competitiveness in international relations. She has published extensively in peer-reviewed national and international journals and has contributed to IEEE-indexed conference proceedings and edited volumes. Ms. Ghouri actively participates in international academic forums and is a member of the Midwest Political Science Association and Center for Alternative Perspectives. Her work bridges academic research, policy relevance, and interdisciplinary inquiry in contemporary international relations and discourse.



Khushboo Farid Khan Ghouri,
FAST-NUCES

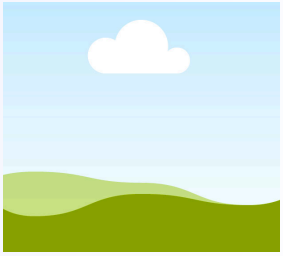
Russia-Pakistan Relations and the Role of China: The Triangular Geopolitical Logic of Convergence

Abstract

During the Cold War, Pakistan and Russia stood on the opposite sides of global strategic and ideological divides. Post Cold war this ideological and strategic rigidity between the two countries gradually started dismantling. Today, the interstate relationship between the two countries has shifted from suspicion to pragmatic cooperation in geopolitical and geoeconomics domains. Russia seeks to challenge the U.S unipolarity and global hegemony and wants to expand its influence in not only Asia but in the Global South. Pakistan is viewed by Russia not merely as a U.S ally but also an important security stakeholder in the region. Pakistan's growing engagement with Russia means diversification of its foreign policy beyond the U.S and China. It also means the enhancement of its regional relevance and significance in Central Asia and Afghanistan. China plays a pivotal role in Russia-Pakistan relationship. Russia and China share an unlimited partnership against pressing western geopolitical and geoeconomics pressure campaigns. China is a close defense and strategic partner of Pakistan and creates that important triangular geopolitical logic of helping advance future Russia Pakistan cooperation and partnership. This paper attempts to explore this triangular logic and China's role in providing the triangular depth to the growing Russia-Pakistan geopolitical and geoeconomics engagement. The paper also examines Afghanistan as the key convergence point and argues how the shared concerns of, terrorism, ISIS-K expansion and spilling over of radical Islamism to Central Asian States, China and South Asia necessitates the adherence to the triangular geopolitical logic of cooperation between all three-stake holder, Russia, China and Pakistan. In the end, the paper will recommend how the triangular geopolitical logic of convergence in Afghanistan can help create a stable and enabling environment for not only the development of Russia-Pakistan future relations but also the weakening of western monopolies and strengthening of power centers like SCO and BRI in the region

Biograpical Note

Dr. Muhammad Ali Ehsan is an Assistant Professor of International Relations in the Department of Humanities and Social Sciences at DHA Suffa University, Karachi. He also serves as a Non-Resident Research Fellow at the Institute of Policy Research Institute (IPRI), Islamabad. Since 2012, he has been a weekly columnist for The Express Tribune, where he writes on national and international affairs. He is the author of three books, including Russia, China and Pakistan – Trilateral Partnership in Changing World Order (2026), The Russian–Ukraine Crisis (2023), and Two Years of Democracy in Pakistan (2018–2020) (2021). He earned his PhD from the University of Karachi in 2017 and completed a postdoctoral fellowship at Kazan Federal University, Russia, in 2023. Currently, he is pursuing a second PhD in International Relations at Tomsk State University, where he has also served as a faculty member.



Dr. Muhammad Ali ,
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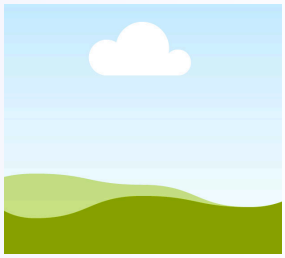
Regional Connectivity- Stagnation and Way forward

Abstract

Pakistan's geographic position offers significant potential to serve as a land bridge connecting South Asia, Central Asia, and the Middle East. This potential remains underutilized due to limited cross-border rail connectivity. Pakistan sits in a strategically important region. It borders China to the north, India to the east, and Iran and Afghanistan to the west. Each neighboring country presents distinct economic and geopolitical opportunities. The southern boundary along the Arabian Sea grants access to major international shipping routes, making Pakistan a key maritime crossroads. Pakistan is uniquely located to connect Central Asia, the Middle East, and China. Pakistan faces connectivity challenges. However, an integrated mixed-methods approach can better connect Pakistan Railways (PR) with networks in the Central Asian Republics (CARs), including Turkmenistan, Uzbekistan, Kazakhstan, Kyrgyzstan, and Tajikistan, as well as with Afghanistan, Iran, and China. The analysis focuses on improving Pakistan's overland access to Central Asia and expanding further to Russia. Drawing on transport geography and regional integration literature, the research assesses the impact of transnational railway corridors on trade flows, spatial accessibility, and regional power dynamics across Eurasia. A comparative assessment highlights the Quetta–Chaman–Kandahar–Torghundi–Serhetabat–Turkmenabat–Bukhara route. This route is the most spatially efficient and economically viable option to connect Pakistan with Central Asia and the post-Soviet railway network in southern Russia. Additional corridors, such as the Quetta–Zahedan and Peshawar–Kabul routes, are also evaluated for their potential to promote broader regional integration. These routes can further support multimodal connectivity between the Arabian Sea and Eurasian markets. GIS-based modeling shows that better rail links decrease transit distances and logistics costs. This enhances Pakistan's access to Central Asian economies and supports freight flows to Russia. The framework explains how structural and institutional factors, such as break-of gauge incompatibilities, limited financing, political instability, and security risks—hinder transnational rail development. Within the China–Pakistan Economic Corridor (CPEC), the Trans-Asian Railway Network, and the Belt and Road Initiative (BRI), Pakistan Railways can serve as an intermediary linking South Asia, Central Asia, and Russia. Rail-based connectivity can reshape regional interactions and help Pakistan join emerging Eurasian transport networks. The findings provide practical guidance for planners and decision makers wanting to improve Pakistan, Central Asia connectivity using spatially informed, evidence-based transport strategies

Biograpical Note

Dr Asim is working as the Head of Department, at Centre of Excellence in Transportation/Railway Engineering (COETRE), Department of Transportation Engineering, at Pak Austria Fachhochschule: Institute of Applied Sciences and Technology, Haripur, KPK, Pakistan. completed his PhD in Transportation Planning Engineering from the University of Sciences and Technology, Beijing, China, in 2019.



Dr. Asim Farooq ,
Institute of Applied Sciences and Technology, Haripur, KPK

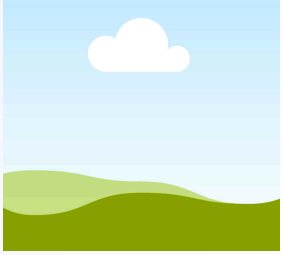
Geopolitics and Economic Engagement: The Evolution of Russia–Pakistan Relations in a Changing Global Order

Abstract

Pakistan–Russia relations have undergone significant transformations in the last two decades. The transformation of unipolar to a growing multipolar global order, and the Increasing importance of geo-economics, have facilitated both states to reconsider their foreign policy priorities. This study highlights the transformational trajectory of Pakistan-Russia relations, analyzing how the bilateral ties have evolved to a multifaceted, dimensional partnership. From the perspective of a changing global system, this research analyzes the relationship between strategic security imperatives and emerging economic needs. This study identifies that changing international power dynamics, regional security interests, and economic requirements have inspired both states to reevaluate their foreign policy preferences. The study highlights the post-9/11 shift in Pakistan-Russia relations, where initial counter-terrorism cooperation evolved into a comprehensive engagement. In the background of opportunity, energy cooperation, and regional connectivity arise as vital factors of engagement. In the background of opportunity, energy cooperation, and regional connectivity arise as vital factors of engagement. Pakistan's energy import diversification through Russian crude oil, discussions over long-term supply preparations, and dialogue on adjacent infrastructure upgradation signal growing economic diplomacy. Multilateral platforms, such as the Shanghai Cooperation Organization, have created an institutional chance for political negotiation and security cooperation. Moreover, networking projects related to the International North-South Transport Corridor show a common interest in integrating Pakistan into wider Eurasian trade networks. Despite this pragmatic easing, serious challenges hinder the strengthening of the relationship, including financial and political pressures from American sanctions. The present research is qualitative in nature. Both primary and secondary sources of data were used for this study. The study concludes that a durable partnership will depend on institutionalizing economic cooperation, handling strategic balances, and generating sanctions-immune financial frameworks, mirroring and assessing the dynamics of global change.

Biograpical Note

Prof. Dr. Salma Naz is a distinguished scholar in Political Science and International Relations, currently serving as professor of Political Science at Minhaj University, Lahore. She holds a Ph.D. from the University of the Punjab and has over two decades of experience in teaching and research. Her expertise spans research methodology, political theory, international relations, crisis management, globalization, governance, and social responsibility. She has published extensively in international journals and presented her research at global conferences. She has also supervised numerous MPhil students across Political Science, Pakistan Studies, History, and International Relations. Known for her analytical skills and ability to communicate complex ideas, she is dedicated to mentoring students and fostering critical thinking. As a leader, she promotes interdisciplinary research, industry collaboration, and community engagement.



Prof. Dr. Salma Naz
Minhaj University, Lahore

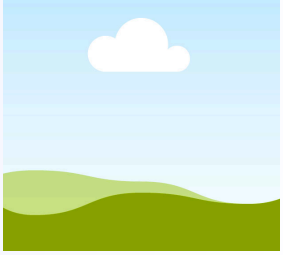
Pakistan–Russia Relations in an Emerging Multipolar World: A Regional Security Complex Analysis of Strategic and Economic Engagement

Abstract

The recent shift in geopolitics and geoeconomics has resulted in new global alignments, with middle powers becoming more significant in shaping regional importance. This shifting dynamic reflects a broader crisis in the existing world order, moving from unipolarity to multipolarity. Pakistan located in a central position of powers, is significantly inflicted by these changes. Earlier, Pakistan have had remained aligned with the US, however, with fluctuations in the US-Pak ties. Hence, it is high time for Pakistan to reconsider the ties with US and look for alternative ways for its economic growth through engaging its partnership with new emerging powers like; China, Russia and the Middle Eastern countries, particularly amid shifting US priorities. Pakistan lies in a geostrategic position on the globe, providing a connecting energy route to Gulf countries with East Asia and Europe. Owing to the geographic route, Russia and Pakistan have signed economic deals, strategic deals amid the new power dynamics in the region. The current research focuses on Pakistan-Russia relations through the lens of Regional Security Complex Theory (RSCT) which identifies a group of states whose primary national security issues are strongly correlate d that they cannot be addressed independently. The theory views security interdependence as a key element in the creation of geographic groups. Since the post Ukraine Russia war, Pakistan is engaging with Russia through energy deals, security ties, and cultural exchanges programs driven by mutual interest. The researcher aims to examine the risks and opportunities for Pakistan and Russia economic and diplomatic relations aligned with the objectives of promoting sustainable economic growth and decent work through strategic collaboration

Biograpical Note

Dr. Muhammad Habib is an Assistant Professor in the Department of Humanities and Social Sciences at Bahria University, Karachi Campus, where he has been teaching and conducting research since January 2024. He holds a PhD in Political Science from the University of Karachi, reflecting his expertise in political analysis and governance. His academic interests span political science, international relations, public policy, and foreign policy, with particular focus on CPEC and regional geopolitics. At Bahria University, he teaches undergraduate and postgraduate courses while actively contributing to research on public policy, political culture, and international affairs. Dr. Habib has published in national and international peer-reviewed journals on topics including women's political representation, policymaking processes, and security issues in the Indian Ocean region. He is also engaged in academic networking and collaborative research, mentoring students and contributing to the advancement of social sciences scholarship in Pakistan.



Dr. Muhammad Habib.
Bahria University, Karachi

“Ethical Literary Criticism of Discourses Across Civilizations: A Comparative Analysis of Leo Tolstoy and Ashfaq Ahmed's Selected Works

Abstract

This study explores ethical discourses in Russian and Pakistani literature as a bridge for cross-cultural dialogue, employing Nie Zhenzhao’s Ethical Literary Criticism (2023) as it’s theoretical framework. Ethical Literary Criticism posits literature as records of human moral experiences, structured by ethical knots (moral dilemmas), ethical lines (narrative progressions of ethical choices), and ethical selection (choosing moral reason over animal instincts). By applying this lens, the paper compares Leo Tolstoy’s short story “How Much Land Does a Man Need?” (1886) and selected texts from Ashfaq Ahmed’s drama “Mann Chalay Ka Sauda” (1970s), highlighting shared themes of material greed for spiritual and moral fulfillment. In Tolstoy’s narrative, the protagonist’s insatiable desire for land forms the central ethical knot, a conflict between human ambition (animal factor) and moral restraint. His ethical line unfolds through escalating acquisitions, culminating in his fatal overreach during a land-walking challenge, where he dies exhausted, needing only six feet for burial. This illustrates ethical selection that protagonist’s preference to greed over morality leads to self-destruction, echoing Tolstoy’s Christian humanism on contentment and non-possession. On the other hand, Ahmed’s text delves into existential sorrow as humanity’s “basic tragedy,” questioning life’s purpose beyond wealth, honor, and luxury. The ethical knot emerges in the awakening from material satisfaction to metaphysical inquiry; why one exists, suffers, and dies, and whether justice awaits. The ethical line traces a phenomenological journey toward spiritual consciousness, urging ethical selection by rejecting superficial pursuits for deeper self-realization, rooted in Sufi influenced Pakistani culture. By using qualitative approach for this comparative analysis, the study reveals dialogic parallels: both works reconstruct ethical order by warning against animal instincts (greed, complacency) in favor of moral humans pursuing transcendence. This research strengthens Russia-Pakistan humanitarian ties by highlighting literature’s capacity to bridge shared values and offer vital lessons for ethical progress in a polycentric world

Biograpical Note

Haadia Haseeb is a 22-year-old multilingual scholar and a Master’s candidate in Foreign Languages and Intercultural Communication at the National Research University–Higher School of Economics (Moscow, Russia), where she studies on a full academic scholarship. She holds a Bachelor’s degree (Honours) in English Literature from the University of Management and Technology (Sialkot, Pakistan), graduating with multiple Merit Awards in recognition of her academic excellence. An active and dedicated researcher, Haadia’s academic interests span world literatures, linguistics, philosophy, semiotics, and cultural studies. She has presented her research at numerous international conferences across Pakistan, the State of Azad Jammu and Kashmir, Malaysia, China, and Russia, reflecting her strong engagement with global academic discourse. With a passion for interdisciplinary inquiry and cross-cultural understanding, Haadia continues to contribute thoughtfully to the evolving landscape of humanities research



Haadia Haseeb.
National Research University–Higher School of Economics (Moscow, Russia)

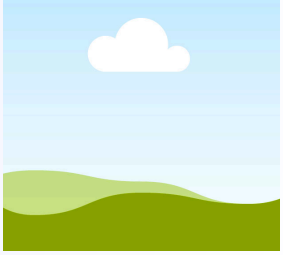
Priority of preserving natural heritage sites over cultural heritage sites

Abstract

UNESCO's cultural heritage sites vastly outweigh natural heritage sites; this study criticizes this imbalance and argues that it would be better if the opposite were true, given the global threat of climate change. The threats to natural heritage sites, particularly in vulnerable regions, caused by climate change are considered, along with numerous arguments that the conservation of natural heritage sites actually benefits cultural heritage sites in the long term from the extreme negative impacts of climate change if the opposite were done. UNESCO's emphasis on selecting natural heritage sites over cultural heritage sites is driven by various published documents. UNESCO's emphasis on selecting natural heritage sites over cultural heritage sites is driven by various published documents. Climate change is a phenomenon that must be taken into account before taking any action in our time. UNESCO plays a vital role in addressing this global emergency, and protecting natural heritage sites can be of great help in ensuring the future of the planet and its people.

Biograpical Note

Ali Sher Durrani is a graduate from the Institute of Statistical Studies and Economics of Knowledge (ISSEK), Moscow. He received his bachelor's degree in business adminsitration from Institute of Business Management, Karachi and a master's degree from HSE University, Moscow. He currently works as a teacher of English language at Star Talk: School of Foreign Languages. He is interested in Russian Language, History, and Business Studies.



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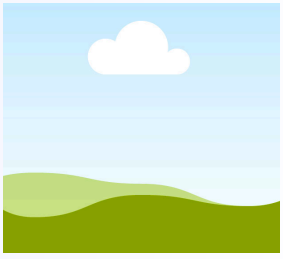
Increasing Pakistan-Russia Academic Collaboration: Understanding Non-Western Political Narratives

Abstract

The growing Pakistan-Russia multidimensional cooperation has presently become an essential feature of South Asian regional interconnectedness with the great power politics. The leaders of both states have decided to rationalise their aspired plans of widening bilateral collaborations in the various unexplored areas. While calculating the ongoing strengths of Pakistan-Russia relations mainly in the economic and strategic domains, the academic joint ventures are still an area of seeking appropriate attentions of two-sided government authorities. The underwhelmed academic cooperation inadequately facilitates the intellectual communities of both nations in synchronising their scholarly approaches to world politics. In this scenario, the contemporary academic approaches of Pakistan's higher studies institutions are merely centred on Western theoretical descriptions of world politics while ignoring the role of non-Western approaches in academia. Thus, Pakistan-based academic community and Islamabad-based leading policymaking circles generally prefer to adopt a Western lens to study the changing patterns of the international system, which has marginalized the significance of diverse literature, especially in the fields of politics and International Relations (IR). It has comprised the intellectual properties of Pakistani academic communities and affected their capabilities of exploring the non-Western approaches of world politics, where Russian academic perspectives on international politics are absent. An unprecedented growth of Western literature in Pakistan and its deep-penetration in the country's higher studies structure have further underestimated the vision of a productive Islamabad-Moscow engagement in developing a combined research and development culture. Based on this scenario, this paper seeks to provide a comprehensive understanding of Russian intellectual approaches to see the world from a different perspective. The paper's central argument concerning the significance of Russian literature in Pakistani academia could be treated as an intellectual endeavour to diversify the existing theoretical perspectives of the Pakistan's mainstream scholarly debates.

Biograpical Note

Missing



Dr Attiq ur Rehman.

The Indian campaign of Zahir ad-din Muhammad Babur in India: the change in his religious image

Abstract

In the early 16th century, Zahir al-Din Muhammad Babur, as a member of the Timurid clan, actively engaged in the struggle for the Timurid political legacy. However, for a number of reasons, he suffered a series of setbacks in his confrontation with his rivals. As a result, Babur left Transoxiana and, after some time, found himself in India, where he succeeded in inflicting military defeat on his opponents. Of particular significance was his victory over one of his most powerful adversaries, the Rajput military leader Rana Sangram Singh, which played a decisive role in the creation of a new Muslim state in India. It was this victory, which contributed to the expansion of the Islamic world's borders, that led to the transformation of Babur's religious imageWhile previously, authors of written sources often characterized him as an "enemy of religion and the state," over time, their assessment shifted, and he began to be perceived as a "ghazi" and "expander of the boundaries of Islam." Furthermore, Babur's decision to abolish the tamgha tax in the conquered territories and the provision of significant assistance to newly arrived Muslim settlers, as well as maintaining close ties with representatives of the Naqshbandi brotherhood and other measures contributed to strengthening his reputation as a true Muslim and patron of Islam.

Biograpical Note

Lutfullo Eshonovichi Ismoilov – PhD in History, Associate Professor in the Department of Arabic, Islamic, and Afro-Asian Studies at Kazan (Volga Region) Federal University. He specializes in the study of medieval Muslim hagiographic writings (manaqib).



Lutfullo Eshonovichi Ismoilov.
Kazan (Volga Region) Federal University

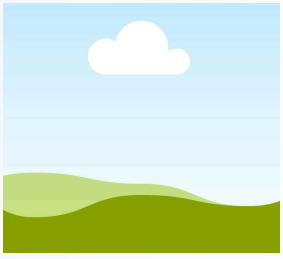
The evolving Russia-Pakistan relations and the role of Russian Language

Abstract

This paper makes the case that in light of regional security concerns and global multipolarity, Pakistan-Russia relations are entering an interest-driven phase. Both nations had a distrustful relationship during Cold War because of their competing interests. However, in recent years, the two countries' relations have been steadily improving. The convergence of diplomacy, economics, security, and cultural connectedness is becoming more and more necessary for a durable geopolitical alliance. Language plays a pivotal role in enhancing international relations by enhancing communication, cultural connectedness and diplomacy. Promoting a foreign language like Russian language in Pakistan can be effective strategy for improving bilateral ties with Russia. The strategy for such promotion includes academic exchanges, tourism and people-to-people connectivity which can project Russian identity and culture among its population. Soft power activities are crucial to build mutual understanding and long-term trust. The primary finding of this study is the significance of Russian language in the development of Pak-Russia relations. In order to improve Pakistan-Russia ties, this study examines Russian language training centers, institutions, cultural exchange initiatives and their future prospects in Pakistan. The Communication Theory framework used in this study highlights the significance of good communication in influencing interactions between states and other players. Its main notion is that diplomacy requires human connection to build trustworthy partnerships. This study investigates how promoting Russian throughout Pakistan can improve Pak-Russia relations. This study employs bibliometric and content analysis as its methodology to find trends and patterns in language-international relations research.

Biograpical Note

My name is Noor Jehan. I am Assistant Professor at Iqra National University, Peshawar. I live at Hayatabad Peshawar with my 3 children and husband. I am hardworking and competent person. I love taking initiatives and facing challenges. I am honest individual with good work ethics having ability to work as part of a team or through my own initiatives. I have Served as the Head of the MPhil English Program, was responsible for academic planning, program administration, coordination of faculty and research activities, and ensuring compliance with university and HEC regulations. I love research work. I have 8 publications in different journals on language, literature and linguistics. I love visiting and exploring the world specially Russia. I did my PhD thesis on Russian language and its role in the economic development of Central Asia. I would appreciate if I got such opportunity to visit Russia.



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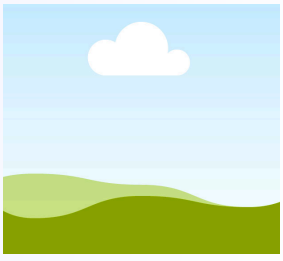
Cultural diplomacy as a means of preserving national sovereignty: interaction between Russia and Pakistan

Abstract

In the 21st century, in an era of deglobalization and the reformatting of the unipolar world order, cultural identity is becoming a key pillar of national sovereignty. For Russia and Pakistan, the protection and promotion of their unique cultures is not simply a matter of prestige, but a strategic objective for maintaining their sovereignty in international affairs. Cultural diplomacy here serves as a tool for neutralizing external destructive interference and the imposition of alien ideologies. Russian-Pakistani relations in the humanitarian sphere are evolving from declarations to institutionalization. The Memorandum of Understanding between the Ministry of Culture of Russia and the National Heritage and Culture Authority of Pakistan (October 2025) lays the legal foundation for long-term cooperation, improving the regulatory framework and intensifying dialogue. Negotiations cover collaboration between cultural institutions—for example, the State Museum of Oriental Art (Russia) and the Taxila Museum (Pakistan)—strengthening each country's sovereign right to interpret its own history. Promising areas of cooperation include cinema, performing arts, creative education, and exchanges between cultural and scientific institutions. Russia has invited its Pakistani partners to participate in the Eurasian Academy of Cinematographic Arts and the Open Eurasian Film Award.Russia is hosting a number of international cultural events of interest to Pakistan, including the 16th International Economic Forum "Russia – Islamic World: KazanForum," the St. Petersburg International Forum of United Cultures, and the International Children's Cultural Forum. Educational initiatives promoting the Russian language in Islamabad and Karachi form the basis for non-politicized interpersonal understanding. The success of Pakistani students confirms the demand for cultural and educational models alternative to Western ones. Despite the political will for cooperation, the financial and technological risks associated with sanctions remain the main stumbling block and source of Western influence. The Pakistani press has explicitly stated that "anxiety over secondary sanctions" is preventing the implementation of large-scale projects. This is where cultural diplomacy can play a key role, creating an atmosphere of trust and mutual understanding that can reduce these risks to an acceptable level.

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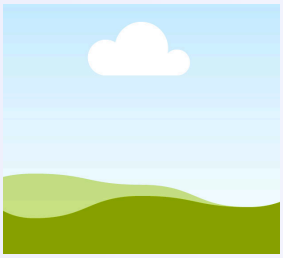
V.V. Usacheva, Associate Professor of the Political Science Department, Faculty of Social Sciences and Mass Communications, Financial University under the Government of the Russian Federation, PhD in Political Science. She specializes in international relations, studying issues of cultural and information sovereignty, forms of neocolonialism, and the interactions of countries in the Global South.



Ratunin P.P.,
Usacheva V.V.,
Financial University under the Government of the Russian Federation

Biograpical Note

P.P. Ratunin, a fourth-year student at the Financial University under the Government of the Russian Federation majoring in Political Science, specializes in political regionalism, elites, and international relations.



P.P. Ratunin,
Financial University under the Government of the Russian Federation

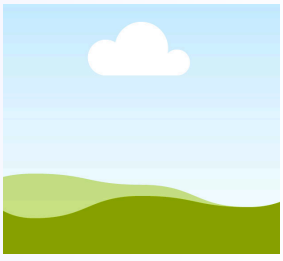
Financial Restriction on Russia and the future of Russia -Pakistan trade exploring Alternatives for Bilateral Economic Engagement

Abstract

Research paper impact of financial sanctions on Russia on Russia -Pakistan Trade relation and the findable alternative mechanism barter trade local currency settlement the Russia SPFS and Mir system digital currency cryptocurrency-based solutions and commodity swap schemes based on mixed methods approaches which includes both qualitative interviews documents analysis and secondary trade data (UN COMTRADE ,PBS ,OEC) the research considers the viability ,risk and scalability of these alternative the result also show that despite the enormous impediments posed by sanction the two state have began to devise some adaptive measure e.g. new barter agreement discounted energy deals and exploration settlement in non USD currencies .The paper suggests serval policy regulatory and institutional interventions to promote safe open and sanction based bilateral trade.

Biograpical Note

Syeda Nida Rizvi is an MPhil scholar at the Federal Urdu University of Arts, Science and Technology (FUUAST), Karachi, within the Department of International Relations. Her research specializes in the intersection of international trade and economic diplomacy, with a specific focus on the geopolitical impacts of financial sanctions.



Syeda Nida Rizvi,
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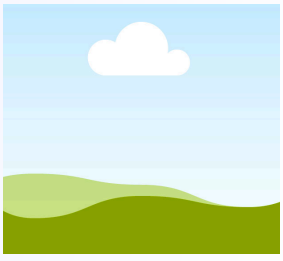
Problems and Prospects of Investment Cooperation between Russia and Pakistan

Abstract

Relations between Russia and Pakistan have moved from geopolitical consultations to the practical implementation of joint decisions. Following record trade turnover in 2023-2024, the ground is being paved for major investments. The main areas of development for bilateral investment ties are the fuel and energy sector, finance (Islamic banking), industry, and trade, including agricultural raw materials. Energy is the main driver of promising cooperation. Pakistan urgently needs energy to meet its population of 250 million. Russian companies can not only supply liquefied natural gas but also act as contractors for geological exploration and production within the country, as Pakistan lacks its own shale exploration technology. Potential resumption of the Pakistan Stream (formerly North-South) gas pipeline project would give Russia access to ports on the Indian Ocean. Pakistan is actively converting its financial system to Shariah standards, planning to completely abolish interest by 2028. This paves the way for attracting investment from the Middle East through the issuance of sukuk securities, particularly in infrastructure projects such as the China-Pakistan Economic Corridor. These efforts could be synchronized with the pilot project on partner financing, which began in the Russian Federation on September 1, 2023, across four republics: Tatarstan, Bashkortostan, Dagestan, and Chechnya. The pilot project aims to introduce Shariah-compliant, interest-free financial services with the participation of banks and non-credit institutions listed with the Bank of Russia. Pakistan has officially invited Russia to invest in the electric vehicle, fertilizer, and pharmaceutical sectors. Discussions are underway for the full modernization of Pakistan Steel Mills, which involves technology transfer and the creation of modern facilities.Currently, there are challenges that hinder the successful development of investment cooperation between the countries. Payments under sanctions are the main obstacle. Even after an agreement is signed, Pakistani banks often refuse to process payments for fear of secondary US sanctions. The technological gap and energy market volatility also pose serious challenges.

Biograpical Note

Irina Gennadievna Morozova, PhD (Candidate of Economic Sciences), is an Associate Professor in the Department of International Economic Relations at Kazan Federal University.



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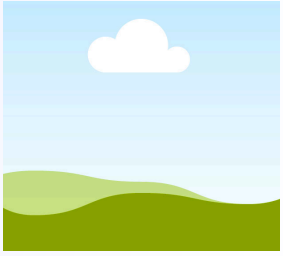
Pakistan's Integration Potential in the Context of the Formation of New Energy and Logistics Corridors

Abstract

A multipolar world order is currently being formed, with the Russian-Chinese strategic partnership playing a key role, and relations with neighboring countries are becoming increasingly important. Pakistan currently maintains a cautious stance regarding the expanding Russia-Iran-China geopolitical partnership, where energy security and logistical integration are crucial. The importance of Pakistan's geopolitical positioning is increasing for Russia amid the developing disintegration processes with the West. With a population of 259 million, Pakistan's economy is struggling: GDP per capita in 2025 was $1,707, but inflation has been slowing over the past two years. While Pakistan's trade balance remains negative, oil, petroleum products, and other energy resources account for over one-third of its national imports. The country remains a major consumer of natural gas, only providing 3% of its own gas. The lack of natural resources that would be of interest to major Eurasian players weakens the country's economic leverage. Therefore, Pakistan needs to integrate into emerging logistics and energy corridors in Central Asia and new economic integration projects in Eurasia to be able to purchase Russian and Iranian gas, modernize the country's power generation capacity, and build reliable transit road infrastructure (including by attracting foreign investment). For Russia, the Pakistani market could become a solid alternative to natural gas exports to Europe, which will decline in 2022-2025. Pakistan's future cooperation not only with Russia but also with Iran appears interesting and mutually beneficial, as Iran's neighboring states are capacious markets with significant gas needs, and joint investment projects with Russia could increase Pakistan's energy security.

Biograpical Note

A.N. Obukhova graduated from the Moscow State Institute of International Relations (MGIMO) with a Master's degree in Economics and a concentration in Persian, English, and Spanish. She completed a full-time postgraduate program in Global Economy at the Institute of Oriental Studies of the Russian Academy of Sciences. She was an affiliate member of UK ACCA. She has over 16 years of experience in investment banking (Renaissance Capital, VTB Capital, Sinara Investment Bank). She was ranked among the top investment analysts in Russia and the EMEA (Europe, Middle East, and Africa) region by professional ratings such as Extel and Institutional Investors. She has authored over 400 analytical reviews in English on ICT companies and markets in Russia, Eastern Europe, and Asia.



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Institute of Oriental Studies of the Russian Academy of Sciences

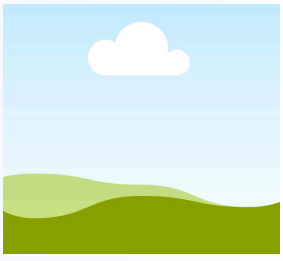
Analysis of the problems of economic cooperation between Russia and the Indo-Pakistani region

Abstract

In the modern economy, the global landscape of cooperation between Russia and Pakistan continues to evolve and serves as a valuable resource for shaping the economic policies of both countries. To deepen the collective understanding that trade relations are far from the only point of contact between Moscow and Islamabad, an impetus for investment in trade and energy ties with Russia is needed. This could contribute to the successful development of the entrepreneurial environment and more effective national economic policies.

Biograpical Note

Tatyana Gennadyevna Antropova is a distinguished Doctor of Economic Sciences and Professor in the Department of International Economic Relations at Kazan Federal University (KFU). With over 43 years of academic experience, she is a leading authority on economic security and international trade dynamics.



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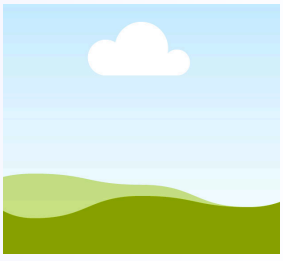
Staff of the Pakistani Ground Forces: Impact on Russian-Pakistani Security Relations

Abstract

Unlike traditional military doctrines of states, which are collectively developed within defense ministries, in Pakistan, each change of Chief of Army Staff is often accompanied by a rethinking of strategic course, expressed in an informally codified "doctrine" designated by the name of the current Chief of Staff (for example, Q. Bajwa or A. Munir). This term has appeared in expert discourse relatively recently and has not received sufficient theoretical development. However, it appears that studying this phenomenon offers significant theoretical and practical value for Pakistani studies. Moreover, studying this aspect is particularly relevant in light of the development of bilateral relations between Russia and Pakistan: in recent years, positive dynamics have been observed in military-technical cooperation, requiring an in-depth understanding of processes within the Pakistani Armed Forces to build security relations. This paper analyzes the development of such doctrines, their constituent elements, as well as the main determining factors and their impact on Russian-Pakistani relations. To this end, we propose using a comparative institutional approach, as well as a qualitative content analysis of statements by individual chiefs of staff over the years. The author believes that, firstly, this phenomenon demonstrates how, in a context of weak civilian institutions, the influence of the personal views of a member of the armed forces (more importantly, the army, as the most influential branch of the armed forces) on the country's domestic and foreign policy is formed. Secondly, through the conceptual framework of the chiefs of staff's doctrines, we can examine the process of institutionalizing foreign policy in the discourse of the generals. Finally, we can trace how the personalization of strategic thinking can be a sustainable mechanism for maintaining political control and adapting to regional challenges, such as the escalating conflict in Afghanistan, opening up new niches for Russia in the sphere of military-technical cooperation. As a result of this analysis, the author concludes that in recent years, the change of Pakistan's Chief of Army Staff has significantly influenced the search for a balance between interactions with international actors such as China, Russia, and the United States.

Biograpical Note

Artur Nikolaevich Makhlayuk is a Junior Research Fellow at the Center of the Indo-Pacific Region within the Primakov National Research Institute of World Economy and International Relations (IMEMO RAS). He is a specialized researcher in South Asian security and military strategy.



Makhlayuk Artur Nikolaevich,
IMEMO RAS

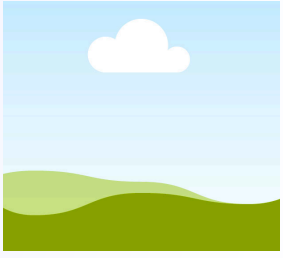
Beyond Strategic Pragmatism: A Social rapprochement towards Cultural Diplomacy & Educational Exchange between Russia and Pakistan

Abstract

Cultural diplomacy forms a vital, yet historically underutilized, foundation for building a sustainable Russia-Pakistan partnership in a globalized world that values unity in diversity. It begins by framing contemporary international relations around the imperative of intercultural dialogue, as endorsed by UN and UNESCO, to achieve global harmony. Russia and Pakistan have a deep rooted historical linkage as the Mongols, Lodhis and Mughals who ruled the sub-continent for centuries belonged to CARs that was a part of USSR. Even during Cold War there was the formalization of a strong cultural and scholarly exchange with a 1965 agreement which in turn saw the formation of bilateral friendship societies, massive literary translations of the works of M. Iqbal, F. A. Faiz, S. H. Manto, etc. Establishment of Russian language units in Pakistan enhanced people-to-people connections accompanied by film festivals, artistic tours and a Twin City relationship between Dushanbe and Lahore, as well as the Soviet-sponsored higher education of hundreds of Pakistani students. This thaw yields a rich, positive legacy driving scholars and diplomats towards rebuilding bridges through intellectual collaboration, founded on the historical footings in this polycentric world. Pakistan is looking for partners and looking in the neighborhood Russia provides a great opportunity in the East due to proximity and historical linkage. This study utilizes a qualitative approach relying on research articles, press release, statements of government officials and MoUs between the two states as primary resource, contending that reactivating and expanding upon this historical people-to-people template through academic centers, revitalized cultural societies and leveraging new social phenomena like intercultural interactions is essential. Such diplomatic and social rapprochement is expected to transform the bilateral relations from strategic pragmatism into a genuine, resilient friendship, thereby integrating both nations into a cooperative global social space.

Biograpical Note

Prof Dr Sajid Mehmood Shahzad Vice-Chancellor, Minhaj University Lahore is a retired naval officers who has held many key positions in his naval career and has proved a role model for his successors. He gained a doctorate from the University of the Punjab succeeding MPhil with top distinction from National Defense University (NDU), Islamabad in International Relations. His Books includes, “Impact of Pakistan Maritime Affairs on Blue Economy in Backdrop of CPEC”. His latest book Pakistan Maritime Tourism is also gatring equal popularity in the Pakistan and abroad. Prof Dr Sajid Mehmood Shahzad has held strategic positions in the Pakistan Maritime Security Agency, the premier organization involved in policing the Maritime Zones of Pakistan and has earned accolades for participating in a prestigious mission to China for the construction of frontline Warships for Pakistan Navy.



Sajid Mehmood Shahzad,
Minhaj University

Empowering Gender dignity and Equality across boarders- Providing Safe academic Workplaces for Women in Russia and Pakistan; Critical analysis of Socio-Legal Norms

Abstract

In today's global era of swift power shift, Russia and Pakistan are finding common interests via diplomatic dialogues, cultural exchanges and shared values. Fields like humanitarian aid, education, arts, language programs, youth initiatives, academic swaps, and people-to-people ties offer cultural diversity. Ideas of academic collaboration, joint research projects, scholarships, or joint degree programs facilitate sharing of knowledge, culture and experience.Gender equality is constitutionally protected in both states acknowledging women as an important participant in society and family life. However, there are strict barriers like sex or gender-based workplace harassment worsened by legal, institutional, and social problems with added patriarchal resistance. This paper addresses a key question: How can Anti-Harassment Laws and Enforcement mechanisms in Russia and Pakistan contribute to develop inclusivity for women in academic institutions ensuring Constitutional mandates of gender equality? This paper is doctrinal legal research focused to critically analyse the Russian Pakistani laws, reports, and insights from stakeholders highlighting socio-legal hurdles in effective implementation at academic institutions. The objective is to recommend practical reforms for anti-harassment policies in workplaces, with a focus on fostering safe, harassment-free academic cultures empowering women. Major recommendations include First, Revising the legal landscape of Workplace harassment Laws- suggesting model law for Russia. Second, set up one unanimous anti-harassment policy mandatory for all universities. Third, introduction of dedicated "Safe Campus Committees" with anonymous reporting apps in multiple languages. Fourth, mandatory training on workplace harassment and cultural sensitivity and surveys as pilot programs under SCO or BRICS youth forums for awareness ending under reporting.The way forward will eventually lead to strengthen trust, promise women's involvement, and foster sustainable development across Eurasia, harmonising with broader goals of cultural collaboration for regional stability. This will also be a legal and social attempt to empower women across borders.

Biograpical Note

Amara Amir is a legal academia from Pakistan with an experience bag of 10 years offering a mix of academic, research and administrative portfolios. She is presently working as Assistant Professor | Director Local Quality Enhancement Cell Law| at NUST Law School. She is also the focal person for harassment. She has taught in International Islamic University, Bahria University Islamabad and liaised with Legal industry and international stakeholders for MOUs and academic and industry linkages. She has been the Focal Person for Disability; ensuring compliance of Institutional Disability Policies with national mandate. As an individual living with albinism, she brings a personal perspective to questions of inclusion, representation, and human dignity in law. She is interested in legal discourse on Diversity



Amara Amir,
National University of Science and Technology

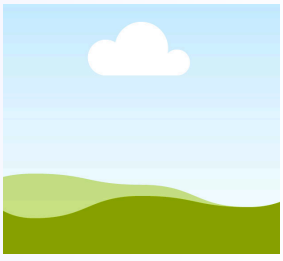
Strengthening Pakistan-Russia Ties: A Policy Framework for Trade, Innovation, and People-to-People Engagement

Abstract

The relationship between Pakistan and Russia has experienced a notable transformation in light of emerging geo-economic paradigms. Given the widening global divide and the rise of a multipolar hegemony, it is essential to reassess the dynamics of these bilateral relations from a modern perspective. This research proposes a comprehensive policy framework to enhance Pakistan-Russia relations by establishing institutional partnerships. Furthermore, this study delineates the collaborative principles and foundational pillars, along with critical policy imperatives, necessary to foster this cooperation. The framework is conceptualized as a layered schematic, commencing with foundational policy principles: sovereign equality, mutual benefits, transparency, inclusive partnership, and sustainability, which serve as the guiding tenets for equitable and enduring collaboration. This study builds on the framework established by the 10th Intergovernmental Commission (November 25-27, 2025) and incorporates elements from the forthcoming 2030 Economic Cooperation Program. It outlines collaborative principles across six core policy pillars: tourism and regional connectivity; language and vocational skill development; capacity building for knowledge corridors; innovation and technology transfer; trade facilitation; and regulatory harmonization. The engagement of various stakeholders is emphasized, promoting a multi-sectoral approach. Policy analysis and reviews integrate multiple sectoral assessments through a regional information pool, with a strategic focus on regional sustainability. This leads to the development of policies driven by national initiatives in trade, customs, technology transfer, and human resource development and exchange. Our findings would be useful for policymakers, government officials, and special interest groups for policy analysis and design.

Biograpical Note

Dr. Waqas Ahmed is a Assistant Professor at Department of Marketing & Entrepreneurship, HSE University Nizhny Novgorod Russia since 2023. He did his PhD in Management Science & Engineering from Nanjing University of Aeronautics & Astronautics, China in 2021, MBA from Quaid-e-Azam University Pakistan in 2004 and MA Management from UK in 2012. He got prestigious Chinese Government Scholarship (2015-2019) and was awarded for Best Researcher and Service Oriened Employee for 2021 and Program designer in 2025. He has published over 20 SCI/Scopus publications. His areas of interest include innovation management, regional economics, decision sciences, conflict management, public policy, environmental issues and entrepreneurship. Mr. Imran Ali is a PhD student at HSE Moscow.



Waqas Ahmad,
Imran Ali,
HSE University,
Nizhny Novgorod

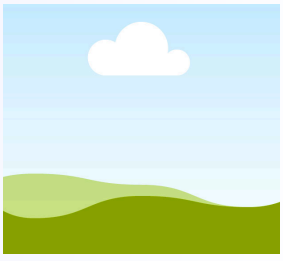
Turkey-Pakistan in the Revised Nuclear Security Architecture Pragmatic Analysis

Abstract

The increasing geopolitical turbulence in the international arena inevitably actualizes security issues on the national agendas of different countries. The heightened sense of external threats in a particularly unstable region of the Middle East makes many players think about those measures to counter them that were previously considered taboo, including nuclear deterrence, which today is actually the last forceful argument in conflict processes. In this regard, Republic of Tűrkiye, which positions itself as the center of the regional political and security architecture, is no exception. Russia and Pakistan appear in the open press as partners in Ankara's potential military nuclear program. The report will review expert assessments of such trilateral cooperation with arguments "pro" and "contra" such a scenario for the transformation of the regional security landscape, as well as make appropriate predictions about how the realization of Tűrkiye's nuclear potential will affect the balance of power in the international arena. The presentation will also focus on the widely discussed potential defense pact between Turkey, Pakistan and Saudi Arabia. Despite the fact that the parties have not yet reached clear agreements, the possibility of creating this military triangle has caused heated discussions in the expert community. The author's vision of this format will be presented through the prism of Russian interests.

Biograpical Note

Dr. Maria Alexandrovna Kolesnikova is a Candidate of Political Sciences (PhD) and a researcher associated with the Moscow State Linguistic University (MSLU). She is recognized for her academic work in international relations and regional security.



Kolesnikova Maria,
Moscow State Linguistic University

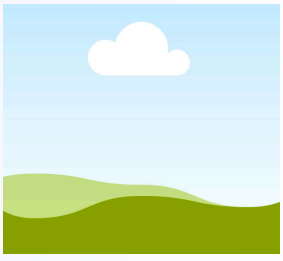
Russian-Pakistani Relations: Institutionalization of Dialogue and Unrealized Potential for Cooperation

Abstract

Between the 2010s and 2020s, Russia and Pakistan expanded institutional formats for bilateral cooperation. Despite this, the level of trade, economic, and investment cooperation remains limited. The report examines the potential for using multilateral formats to develop bilateral cooperation, primarily the SCO, of which Pakistan has been a full member since 2017, and BRICS+, which it may soon join. It analyzes the potential for cooperation in energy, transport, and humanitarian exchanges, as well as factors hindering deeper cooperation, including low economic interdependence and limited implementation of existing agreements.

Biograpical Note

Dr. Olga Aleksandrovna Kharina is a Candidate of Political Sciences (PhD) and a Research Fellow at the National Research University Higher School of Economics (HSE). Her academic work primarily focuses on the geopolitical dynamics of the Indo-Pacific region, with a specialized emphasis on India's foreign policy, regional security architectures, and the strategic interactions between major global powers in South Asia. She is an active contributor to the HSE Faculty of World Economy and International Affairs.



Kharina Olga Aleksandrovna,
National Research University Higher School of Economics

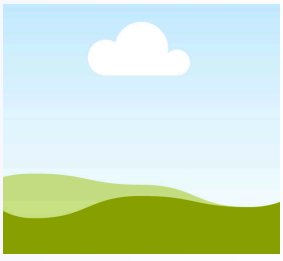
Education as a Tool for Dialogue: Developing Cooperation between Russia and Pakistan through Exchange Programs and Joint Initiatives

Abstract

This article analyzes the role of education as a key tool for intercultural dialogue and the development of cooperation between Russia and Pakistan. It highlights the main areas of student and faculty exchange programs, as well as joint research projects in fields such as medicine, information technology, energy, and industry. Particular attention is given to the mechanisms for implementing educational initiatives, their impact on bilateral relations, and prospects for further development, including the creation of joint programs and digital platforms. The article emphasizes the importance of strengthening academic exchange for building trust, developing an innovative economy, and promoting peace and stability in the region. It concludes with key challenges and proposals for overcoming them, as well as prospects for expanding cooperation.

Biograpical Note

Varvara Vladimirovna Kuznetsova is a student at Moscow Polytechnic University, specializing in International Business and Foreign Economic Activity.



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Moscow Polytechnic University

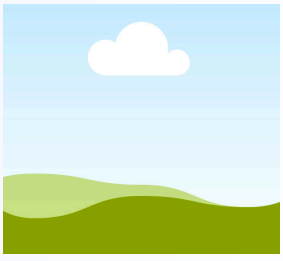
Financial Restriction on Russia and the future of Russia -Pakistan trade exploring Alternatives for Bilateral Economic Engagement

Abstract

In the 16th and 17th centuries, the Russian state served as a strategically important market and transit corridor within the global trade network between the "gunpowder empires" of the East (the Ottoman, Safavid, and Mughal empires). This trade axis was rigidly structured by a network of cities—from the Caspian hub in Astrakhan through the administrative center in Moscow and further north to Arkhangelsk, linking the markets of South Asia with Northwestern Europe. The high intensity of commercial contacts is reflected in detail in a wealth of sources generated by the developed bureaucratic system of the Russian state. The specific nature of the prikaz (prikaz) system of the 16th and 17th centuries made it possible to record not only the volume of trade but also the composition of trade caravans, their routes, and even the details of the daily interactions between eastern merchants and local administration. Of particular value for reconstructing the region's political and economic realities are the lists of articles of the royal merchants (trading agents), as well as interrogatories and petitions of merchants originating from the major centers of Punjab and Sindh. These documents provide detailed information about the life and internal structure of cities such as Lahore, Multan, and Thatta. Analysis of these sources allows us to reconstruct in detail not only the transit routes and hierarchy of regional markets, but also the commodity mix. While exports from South Asian cities (primarily textiles, indigo, and spices) have traditionally attracted the attention of researchers, Russian imports to the cities of Punjab and Sindh remain a "blind spot." Archival materials (both published and lesser-known from the collections of the Russian State Archive of Ancient Documents and the Scientific Archives of the St. Petersburg Institute of History of the Russian Academy of Sciences (the collection of the Astrakhan Prikaznaya Chamber)) demonstrate a stable demand in the region for goods such as "soft furs," tanned leather (yuft), walrus ivory, and metalworking products.Thus, studying Russian archival materials allows us to trace the development of the economic foundation and the vector for future relations between Russia and the modern Islamic Republic of Pakistan.

Biograpical Note

Director of the Center for the Study of the Islamic Republic of Iran at St. Petersburg State University, Associate Professor of the Faculty of Political Science at St. Petersburg State University, Leading Research Fellow at the Institute of History at St. Petersburg State University



Andreev Artem Alekseevich,
St. Petersburg State University

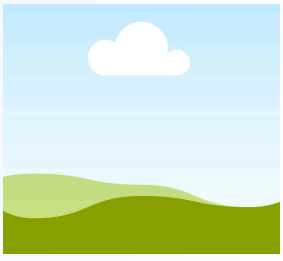
Prospects for Russian-Pakistani Cooperation in Space: Geopolitics, Economics, Science

Abstract

Russia's interaction with friendly countries and partnerships in higher education and scientific research are becoming increasingly important and serve as a tool for the economic development of countries that learn and innovate together. This report explores the potential and possibilities for partnership between Russia and Pakistan in educational and scientific fields. It aims to analyze the current state of scientific and educational interaction between the two countries, identify priority areas for further partnership, and propose practical steps to strengthen integration processes. Particular attention should be paid to the use of space technologies to address priority issues such as improving industrial and environmental safety, digital transformation of industries, and ensuring technological sovereignty.Formats of interaction:- Academic mobility: the implementation of joint educational programs and internships promotes intercultural dialogue and expands the international experience of educational participants;- Joint scientific projects: the establishment of joint research centers and laboratories will enable the effective development of innovative technologies, stimulating the economic and technological development of both countries;- Training world-class personnel: the joint efforts of universities will help prepare qualified personnel capable of implementing space projects. The involvement of educational institutions and scientific organizations in Russia and Pakistan in international cooperation initiatives, including within the framework of the Shanghai Cooperation Organization (SCO), is highly significant. The Russian Ministry of Education and Science places particular emphasis on supporting such cooperation by providing grants for joint scientific research. A range of promising areas of cooperation can be identified with the participation of the Roscosmos Constellation consortium, which unites Russian universities successfully implementing training programs for the rocket and space industry, as well as within the framework of the Russian Ministry of Education and Science's federal project "Personnel for Space" (2026-2030), aimed at developing a comprehensive system for training highly qualified specialists for the rocket and space industry. Thus, the synergy between the scientific and educational resources of Russia and Pakistan can strengthen long-term international cooperation, increase the competitiveness of national economies, and contribute to solving current global technological challenges.

Biograpical Note

Head of the Department for Project and Research Activities, Technological University named after twice Hero of the Soviet Union, pilot-cosmonaut A.A. Leonov - branch of the Federal State Budgetary Educational Institution of Higher Education Moscow State University of Geodesy and Cartography, Korolev, Russia



Bakanova Marina Vladimirovna,
Russian International Affairs Council

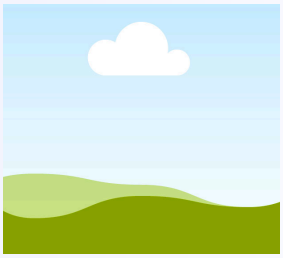
Geoeconomic scenarios for cooperation between Russia and Pakistan in the context of a multipolar Eurasian architecture (up to 2036)

Abstract

The emergence of a multipolar global economic model in the 21st century is accompanied by the strengthening of Eurasia's role as an independent macroeconomic center. Under these circumstances, cooperation between the Russian Federation and the Islamic Republic of Pakistan is acquiring strategic significance in the context of transforming trade flows, energy routes, and financial mechanisms. Both countries are integrated into key regional structures, including the Shanghai Cooperation Organization, the Eurasian Economic Union, BRICS, and the Organization of Islamic Cooperation, which provides an institutional foundation for deepening interaction. Bilateral trade turnover has demonstrated steady positive momentum: in 2023, trade volume exceeded $1 billion for the first time, with Russian exports amounting to approximately $782 million and imports from Pakistan reaching approximately $289 million, reflecting significant growth potential in economic ties between the two countries. According to the Russian Ministry of Economic Development, over the past five years, Russian exports to Pakistan have increased by 35%, while overall trade between the two countries has increased by 15% over the same period, reinforcing the trend of deepening economic cooperation. The trade structure is complementary: Russia supplies grain, energy, and industrial goods, while Pakistan supplies light industrial products, agricultural goods, and textiles. This factor reduces the direct competitiveness of the relationship and creates conditions for sustainable trade growth. Energy cooperation is becoming a key element of collaboration, as the parties engage in dialogue on expanding energy supplies and participating in the modernization of energy infrastructure. At the same time, transport and logistics cooperation is intensifying, aimed at developing southern Eurasian routes, opening up additional opportunities for access to Central Asian and Indian Ocean markets. The financial component of cooperation is particularly important in the context of global instability: the transition to settlements in national currencies and the development of alternative payment mechanisms could enhance the resilience of bilateral trade. The financial component of interaction is becoming especially important in the context of global instability: the transition to settlements in national currencies and the development of alternative payment mechanisms can increase the stability of bilateral trade. The scenario analysis for development up to 2036 includes an optimistic scenario with deepening institutional integration and increased trade turnover, a baseline scenario of moderate expansion, and a risk scenario associated with a slowdown due to geopolitical and economic imbalances. Given current trends, the baseline scenario, in which cooperation between Russia and Pakistan gradually strengthens, playing a significant role in the Eurasian economic architecture, appears most likely.

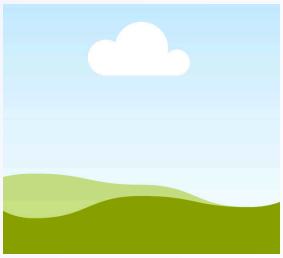
Biograpical Notes

Sofia Sergeevna Smirnova is a Student, Department of Management, Technological University named after Twice Hero of the Soviet Union, Pilot-Cosmonaut A.A. Leonov, a branch of the Moscow State University of Geodesy and Cartography.



Sofia Sergeevna Smirnova,
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Sofia Sergeevna Smirnova is a Student, Department of Management, Technological University named after Twice Hero of the Soviet Union, Pilot-Cosmonaut A.A. Leonov, a branch of the Moscow State University of Geodesy and Cartography.



Elena Nikolaevna Goncharova,
University of Geodesy and Cartography.

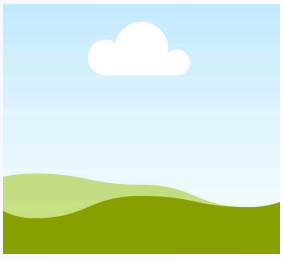
Russia-Pakistan Cultural Collaboration in the Digital Age: Shaping South Asia's Future

Abstract

In the 21st century, South Asia is experiencing rapid digital and cultural transformation, creating new avenues for cross-border engagement and regional cooperation. The partnership between Russia and Pakistan offers a compelling example of how cultural collaboration, supported by digital technologies, can strengthen people-to-people ties, foster mutual understanding, and contribute to broader regional stability. This paper explores the ways in which digital platforms, online learning initiatives, virtual cultural programs, and collaborative media projects are redefining bilateral cultural engagement. The study draws on a theoretical framework combining Soft Power and Digital Diplomacy, which highlights how culture and technology can be strategically leveraged to influence perceptions, build trust, and enhance cooperation. Soft Power emphasizes the role of shared values, education, and cultural exchange in international relations, while Digital Diplomacy focuses on the impact of online tools and virtual engagement in strengthening state-to-state and people-to-people connections. This research adopts a qualitative approach, analyzing official policy documents, cultural agreements, digital initiatives, and case studies of collaborative projects. This approach provides a nuanced understanding of how Russia and Pakistan are using cultural collaboration in the digital sphere to achieve long-term strategic and societal objectives. Beyond policy implications, the paper emphasizes the human dimension of collaboration: digital platforms enable dialogue, empathy, and connection between communities, transcending borders and fostering a sense of shared regional identity. The findings suggest that Russia-Pakistan cultural collaboration in the digital age not only enhances bilateral relations but also contributes to a more connected, resilient, and inclusive South Asia. This study offers insights for policymakers, practitioners, and researchers interested in leveraging cultural and digital tools to advance sustainable regional development and cross-cultural understanding.

Biograpical Note

Dr. Ayesha Ashfaq is an Assistant Professor at the School of Integrated Social Sciences, University of Lahore, Punjab, Pakistan. She holds a Ph.D. and an M.Phil. in South Asian Studies from the University of the Punjab, Lahore. She completed the Gaming for Peace (G4P) Fellowship at the Center for Security, Strategy, and Policy Research (CSSPR), University of Lahore, Pakistan. With extensive experience in academic and research activities, her research interests include political and sociocultural issues in Pakistan and India, communal politics, ethnic conflicts in South Asia, violence and human rights, minority issues, extremism, SAARC Pakistan-Russia Relation, and CPEC.



Ayesha Ashfaq,
University of Lahore

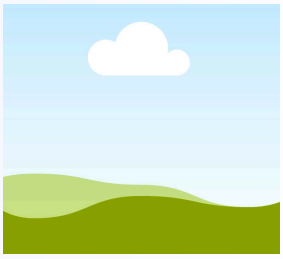
Geopolitical Cooperation via Education: Language as a Catalyst for Strengthening Russia-Pakistan Strategic Partnership

Abstract

Although the diplomatic relations between Russia and Pakistan have been evolving in terms of trade, energy, and security, the language barrier remains a major challenge to enhancing bilateral cooperation. This study explores the significance of Russian language education in Pakistan as a strategic tool to strengthen cultural ties, geopolitical, educational, and economic cooperation between the two countries. Existing scholarship emphasizes the urgent need for language diplomacy and policy for refined negotiation and prolonged collaboration. This research fills the identified gap by examining how the study of the Russian language in Pakistan offers opportunities to enhance diplomatic communications and geopolitical coordination. The investigation has followed an interdisciplinary approach employing Neoliberal Institutionalism (Joseph Nye, 1990) and Soft Power Theory (Robert Kohane, 1984) of International Relations, together with the Sociocognitive theory of Intercultural Pragmatics (Istvan Kecskes, 2014). The researchers conducted the interviews with educators and students from the Department of Russian, National University of Modern Languages, Islamabad, Pakistan (NUML), and the diplomats from the Ministry of Foreign Affairs and the Russian Embassy in Pakistan. The study concludes that in Pakistan, though the Russian language courses are increasingly becoming popular, they are not fully incorporated into the diplomatic strategy. The efficacy of language learning as a deeper expansion of geopolitical and economic engagement is obstructed by the linguistic gap, inadequate training material, and the absence of consensus between the education framework and the foreign policy agendas. The research suggests developing a strategic framework to incorporate language education into foreign policy as well as international relations practice. The study offers valuable policy recommendations to diplomats and educators, emphasizing the need for a coordinated language diplomacy to enhance geopolitical cooperation and strengthen educational and economic ties between the two nations.

Biograpical Note

Ahmed Osama Tahir is a PhD Scholar in International Relations and a Faculty Member in the Department of International Relations at Federal Urdu University of Arts, Science and Technology, Pakistan. He is an educator, researcher, Presidential Award achiever, professional trainer, and social activist. His 13 years of professional career include key leadership roles such as Program Consultant with various international NGOs, including RELO, U.S. Embassy Islamabad. He also has expertise in international business collaborations, actively promoting entrepreneurship, youth development, and geopolitical engagement. Co- author, Memona Mujahid, is a PhD scholar in Linguistics and a faculty member at the Department of English, International Islamic University,



Ahmed Osama Tahir,
Federal Urdu University, Karachi

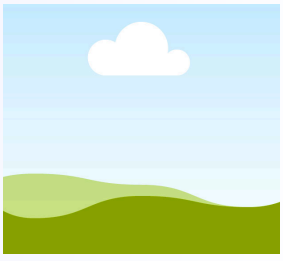
Pakistan as a necessary partner for Russia in its foreign policy in the Central Asian, Afghan and South Asian directions

Abstract

This research identifies Pakistan as a critical strategic pivot for Russia's foreign policy objectives across Central and South Asia. It explores the convergence of interests between Moscow and Islamabad regarding regional stability, particularly in post-conflict Afghanistan and through the framework of the Shanghai Cooperation Organization (SCO). By analyzing the transit and security potential of this partnership, the study argues that deepened cooperation with Pakistan is essential for Russia to maintain a balanced and effective geopolitical presence in the Eurasian heartland.

Biograpical Note

PhD in Economics, Associate Professor, and Coordinator of the Center for International Cooperation at Shakarim University (Semey, Republic of Kazakhstan).



Bail'dinov Yergali Temurzhanovich,
Shakarim University, Kazakhstan

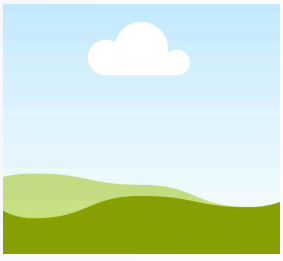
Pakistan as a link in regional security complexes and an active actor in strategic alliances

Abstract

This research evaluates Pakistan's pivotal role within the shifting regional security architecture of South and Central Asia. It examines the country's strategic maneuvering between traditional partnerships and emerging alliances, particularly within the context of the Shanghai Cooperation Organization (SCO) and the Belt and Road Initiative. By applying regional security complex theory, the study analyzes how Pakistan's foreign policy adaptations respond to new geopolitical realities and influence the balance of power in Eurasia.

Biograpical Note

Doctor of Political Science, Professor and Head of the Department of Foreign Regional Studies at HSE University, and Chief Research Fellow at the Institute of Scientific Information on Social Sciences of the Russian Academy of Sciences (INION RAN).



Efremenko Dmitry Valerievich,
National Research University Higher School of Economics

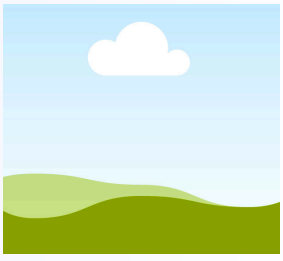
Developing Pakistan's ties with the GCC countries is an important element in the formation of a new geopolitical order

Abstract

This paper analyzes the strategic reorientation of Pakistan's foreign policy toward the Gulf Cooperation Council (GCC) as a defining component of the emerging multipolar world order. It examines the multifaceted nature of these ties, encompassing labor migration, energy security, and the recent inclusion of regional powers like Saudi Arabia into expanded global frameworks like BRICS. By evaluating the convergence of interests between Islamabad and the Gulf monarchies, the research highlights how this "axis of complementarity" serves as a counterbalance to traditional Western influence and strengthens Eurasian integration.

Biograpical Note

Andrey Glebovich Baklanov is a Professor at the National Research University Higher School of Economics (HSE) in Moscow, within the Faculty of World Economy and International Affairs. A veteran diplomat, he holds the rank of Ambassador Extraordinary and Plenipotentiary and serves as the Head of the Middle East and North Africa Studies section. His work bridges the gap between high-level diplomatic practice and academic research, focusing on international security, Middle Eastern geopolitics, and global energy policy.



Baklanov Andrey Glebovich,
HSE University, Moscow

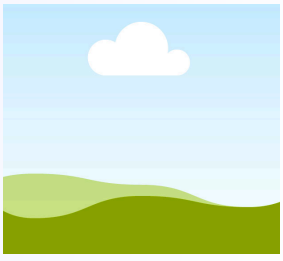
The Architecture of Reciprocity: Decoding the Strategic Rapprochement between Pakistan and Russia (2020–2025) through Mirror Diplomacy"

Abstract

Since the 2014 Defence paradigm shift, Pakistan-Russia relations have evolved into a sophisticated strategic partnership characterized by high-frequency reciprocity. This study employs the contemporary lens of Mirror Diplomacy, a subset of Neo-Rationalism and Social Constructivism, to analyze how bilateral relations transitioned from Cold War hostility to pragmatic alignment between 2015 and 2025. Through a qualitative analysis of diplomatic protocols, joint military exercises (Druzhba), and the breakthrough in energy cooperation (Russian crude oil shipments), this paper argues that "mirrored gestures" serve as essential trust-building mechanisms that mitigate historical mistrust. The findings reveal that while the Shanghai Cooperation Organization (SCO) has institutionalized this reciprocity, the partnership now faces a critical transition from "security-led mirroring" to "geo-economic integration." The study concludes that Russia's support for Pakistan's BRICS aspirations and the land-based trade via the INSTC represent the "upper stories" of this diplomatic architecture, though Western sanctions remain a significant structural constraint.

Biograpical Note

Dr. Gul-i-Ayesha Bhatti is an Assistant Professor at NUST and a preeminent Russia expert, serving as the Director of the Eurasian Chapter at CAPES. Honored by the Russian Embassy for her diplomatic contributions, she is a critical voice on the strategic reconfigurations of the Eurasian landscape. Her scholarship masterfully navigates the evolving power dynamics between Moscow and Islamabad in a shifting global order.



Dr. Gul I Ayesha,
National University of Science and Technology

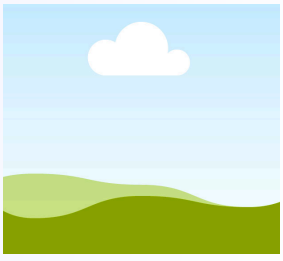
Comparative analysis of the paradiplomatic capabilities of the regions of Pakistan and the Russian Federation

Abstract

This paper provides a comparative study of paradiplomacy the international activities of subnational entities within the federal structures of Pakistan and the Russian Federation. It examines the legal frameworks and political mechanisms that allow regions, such as Tatarstan in Russia and provinces like Punjab or Sindh in Pakistan, to engage in independent foreign economic and cultural cooperation. By identifying common challenges and unique regional strategies, the research highlights how sub-state diplomacy can complement national foreign policy goals and foster direct bilateral ties between the two nations' diverse regions.

Biograpical Note

PhD in Political Science and Associate Professor in the Department of International Relations, World Politics, and Diplomacy at Kazan Federal University, specializing in political institutions and processes.



Silaeva Zoya Vladimirovna,
Kazan Federal University

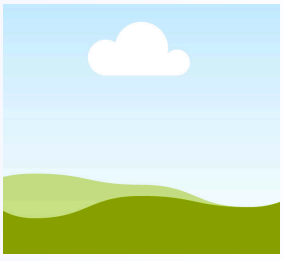
The main stages of the development of Russian-Pakistani relations in matters of economic interaction.

Abstract

This research outlines the historical evolution of economic diplomacy between Russia and Pakistan, identifying key stages of bilateral cooperation from the Soviet era to the present day. It focuses on strategic sectors such as energy, infrastructure, and trade, analyzing how geopolitical shifts have influenced economic priorities. By evaluating current joint ventures and investment frameworks, the study provides a comprehensive overview of the trajectory and future potential of the Russo-Pakistani economic partnership.

Biograpical Note

Associate Professor in the Department of International Economic Relations at the Institute of International Relations, Kazan Federal University.



Bakirova Gulnaz Yanovna,
Kazan Federal University

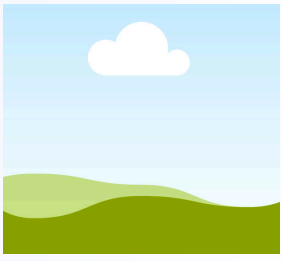
The Financial Sector in the Structure of the National Economy of Pakistan

Abstract

This research outlines the historical evolution of economic diplomacy between Russia and Pakistan, identifying key stages of bilateral cooperation from the Soviet era to the present day. It focuses on strategic sectors such as energy, infrastructure, and trade, analyzing how geopolitical shifts have influenced economic priorities. By evaluating current joint ventures and investment frameworks, the study provides a comprehensive overview of the trajectory and future potential of the Russo-Pakistani economic partnership.

Biograpical Note

Associate Professor in the Department of International Economic Relations at the Institute of International Relations, Kazan Federal University.



Khasanov Ilgizar Shamilevich,
Kazan Federal University

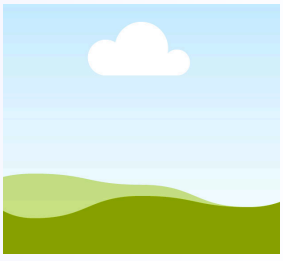
Persian-language poetic tradition on the Indian subcontinent: on the problem of interaction of languages and cultures

Abstract

This research explores the historical development of the Persian poetic tradition within the Indian subcontinent, focusing on the unique synthesis of "Sabk-e-Hindi" (the Indian style). it examines the linguistic and cultural dialogue between Persian literary norms and local Indian traditions, analyzing how this interaction transformed classical genres and metaphors. By tracing these cross-cultural influences, the study highlights the role of the Persian language as a bridge for intellectual and aesthetic exchange across the Eastern Islamic world.

Biograpical Note

Doctor of Philology and Professor in the Department of Iranian Philology at the Institute of Asian and African Studies, Lomonosov Moscow State University.



Reisner Marina Lvovna,
Moscow State University

Message from the East by Mohammad Iqbal (reference to Persian works)

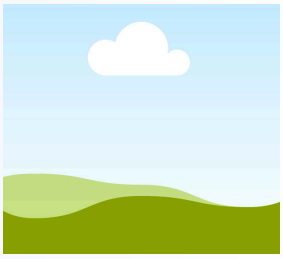
Abstract

This research explores Mohammad Iqbal's philosophical and poetic masterpiece, Payam-e-Mashriq (Message from the East), specifically analyzing its deep-rooted connections to his Persian-language oeuvre. It examines how Iqbal utilizes the Persian literary tradition to respond to Western thought, blending classical Eastern aesthetics with contemporary socio-political themes. By tracing these intertextual references, the study illuminates Iqbal's vision of spiritual rebirth and his enduring influence on Indo-Persian cultural synthesis.

). it examines the linguistic and cultural dialogue between Persian literary norms and local Indian traditions, analyzing how this interaction transformed classical genres and metaphors. By tracing these cross-cultural influences, the study highlights the role of the Persian language as a bridge for intellectual and aesthetic exchange across the Eastern Islamic world.

Biograpical Note

PhD in Philology and Associate Professor in the Department of Arabic, Islamic, and Afro-Asian Studies at Kazan Federal University.



Akhmedova Mastura Negmatdzhonovna,
Kazan Federal University

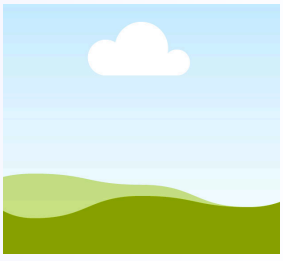
Some aspects of the development of Christianity in Pakistan

Abstract

This research examines the historical evolution and cultural identity of Christianity in Pakistan, from colonial missionary roots to its current minority status. It analyzes how the community navigates the socio-political pressures of state Islamization while maintaining its unique religious and social traditions. By exploring the intersection of faith and the Pakistani social fabric, the study highlights the resilience and evolving role of Christians within the nation's contemporary landscape.

Biograpical Note

Master of Philosophy (HSE) and 4th-year postgraduate student in Cultural Studies at Moscow State University for the Humanities.



Khasanov Marat,
Moscow State University for the Humanities

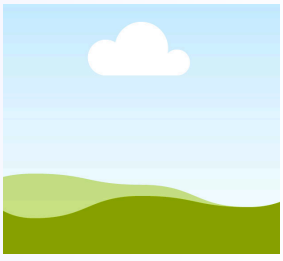
Indo-Iranian studies at KFU: a working model for developing cooperation with Pakistan

Abstract

This paper presents the Indo-Iranian studies program at Kazan Federal University (KFU) as a strategic framework for strengthening academic and cultural ties with Pakistan. It outlines the pedagogical methodologies and research initiatives used to build a sustainable model for international institutional cooperation. By analyzing KFU's long-standing expertise in Asian philology, the study demonstrates how academic exchange serves as a foundation for broader diplomatic and social engagement.

Biograpical Note

Ramil Tagirovich Yuzmukhametov, PhD in Philology, is an Associate Professor at Kazan Federal University with over 24 years of experience in Asian languages and Oriental studies.



Yuzmukhametov Ramil Tagirovich, Kazan Federal University - **Moderator**

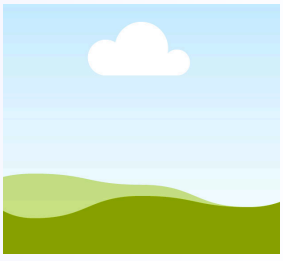
The introduction of the Arabic language into the curriculum of secondary schools in the Russian Federation as a model for the Islamic Republic of Pakistan

Abstract

This presentation examines the systematic integration of the Arabic language into the Russian secondary education system, particularly within the Republic of Tatarstan, as a pedagogical blueprint for Pakistan. It explores the development of standardized textbooks and modern communicative methodologies that balance linguistic proficiency with cultural and religious literacy. By highlighting the Russian model's success in secular and religious educational contexts, the study proposes a framework for Pakistan to enhance its own Arabic curricula through international academic cooperation and shared best practices

Biograpical Note

Candidate of Philological Sciences, Associate Professor, and Vice-Rector for Research at the Russian Islamic Institute, as well as Head of the Department of Arabic, Islamic, and Afro-Asian Studies at Kazan Federal University.



Zakirov Rafis Rafaelevich,
Mingazova Naila Gabdelkhamitovna ,
Kazan Federal University

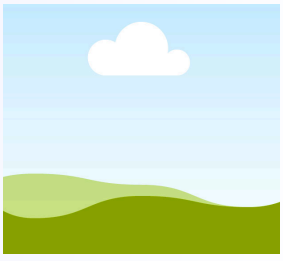
Teaching Hindi and Urdu in Russian Universities: Common Features and Differences in Methodology

Abstract

This research presents a comparative analysis of the pedagogical approaches to teaching Hindi and Urdu within the Russian higher education system. It examines the shared linguistic foundation of these languages while highlighting the distinct methodological challenges posed by their different scripts, specialized vocabularies, and cultural contexts. By evaluating current curricula and instructional materials, the study proposes optimized strategies for training philologists and regional specialists in the unique socio-linguistic landscape of South Asia.

Biograpical Note

Senior Lecturer at the Department of Arabic, Islamic, and Afro-Asian Studies, Institute of International Relations, Kazan Federal University.



Bobkov Dmitry Vyacheslavovich,
Kazan Federal University

Pakistan's Strategic Agency in an evolving World Order

Abstract

The present international order is fragmenting at a rapid pace, as seen by rising US China rivalry, the geopolitical consequences from the Ukraine conflict, sanctions driven economic blocs, and the rise of regional power politics. Secondary states in this evolving framework are no longer passive beneficiaries of systemic pressures; instead, they have measurable strategic agency. This study contends that Pakistan is a key example of adaptable statecraft in an evolving multipolar system.

The paper uses a hybrid analytical framework that combines neorealist balancing theory, hedging literature, and strategic autonomy paradigms to assess Pakistan's foreign policy diversification between 2014 and 2025. It quantitatively maps changes in diplomatic engagement, defense collaboration, trade realignment, and energy discussions, particularly in light of the changing relationship with Russia. The study identifies three measurable indicators of agency (1) diversifying security partnerships, (2) expanding energy diplomacy beyond conventional blocs, and (3) calibrated neutrality in great-power crises.

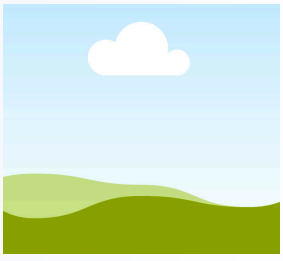
The article explains the emerging Russia-Pakistan relationship as a strategic tool within Pakistan's larger multi vector foreign policy, rather than a departure from previous alliances. The study examines military drills, energy cooperation frameworks, regional security dialogues, and post sanctions economic recalibrations to show how Pakistan uses systemic uncertainty to optimize diplomatic flexibility and geopolitical relevance.

The research theoretically contributes to debates on middle-power conduct and strategic autonomy by presenting an improved model of 'adaptive agency' that is applicable to states working in the context of global fragmentation. Empirically, it offers data-driven insight into how Pakistan's foreign policy trajectory reflects broader global shifts.

In doing so, the study reframes Pakistan as a strategically adaptable state actively developing its options in a shifting multipolar system, rather than a reactive actor stuck between great powers.

Biograpical Note

Dr. Tatheer Zahra Sherazi is an Assistant Professor in the Department of International Relations at the National University of Modern Languages (NUML) in Islamabad. She is a specialized academic focused on global politics, particularly the rise of China and contemporary security issues.



Tatheer Sherazi,
National University of Modern Languages

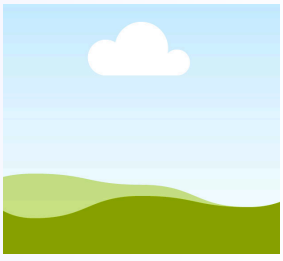
Russia-Pakistan Relations and the Role of China: The Triangular Geopolitical Logic of Convergence

Abstract

During the Cold War, Pakistan and Russia stood on the opposite sides of global strategic and ideological divides. Post Cold war this ideological and strategic rigidity between the two countries gradually started dismantling. Today, the inter-state relationship between the two countries has shifted from suspicion to pragmatic cooperation in geopolitical and geoeconomics domains. Russia seeks to challenge the U.S unipolarity and global hegemony and wants to expand its influence in not only Asia but in the Global South. Pakistan is viewed by Russia not merely as a U.S ally but also an important security stakeholder in the region. Pakistan's growing engagement with Russia means diversification of its foreign policy beyond the U.S and China. It also means the enhancement of its regional relevance and significance in Central Asia and Afghanistan. China plays a pivotal role in Russia-Pakistan relationship. Russia and China share an unlimited partnership against pressing western geopolitical and geoeconomics pressure campaigns. China is a close defense and strategic partner of Pakistan and creates that important triangular geopolitical logic of helping advance future Russia-Pakistan cooperation and partnership. This paper attempts to explore this triangular logic and China's role in providing the triangular depth to the growing Russia-Pakistan geopolitical and geoeconomics engagement. The paper also examines Afghanistan as the key convergence point and argues how the shared concerns of, terrorism, ISIS-K expansion and spilling over of radical Islamism to Central Asian States, China and South Asia necessitates the adherence to the triangular geopolitical logic of cooperation between all three-stake holder, Russia, China and Pakistan. In the end, the paper will recommend how the triangular geopolitical logic of convergence in Afghanistan can help create a stable and enabling environment for not only the development of Russia-Pakistan future relations but also the weakening of western monopolies and strengthening of power centers like SCO and BRI in the region.

Biograpical Note

Dr. Muhammad Ali Ehsan is an Assistant Professor of International Relations in the Department of Humanities and Social Sciences at DHA Suffa University, Karachi. He also serves as a Non-Resident Research Fellow at the Institute of Policy Research Institute (IPRI), Islamabad. Since 2012, he has been a weekly columnist for The Express Tribune, Pakistan's leading English daily, where he writes on national and international affairs. He is the author of three books, Russia, China and Pakistan – Trilateral partnership in Changing World Order(2026), The Russian–Ukraine Crisis (2023) and Two Years of Democracy in Pakistan (2018–2020) (2021). He earned his PhD from the University of Karachi in 2017. In 2023, he engaged in a postdoctoral fellowship at Kazan Federal University, Russia, and is currently pursuing a second PhD in International Relations at Tomsk State University, Russia, where he has also taught as a member of the faculty.



Muhammad Ali,
DFA Suffah University

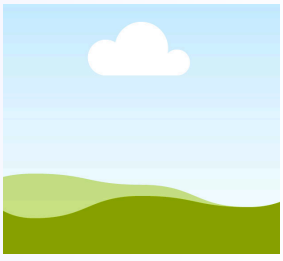
A road to take: The Russian-Pakistani connections in media studies and the role of national scholarly associations

Abstract

Russia and Pakistan have had scarce connections in the area of media and communication studies. However, the experience of participating in academic conferences and the IAMCR Spring School on media and communication studies (2022-2025) allows for firmly saying that the road of collaboration should be taken. There are political, technological, professional, and academic similarities, including similar issues to tackle, that would foster such collaboration. Thus, both countries are emerging as poles in the multi-polar world. They have developed media systems and mediatized societies, but journalism in both countries experiences large-scale impact of the state and struggles for survival. Moreover, media studies in both countries rely on Western concepts which rarely fit to local contexts, and PhD students equally suffer from under-training in terms of getting through to major world journals. We explore the obstacles for the current development of collaboration in media industry and academe, as well as suggest three-level measures to develop mid-range projects, with the goal of developing the field itself, trust, and culture of collaboration. We argue that national associations of media scholars, MCAP and NAMMI, both very active nationally, should play the leading role in organizing co-operation between media scholars. We also urge the embassies and think tanks to take on more active roles in supporting the existing initiatives to make them long-term points of collaboration growth.

Biograpical Note

Svetlana S. Bodrunova is Professor at School of Journalism and Mass Communications, St. Petersburg State University, Russia. She has led seven research projects and published two books and 200+ research papers. She leads the Center for International Media Research (CIMRES) in her university. Her works regularly appear in the best international academic journals and books by major academic publishing houses. Her keynote speaking includes URBAN20 (G20 side conference in Jakarta, Indonesia) and 20+ other speeches around Russia, the USA, Europe, and Asia since 2017. Since 2013, she has been program chair of the international conference 'Comparative media studies in today's world' (CMSTW). In 2024, she became an elected IAMCR International Council member (till 2028). Svetlana's research interests include deliberation and opinion formation online, social media, media and politics, and automated and AI-based communication studies' methodologies. She visited Pakistani academic events in 2022-2025.



Svetlana S. Bodrunova,
St. Petersburg State University

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Qurtuba Aslam





Alishba Farooq

Azadar Hussain





Minahil Qaisar

Talha Ali



Honoring Our Volunteers

Shazia Batool





Waniya Fatima

